

INTERPRETING SNT-TC-1A

INTERPRETATIONS FROM
1976 THROUGH 2024

2024

EDITION



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INTRODUCTION

The SNT-TC-1A Interpretation Panel was established to respond to written inquiries about Recommended Practice No. SNT-TC-1A: *Personnel Qualification and Certification in Nondestructive Testing*.

This book contains the responses by the panel to inquiries submitted from 1976 through 2024. These responses clarify the intent of ASNT's Standards Council and the recommendations of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiries are numbered to include the year of the inquiry and always refer to the edition of SNT-TC-1A in effect in that year, unless otherwise stated in the question. New editions of SNT-TC-1A were published in these years: 1968, 1975, 1980, 1984, 1988, 1992, 1996, 2001, 2007 (2006 edition), 2011, 2016, 2020, and 2024.

Users of SNT-TC-1A are reminded that the document is intended as a guideline for employers to establish their own written practices for the qualification and certification of their nondestructive testing personnel.

The responses of the SNT-TC-1A Interpretation Panel are clarifications of intent and subject to the statement of "Scope" in each edition of SNT-TC-1A, such as the 2020 edition, paragraph 1.4, "It is recognized that these guidelines may not be appropriate for certain employer's circumstances and/or applications. In developing a written practice as required in Section 5, the employer should review the detailed recommendations presented herein and modify them, as necessary, to meet particular needs."

Guidelines for Inquiry Preparation

The following guidelines for preparing an inquiry to the panel will expedite consideration and response to the inquirer. Each inquiry should be limited to a single recommendation of SNT-TC-1A. Inquiries concerning multiple recommendations of SNT-TC-1A or unrelated subjects may be returned for further clarification.

The specific question to be answered by the panel should be distinctly set apart from the body of the letter and in a condensed, precise, question format, omitting superfluous background information and, if possible, asked in such a manner that a "yes" or "no" (with a short explanation) would be an acceptable reply.

The background explanation for the question can be prepared separately from the question. It should state the purpose of the inquiry, which could be to obtain a clarification of the document's recommendations or the intent of ASNT's Standards Council; provide concisely the information needed for the panel's understanding of the inquiry and include references to applicable paragraphs of SNT-TC-1A, including date of edition. Sometimes it helps the panel members' understanding if the inquirer includes—set aside from the body of the letter—a "proposed response" at the end of the letter. Do not solicit from the panel an opinion or interpretation of an employer's written practice, nor of another party's opinion of an employer's written practice.

To make an inquiry, download the form from the ASNT website (<https://www.asnt.org/standards-publications/standards>). Inquiries should be sent to standards@asnt.org.

Inquiry 76-1

Table 6.2.1A contains the statement “Credit for experience may be gained simultaneously in two or more disciplines. The candidate must spend at least 25% of the work time on each discipline for which experience is being claimed.” Our question is this: Over what time period does the term “simultaneously” apply?

Response

The employer’s written practice should specify the time period over which simultaneous experience shall be credited.

Inquiry 76-2

1. For requalification of Level I and II NDT personnel, does Paragraph 6.2.1 imply that you must keep continuous records by the hour showing that individuals have continuously spent at least 25% of their work time working in each method to which qualified?
2. Because of the 25% used in the note to Table 6.2.1A, it has been implied that an individual at maximum could be qualified in only four methods and this would be true only if they could show that exactly 25% of the work time was spent in each of four methods. Was this the intent of SNT-TC-1A?

Response

1. No. Table 6.2.1A applies only to initial experience required for qualification; it is not applicable to requalification.
2. No. The candidate may be qualified in as many methods as desired. The 25% work time experience only applies to the work time experience required for initial qualification in each level for each method. The 25% is not applicable and is not required for the individual to remain qualified in a particular method at a specific qualification level.

General Comments

Paragraph 6.2.1, like the rest of SNT-TC-1A, is only a guide. The employer’s written practice should detail all such requirements, which may differ from the recommendations of Paragraph 6.2.1.

Inquiry 76-3

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that the Level I NDT persons described in Paragraph 4.3(a) of the 1975 edition of this document be the same as the Level I individual described in the SNT-TC-1A (1968 edition) Paragraph 4.1(a) with both having the same capabilities?

Response

Yes. The changes in wording between the 1975 and the 1968 versions of SNT-TC-1A, insofar as the duties and capabilities of Level I personnel are concerned, were intended only to clarify the intent of the document. None of these changes in wording were intended as substantive changes.

Inquiry 76-4

Paragraph 1.1 of SNT-TC-1A refers to individuals who “perform, witness, monitor or evaluate” nondestructive tests. Is it intended that individuals whose principal functions are to witness, monitor or evaluate nondestructive tests be qualified in the same manner as those whose principal function is to perform nondestructive tests?

Response

It is intended that the employer designate through the written practice as recommended in Paragraph 5 specific jobs that require knowledge of the technical principles of nondestructive testing. The employer

should test the statement of Paragraph 1.1, “... personnel whose specific jobs require appropriate knowledge of the technical principles underlying the nondestructive tests they perform, witness, monitor or evaluate,” against the specific job elements of the personnel in question in order to establish whether or not the specific job requires knowledge of nondestructive testing.

Inquiry 76-5

In accordance with SNT-TC-1A (1975 edition), may a Level I NDT person who has been trained, qualified, and certified in accordance with SNT-TC-1A (1975 edition) be the sole person to perform, evaluate and sign for final acceptance of NDT examinations in accordance with written procedures and acceptance standards with occasional surveillance and guidance from a Level II or III?

Response

Yes. The intent in SNT-TC-1A is that the Level I person may perform the above functions provided they are in accordance with written procedures and so documented in the employer’s written practice.

Inquiry 77-1

1. Is it intended that the 1975 edition of SNT-TC-1A including all recommendations therein completely replace prior editions of SNT-TC-1A?
2. Is it intended that personnel qualified and certified as recommended in the 1975 edition of SNT-TC-1A be considered equivalent to those qualified and certified as recommended in previous editions of SNT-TC-1A?

Response

The answer is yes to both parts of the inquiry.

Inquiry 77-3

With respect to Paragraphs 9.4 and 9.5 of SNT-TC-1A:

1. Is it the intent to restrict an employer to engage only Level III services from an outside agency or may Level I and Level II services also be utilized?
2. Is it intended in Paragraph 9.5 that an employer may subcontract training, examination and certification for all levels, provided the employer’s audit results are found to be satisfactory?
3. Paragraph 9.1 states that the certification of all levels is the responsibility of the employer. Paragraph 9.5 recognizes the use of outside certification services. May an employer subcontract nondestructive testing to an outside organization utilizing that organization’s certifications for Levels I, II, and III, provided the results of the employer’s audit of that organization are satisfactory? Must the employer personally certify NDT personnel, or may they accept the outside organization’s certification?

Response

1. It is intended that Level III services may be obtained from an outside agency for the purpose of training and examining NDT personnel. It is beyond the scope of SNT-TC-1A to recommend whether or not outside inspection services should be obtained. It is definitely not intended that the employer be restricted from utilizing any outside NDT services.
2. The intent of Paragraph 9.5 is to emphasize the responsibility of the employer to assure by audit that any and all parts of purchased services attendant to qualification and certification of NDT personnel are within the same guidelines that the employer would follow in accordance with their written practice.

3. The intent underlying Paragraph 9.1 is fundamental. When outside Level III services are used for the purpose of qualifying and certifying personnel, it is intended that the employer utilizing such services be responsible for assuring that those services are properly performed and audited. Whether or not the employer uses outside Level III services for training and examining their NDT personnel, the total responsibility for certification of all levels rests with the employer of the individuals.

SNT-TC-1A only provides guidelines for qualification and certification of NDT personnel. Outside services referred to in Paragraph 9 are those intended to be used by an employer only for the purposes of training, examining or otherwise qualifying individuals directly employed by the employer.

When the performance of NDT is subcontracted to an outside organization and the outside organization is the direct employer of the individual performing NDT, the outside organization is the “employer” in terms of SNT-TC-1A. Whether the outside organization is properly qualifying and certifying its NDT personnel can only be determined by the purchaser of such outside services and how such determination is made is a contractual matter between the purchaser and the outside organization.

Inquiry 77-4

May the experience requirements expressed as “certified NDT Level II” in Paragraph 6.3.1(b), (c) and (d) of the 1975 edition of SNT-TC-1A be considered to include experience gained in “an assignment comparable to that of an NDT Level II” [as stated in Paragraph 6.3.2(a)] in determining the prerequisite requirements of a candidate for certification as a Level III? If so, may this acceptance of experience in “an assignment comparable to” be extended to include similar subparagraphs under Paragraph 6.2.5 of the earlier editions of SNT-TC-1A?

Response

Paragraph 6.2 of the 1975 edition of SNT-TC-1A states, “Documented training and/or experience gained in positions and activities equivalent to those of Level II or Level III prior to establishment of the employer’s written practice and a certification program in accordance with this document shall be considered as satisfying the criteria of Paragraph 6.2.1 and 6.3.” If documentation was not produced during such prior experience, an affidavit or other suitable testimony regarding such experience may be evaluated by the employer to aid in determining equivalence. This response applies to the 1975 edition and all prior editions of SNT-TC-1A. See Inquiry 77-1.

Inquiry 77-5

With reference to Paragraph 8.5 of the 1975 edition of SNT-TC-1A, is it intended to limit the written Specific examination to a closed-book examination, without access to codes, specifications, and/or procedures?

Response

It is intended that codes, specifications, and/or procedures are “necessary data” under Paragraph 8.5 of the 1975 edition of SNT-TC-1A, provided that examination questions are asked that require reference to such data and that such data cannot be used to answer questions related to other closed-book portions of the examination.

Inquiry 77-6

1. Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that Level I, II and III individuals certified to the recommendations of the 1968 edition meet the recommendations for certification in the 1975 edition?
2. If certification is transferred from the 1968 edition to the 1975 edition recommendations, which recommendations prevail regarding recertification?

Response

1. It is intended that individuals certified according to the recommendations of earlier editions of SNT-TC-1A meet the recommendations for certification in the 1975 edition.
2. The 1975 edition recommendations prevail regarding recertification. See also Inquiry 78-2.

Inquiry 77-8

Level III personnel certified by ASNT do not receive examination grades. Paragraph 8.6 of SNT-TC-1A recommends arriving at a composite grade. How can this be accomplished since ASNT only supplies examination results in terms of pass or fail?

Response

Published in *Materials Evaluation*, May 1978, page 21, is the “ASNT Position Paper on the Use of SNT-TC-1A and the ASNT Level III Certification Program.” Under the heading “Certification Options” is the following:

[The employer can] Incorporate into the written practice acceptance of ASNT Level III certification as permitted in 9.4 of SNT-TC-1A for meeting any or all examination requirements of 8.5.3 (General, Specific, and Practical) and assigning grading weight factors based on satisfactory performance, in accordance with 8.6.3 and 8.6.4.

Inquiry 77-10

What is the intent regarding employers’ attempts to verify an individual’s experience and performance with past employers in order to maintain the documentation recommended in Paragraph 9.6.1?

Response

The specific documentation to be furnished by new employees and past employers and the means for obtaining documentation is referenced in Paragraphs 9.6 and 10.2 of SNT-TC-1A. Details should be included in the employer’s written practice.

General Comments

As published above and in *Materials Evaluation*, October 1977, in response to Inquiry 77-4, “If documentation was not produced during... prior experience, an affidavit or other suitable testimony regarding such experience may be evaluated by the employer...” While Inquiry 77-4 was related to a somewhat different matter, the intent behind the response applies equally to this inquiry (77-10).

Inquiry 77-12

1. Is it intended that an employer may use more than one outside agency for providing Level III services?
2. Is it intended that an employer may use Level III individuals in their direct employment and also use an outside agency for Level III services?
3. Is it intended that certification examinations may be administered without direct supervision and monitoring?

Response

1. There is no intent to restrict the number of outside agencies from which an employer could use Level III services.
2. Yes, both the above and this situation may be used under circumstances as described in the employer's written practice.
3. It is not intended that unsupervised examinations be administered.

Inquiry 77-13

Regarding Paragraph 8.5.3(a) of SNT-TC-1A, is it intended that the "30 questions from the NDT Level II questions for other applicable NDT methods" be selected from and represent every test discipline listed in Paragraph 8.5.2?

Response

No, it is intended that the examiner select the questions applicable or appropriate to the product requirements of the particular case. This is a specific recommendation for examining Level IIIs and in no manner conflicts with the Level III qualifications of Paragraph 4.3(c) of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 78-1

If a Level II examination is administered to a Level I individual, is there a need, when that individual is eligible for Level II certification, to readminister the same Level II examination provided that all other criteria, for example, education, training and experience, have been satisfied?

Response

It is not intended that the individual should be reexamined, provided the original Level II examination was passed and all applicable requirements of the employer's written practice have been met according to Paragraph 8.1 of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 78-2

See Inquiry 77-6, as published above and in *Materials Evaluation*, October 1977. In order to clarify the response, is it intended that Level I, II, and III individuals who have been certified to the recommendation of the 1968 edition automatically meet the recommendations for certification in the 1975 edition?

Since the training hours were increased in the 1975 edition for certain level and discipline combinations above those recommended in the 1968 edition, is additional training and reexamination required to upgrade these individuals?

Response

It is the intent that individuals certified in accordance with the recommendations of the 1968 edition can be automatically certified to the recommendations of the 1975 edition without additional training or experience. For recertification, it is intended that individuals should meet the guidelines of the 1975 edition as reflected in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 78-3

With reference to the note in Table 6.2.1A, "Credit for experience may be gained simultaneously in two or more disciplines. The candidate must spend at least 25% of the work time on each discipline for which experience is being claimed," is it intended that an individual being qualified in only one method could obtain the work time experience in 25% of the times tabulated in Table 6.2.1A?

Response

No, individuals being qualified in only one method should spend at least 25% of their work time in that method and should obtain the total work time experience as recommended in consecutive months as though the remainder of their work time was spent in qualifying for other NDT methods simultaneously.

Inquiry 78-4

1. Regarding Paragraph 10.2 of SNT-TC-1A, does "... based on examination..." refer to examinations administered during prior employment, or does it refer to new examinations to be administered by the new employer?
2. An individual can provide evidence of prior certification per Paragraph 10.2(a) but does not meet either Paragraphs 10.2(b) or 10.2(c) which recommend that the individual was working in the capacity to which they had been certified and is being recertified within six months of termination. What should be the basis of qualification for such an individual?

Response

1. It is intended that the examination referred to in Paragraph 10.2 be administered by the new employer.
2. It is intended that an individual who has neither worked in the capacity to which previously certified in the past six months nor is being recertified within six months should have additional training and experience prior to recertification. The employer's written practice should detail such provisions.

Inquiry 78-6

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A to recommend that the percented weight factors of Paragraph 8.6.3 may be applied based upon differing job requirements of individual candidates or should they be applied equally to all individuals within a particular level?

Response

Percentile weight factors should be within the ranges shown in SNT-TC-1A, Paragraph 8.6.3. The specific percentile weight factors used should be clearly stated in the employer's written practice and should be based on the particular needs of the employer. The same weight factors should be used uniformly for all the employer's personnel seeking certification for given job requirements. However, the employer may change or modify the weight factors for different job requirements within a single level provided they remain within the ranges recommended in Paragraph 8.6.3.

Inquiry 78-7

1. Should personnel who operate digital thickness measurement equipment be qualified and certified?
2. To what level should such personnel be certified?
3. Does ASNT anticipate a change in SNT-TC-1A that would provide specific recommendations for qualifying and certifying such personnel?

Response

1. Whether any NDT personnel should be certified depends solely upon the needs of the employer and the requirements of the employer's customers or clientele.
2. Likewise, the level to which personnel should be certified depends upon the same factors as in [1.] above. Note that Paragraph 4.1 of SNT-TC-1A provides for subdivision within the levels as needed.
3. Paragraph 1.4 and Paragraph 4.1 of SNT-TC-1A are intended to provide the employer with adequate flexibility to accommodate

a variety of special needs as documented in the written practice. While the recommended training course outline of SNT-TC-1A does not specifically address digital thickness measurement, the principles of pulse-echo techniques are those involved. The training course outline does not provide for instruction in the employer's Specific equipment uses and, as with the remainder of SNT-TC-1A, the training course outline should be modified, if necessary, to meet employers' specific needs.

Inquiry 78-9

Is it intended that personnel currently certified as NDT Level III within the guidelines of SNT-TC-1A who also regularly perform Level II functions be qualified as recommended in Paragraphs 8.2, 8.5.2, 8.6 and 9.7?

Response

It is the opinion of the Interpretation Panel that personnel currently certified as Level III may regularly perform Level II functions without specifically being qualified as Level II as recommended in Paragraph 8.2, 8.5.2 and 8.6 of SNT-TC-1A. However, as recommended in Paragraph 9.7, all levels should be periodically recertified.

General Comments

Implicit in the definitions of Levels I, II, and III as outlined in Paragraphs 4.3(a), 4.3(b) and 4.3(c) is the concept that the qualifications for Level III equal and exceed those of Level II. The employer must be satisfied with the proficiency of any individual at any level to handle work tasks. SNT-TC-1A is not intended for use to determine an individual's proficiency. It is intended as a guideline to establish qualifications.

Inquiry 78-10

1. When an employee returns to work for a former employer where previously certified, may the employee's certification(s) be reinstated without examination if the provisions of Paragraphs 10.2(b) and 10.2(c) are met?
2. If an employee has been continuously working for another employer certified in the same capacities, may the certification(s) be reinstated for the remainder of the original three-year period of certification in accordance with Paragraph 9.7?

Response

1. The provisions of Paragraph 10.2 apply only to a new employer. For this part of the inquiry, the provisions of Paragraph 9.7.3 would prevail.
2. For this part of the inquiry, the receiving employer would be considered a new employer and the provisions of Paragraph 10.2 would apply. If, however, the employee in question was previously employed by the receiving employer, Paragraph 9.7.3 would prevail.

General Comments

The principle behind "evidence of continuing satisfactory performance" in Paragraph 9.7.1(a) applies to employees originally certified by, and in continuous employment of, one employer. It is not envisioned that a new employer should prudently accept "evidence of continuing satisfactory performance" from a previous employer. Note that Paragraph 10.2 recommends recertification by examination of an employee by a new employer even if the conditions of 10.2(a), 10.2(b) and 10.2(c) are met to the new employer's satisfaction. The employer's rules covering the duration of interrupted service (Paragraph 9.7.3) should bear a reasonable relationship to the recommendations

in Paragraph 10.2. However, in the case of interrupted service, the employer has direct knowledge of the employee's prior performance and can best judge the need for reexamination as a function of duration of interrupted service.

Inquiry 78-11

1. Regarding Paragraph 8.2(a1) of SNT-TC-1A, is it intended that the personnel referred to in the statement, "The examination shall be administered by qualified personnel..." be qualified medical personnel or may a certified Level III person administer the near-distance vision acuity examination when a standard Jaeger test chart is used? It would appear that the qualifications necessary to administer such examinations would only include the capability to read, to identify the Jaeger chart and the appropriate parts thereof and to be able to measure and maintain the 12 in. required reading distance.
2. Regarding Paragraph 8.2(a2), is it intended that the statement, "... as demonstrated by the Practical examinations or test performance," refers to the Practical examination of Paragraph 8.2(d) or does it refer to a special standardized eye test for color vision?

Response

1. It is intended that Level III personnel be allowed to administer the near-distance vision acuity examination using the Jaeger chart. However, if the employer elects to use other methods of vision examination or the employer requires additional physical requirements as referred to in Paragraph 8.2(a3), it may be necessary to use personnel with other specialized qualifications to administer examinations for such additional requirements. The employer should include details of specific physical requirements and the qualifications required of examiners in the written practice.
2. It is intended that the Practical examination referred to in Paragraph 8.2(a2) is that of Paragraph 8.2(d) and that such Practical examination include checkpoints as appropriate to verify that the candidate's color vision capabilities are adequate to satisfy the specific needs imposed by the NDT method in question, the employer's test equipment, procedures, and products.

Inquiry 79-1

In maintaining records, if an individual is working simultaneously in more than one method, should the records reflect the total time spent for each method or should the time be divided proportionately for each of the methods? For example, if an individual spent 50% of the time on ultrasonic testing and 50% of the time on radiographic testing for a period of nine months, should the record show experience in ultrasonic testing of four and one-half months or nine months?

Response

It is intended that the employer's written practice should include details of maintaining records. It is intended that records should reflect the facts of each individual's work time with regard to the amount of time spent on each method and the periods of time during which the work was performed.

Inquiry 79-2

Since NDT Level III General examination questions in some methods are available from ASNT (*Questions and Answers for Qualifying NDT Level III Personnel*, October 1977), is it intended that the Level III questions referred to in Paragraphs 8.4 and 8.5.3(a) be selected from those published by ASNT?

Response

It is intended that the recommended 30 questions devised by the examiner for the appropriate method [Paragraph 8.5.3(a)] be devised or selected as appropriate to the degree required by the employer's written practice. As with all questions and answers provided by ASNT, they are suggested as guidelines and supplied as an aid to employers in preparing examinations. It is intended that the provisions of Paragraph 8.4 be superseded when questions of a character unique to Level III qualifications as delineated in Paragraph 4.3(c) are devised or selected by the employer for use in the Level III General examination. The additional 30 questions from Level II questions for other applicable NDT methods as recommended in Paragraph 8.5.3(a) are intended to be selected from methods other than that for which the candidate is being examined. It is intended that the employer use such questions to determine that the candidate has sufficient knowledge of other NDT methods that might be applicable to the employer's particular circumstances. For example, it could be appropriate that a candidate being examined for Level III qualification in a particular method be required to demonstrate basic knowledge in one or more other methods in order to "designate the particular test method and technique to be used." See Paragraph 4.3(c).

Inquiry 79-4

1. In Paragraph 8.2(a1), reference is made to a "standard Jaeger test chart." Of several reading cards available, which is considered standard?
2. In Paragraph 8.2(a1), the recommended distance for reading Jaeger Number 2 letters is "not less than 12 in. (30.5 cm)." On the reading card currently available from ASNT, the "designated distance in decimeters" for J2 letters is 5 dm or approximately 19.7 in. Is it intended that the near-distance vision acuity requirements be reduced by such a significant factor?

Response

1. The reading card intended to be considered standard is currently available from ASNT and was previously supplied by Bausch & Lomb. Bausch & Lomb no longer supplies such cards, but those bearing the title, *Reading Card (Metric)*, with the notation at the bottom of the card reading, "The above letters are Snellen sizes at the designated distance in decimeters, with Jaeger notations at right," as previously supplied by Bausch & Lomb are equivalent to the card currently available from ASNT. Other cards bearing equivalent type size and body are also intended to be used.
2. The intent in Paragraph 8.2(a1) was to recommend a minimum distance. The employer's written practice should state the near-distance vision acuity requirements for the particular circumstances of the employer.

Inquiry 79-13

If an employee performs NDT to multiple codes, specifications, and acceptance standards, is it necessary to include questions relating to each code, specification or acceptance standard in this Specific examination?

Paragraph 9.6.1(c) requires records of educational background to be included in personnel records. Is information supplied by the employee (i.e., such as a résumé or employment application) satisfactory evidence of educational accomplishments or is conclusive evidence (i.e., such as a copy of a diploma or transcript) required for verification?

Response

It is the intent of Paragraph 8.2(c2) that the Specific examination cover all codes, specifications, and acceptance standards applicable to the employee's activities.

See also Inquiry 77-4 and Inquiry 77-10.

Inquiries 79-14 and 79-15

Is it intended per SNT-TC-1A (1975 edition) that the time spent in a laboratory exercise during a long-term NDT course be considered the only qualifying work time experience?

May the laboratory time be given any credit at all as "work time experience" to satisfy all the requirements in Table 6.2.1A?

Response

It is not intended that laboratory experience in an educational program be directly applied to the work time experience. Laboratory experience is not necessarily applicable to the employer's product or to the specific codes, standards, or specifications in use. However, in recognition of the benefits accruing from laboratory experience, the employer may include such consideration for adjustment to the work experience in their written practice. Should the employer decide to do so, they should thoroughly evaluate the curriculum to determine its applicability.

Inquiry 80-2

In reference to the Practical examination, there are several approaches that may be taken. For example, grades on check points could be given as 1 (correct) or 0 (incorrect) or could be given in a graduated fashion, say 0 to 5, depending on the correctness and efficiency of the application. Which approach is correct? Could a questionnaire for which written answers would be prepared as an alternative method of grading be used?

Response

Please refer to Paragraphs 8.5.1(c) and 9.6.1(f). Either of the proposed grading methods is permissible depending on the needs of the employer. Other approaches may also be taken. The approach which meets the needs of the employer should be described in their written practice and followed for the Practical examination. The last technique proposing a questionnaire for which written answers would be prepared would fall more appropriately under the Specific examination category.

Inquiry 80-3

A candidate spends 50% of their time performing radiography, 25% performing magnetic particle examinations, and the remaining 25% performing liquid penetrant examinations. At the end of a one-month period, assuming a 144-hour month, is Method A or Method B a correct computation of working time experience for certification to a Level I rating?

Method A: The candidate claims work time experience of 144 hours for each of the three methods.

Method B: The candidate claims work time experience of 72, 36, and 36 hours for radiography, magnetic particle, and liquid penetrant, respectively.

Response

These questions have been addressed in Inquiries 76-1, 76-2 and 78-3, which were published above and in *Materials Evaluation* in October 1977 and October 1978. As further clarification, the method described in Method A is that intended by the document. In other words, the examiner may claim full-time for all the NDT methods in which the candidate works simultaneously. It is not intended the candidate claim time for work hours spent in work other than non-destructive testing.

Inquiry 80-4

NDT examiners in our employ who perform examinations using liquid penetrant use only the visible dye, solvent removable, penetrant technique. Since our examiners do not have need to be qualified in the other liquid penetrant techniques, is it permissible to modify the number of general and specific questions as well as the hours of training and work experience to satisfy requirements of SNT-TC-1A for Level I and Level II examiners?

Response

Please refer to Inquiry 76-2, published above and in *Materials Evaluation* in October 1977 and Inquiry 77-13 published above and in *Materials Evaluation* in October 1978. It is the intent that SNT-TC-1A is a recommended practice and that it is a guideline which should be modified by the employer as necessary to meet their particular needs. The employer should determine the needs, determine the necessary qualifications of the examiners to meet those needs, and describe those in their written practice.

Inquiry 80-6

1. How may we qualify supervisory personnel in accordance with SNT-TC-1A? Supervisory personnel would include quality control engineers in plants doing surveillance-type inspection.
2. Table 6.2.1A for SNT-TC-1A provides: "credit for experience may be gained simultaneously in two or more disciplines. The candidate must spend at least 25% of this work time on each discipline for which experience is being claimed." Does this statement mean (as it regards Level I PT) that if the candidate is already a qualified Level I or Level II radiographer, the one-month work experience can be reduced to 44 hours?

Response

1. This inquiry is similar to Inquiry 76-4 which was answered above and in the October 1978 issue of *Materials Evaluation*. It must again be emphasized that SNT-TC-1A is a guideline to aid an employer in certifying their employees and the guidelines combined in that document should be modified to meet the employer needs.
2. It is the intent of this statement that a candidate may take credit for work performed in two methods simultaneously because of the knowledge interchange factor believed to be present in such activities. It is not intended that an examiner certified in one method could at some later time reduce the requirements for certification in another method except as defined in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 80-7

In the NDT Level II Practical examination, 8.5.2(c), is it intended that the NDT Level II candidate demonstrate proficiency in all phases of the NDT operation (i.e., set up, calibration, inspection, and interpretation)?

Response

Yes, it is intended that the Level II demonstrate proficiency in all phases of the operation for which the candidate is being certified. The employer's written practice should define the duties and needed knowledge.

Inquiry 80-8

1. May an employer deviate from the guidelines to meet their specific needs?
2. Is our company's specific written practice acceptable?

Response

1. Yes, in accordance with Paragraph 1.4 of SNT-TC-1A, the employer should modify the guidelines to meet their needs.
2. It is against ASNT policy to judge the applicability of company documents. As a general comment, it is the employer's prerogative to establish their criteria for certification. It is then the customer's prerogative to accept or reject those criteria.

Inquiry 80-9

Is there an acceptable method by which a Level III may be certified by a new employer on the basis of Level III certification examinations administered by the former employer without examination?

Response

As outlined in Paragraph 8.5.4, an employer may waive examination for an NDT Level III based on the candidate's demonstrated and documented ability, achievement, experience and education as defined in Paragraph 4.3(c) and 6.3. However, if the new employer desires that the certification be based on examination, then the employer must reexamine the candidate or obtain copies of the examinations taken by the candidate at the previous employer. This step is necessary to ensure the quality of the examination and to meet the documentation needs of Paragraph 9.6.1(f).

Inquiry 80-12

1. If a candidate does not spend 25% of the time in the method in a given period, e.g., one month, can the candidate accumulate one month's credit over a longer period, e.g., two months and claim one month's experience?
2. What constitutes an NDT-related activity that may be identified in the employer's written practice? What percentage of time may be NDT related?
3. Can work experience prior to and in excess of the Level I requirements be applied to Level II experience requirements?
4. May documented experience at a level equivalent to NDT Level II in a company without a certification program be used by a new employer to fulfill experience requirements for Level II?

Response

1. No, the intent of the note to Table 6.2.1A (6.3.1) is that work time experience claimed for a specific period should be accumulated in that period. For example, to claim one month work time experience, the candidate should spend at least 44 hours (one-fourth of 175) in the method and the remaining work time (75%) of that month in NDT-related activities.
2. As stated in the note to Table 6.3.1 (1980 edition), the employer should define NDT-related activities. It is also intended that all work time experience claimed should be in NDT or its related activities.

3. Note (1) to Table 6.3.1 (1980 edition) and Table 6.2.1A (1975 edition) indicate that the total NDT experience of the candidate may be applied to the requirements for Level II.
4. Yes, provided the experience is documented to the requirements of the new employer's written practice and the candidate passes the necessary examinations.

General Comments

Please note that experience required for Level II includes work at both trainee and Level I levels. Work experience claimed for Level II should meet the experience required at these levels.

Inquiry 80-14

There are certain differences in the 1975 and 1980 editions of SNT-TC-1A. Is it the intent that individuals qualified to the 1975 edition be certified as qualified to the 1980 edition without reexamination (where examinations have been used as the basis for qualification) when an organization chooses to upgrade their written practice to the 1980 edition?

Response

Yes, it is the intent that individuals certified to the 1975 edition, whether by examination or by waiver in accordance with Paragraph 8.5.4 (1975 edition), are automatically certified to the 1980 edition when the employer chooses to upgrade their written practice to the 1980 edition. Subsequent recertifications should be to the guidelines of the later edition.

Inquiry 80-15

What is the definition of "annual" as used in SNT-TC-1A (1980 edition), Paragraph 8.1.1(4), "The examination should be administered on an annual basis"?

Response

The intent of this statement is that the examination should be administered every year with the interval between examinations not to exceed 12 months from the month of the examination.

Inquiry 81-1

Is it the intent of Paragraph 8.2(a2) that individuals demonstrate the capability of distinguishing and differentiating contrast between colors on an annual basis or only upon certification and/or recertification?

Response

The individual should demonstrate this capability upon original certification and upon recertification by Practical examination or work performance. Normally, recertification occurs at three-year intervals.

Inquiry 81-3

The ASNT examinations for Level III are referred to as "General" and "Practical." In the 1980 edition, these are "Basic" and "Method." May I assume this is a change in terminology and that the examinations are equivalent?

Response

The ASNT Level III examinations are titled "Basic" and "Method" as are the designated examinations in SNT-TC-1A (1980 edition). It is intended that the ASNT Level III examinations satisfy the "General" and "Practical" examinations of SNT-TC-1A (1975 edition).

Inquiry 81-5

Do the requirements identified in Table 6.2.1A (1975 edition) include (a) required performance of the test method by personnel for certification or (b) personnel are to be employed where the test method is being utilized?

Response

The intent of SNT-TC-1A is clear. Actual performance of work in the method is required for that time to be claimed as work experience.

Inquiry 81-9

1. May the president of an NDT company appoint themselves as a Level III provided they are qualified?
2. May a Level III qualify NDT personnel for another company?

Response

3. An employer may certify any employee as Level III provided the individual has the qualifications required by the employer's written practice.
4. Yes, a Level III may attest to the qualifications of an individual in another company. However, the individual must be certified by their own employer, not the aforementioned Level III.

Inquiry 81-12

Paragraph 9.6.1(f) (1975 edition) states that qualification records should include "copies of current examinations and of grades for all previous examinations and..." Does the phrase "grades for all previous examinations" imply grades for examinations by the present employer and/or previous employers and outside agencies?

Response

Paragraph 9.6.1(f) (1975 edition) applies to examinations administered by the present employer.

Inquiry 81-13

Does on-the-job training in lieu of classroom training satisfy the requirement for organized training?

Response

Paragraph 7.1 (1980 edition) states that the personnel "should complete sufficient organized training to become thoroughly familiar with the principles and practices of the specified test method..." It is intended that the training be organized into a definite training program although the form of that training is not specified.

Inquiry 81-15

Paragraph 8.1.1.2 states, "The examination should demonstrate the capability of distinguishing and differentiating contrast between colors used in the method." Does the Ishihara color chart satisfy this requirement?

Response

Any means used to determine the individual's capabilities of color differentiation and distinguishing: (1) which actually accomplishes the determination and (2) which is satisfactory to the employer and its customer should fulfill this requirement.

Inquiry 81-16

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that employers may prorate classroom training hour requirements for personnel with an education level between the educational levels defined in the document?

Response

Table 6.3.1 and Paragraph 6.3.2 (1980 edition) prorate classroom training hours based on education levels and experience for Levels I, II, and III certification. Prorating between those specified is a logical progression well within the intent of the 1975 and 1980 editions.

Inquiry 82-1

1. Does Paragraph 4.1 (1975 edition) permit qualification and certification under restrictive conditions, i.e., NDT Level II-R or Level II-S (restricted or surveillance)?
2. Do these subdivided levels referenced in Paragraph 4.1 need to comply with education, training and experience requirements in Paragraph 6 and Table 6.2.1(a)?

Response

1. Paragraph 4.1 permits subdivision of the basic levels of qualification as needed to fit the employer's needs. The scope of these subdivisions may be greater or less than the guidelines of SNT-TC-1A.
2. Education, training and experience guidelines of Paragraph 6 and Table 6.2.1(a) should be modified as appropriate to meet the needs of the subdivisions in accordance with Paragraph 4.1.

Inquiry 82-3

Do the passing grades for Level III examinations of the 1980 edition (i.e., 80% composite and 70% minimum on each examination) satisfy the requirements of the 1975 edition (i.e., 90% and 80%, respectively)?

Response

The passing grades for Level III examinations in the 1975 edition are based on the use of Level II questions. Grades for the 1980 edition are based on the use of Level III questions and are considered to meet the guidelines of the 1975 edition.

Inquiry 82-4

Table 6.3.1 (1980 edition) requires experience in excess of one month in certain circumstances. May credit for one of those multimonth "specific periods" be given if the candidate spends at least 25% of the applicable period in the method and the remaining work time (75%) in that period in NDT-related activities?

Example: Three months' work time experience credited when a total of at least 132 hours are spent in penetrant testing during a three-calendar-month period while the remaining work time experience (75%) in that period is spent in NDT-related activities.

Response

The work time experience guidelines of Table 6.2.1(a) (1975 edition) and Table 6.3.1 (1980 edition) are total, accumulated work time experience levels. In accordance with Inquiry 76-1, the employer's written practice should specify the time period over which simultaneous experience shall be credited.

Inquiry 82-6

SNT-TC-1A (1975 edition), Section 8.5.3(a) states: "General Examination—Thirty questions devised by the examiner for the appropriate method, plus 30 questions from the NDT Level II questions for other applicable NDT methods, are to be answered."

1. For each NDT method, must each Level III General examination contain a minimum of 60 questions?
2. If Level III General examinations are administered in more than one method, is it permissible to not include the 30 Level II questions from other methods (i.e., General examinations consist of only 30 questions in method under consideration) and assume that the requirements of Section 8.5.3(a) have been satisfied?

Response

Paragraph 8.5.3 (1975 edition) states that each General examination should comprise 60 questions, 30 for the appropriate method and 30 NDT Level II questions for other applicable NDT methods.

Inquiry 82-7

Who within a corporation is the employer as the term is used in SNT-TC-1A?

Response

No one *within* the corporation is the employer. The employer is the corporation as stated in Paragraph 2.1.5: "Employer—The corporate, private or public entity which employs personnel for wages, salary, fees or other considerations." The employer's written practice should designate the Level III responsible for certification of Level I and II individuals and the person responsible for certification of Level III personnel.

Inquiry 83-1

Table 6.3.1 of SNT-TC-1A (1980 edition) specifies work time experience in months. Is it acceptable for the employer's written practice to express this time in hours based on 160 hours per month?

Response

It is allowable for an employer to define the number of hours that constitute a month within their written practice. Whether 160 hours is acceptable is a contractual matter between the employer and customer.

Inquiry 83-2

Has the intent of SNT-TC-1A been satisfied if the employer's written practice states in effect that failure to meet the requirements of Paragraphs 10.2(b) or 10.2(c) will necessitate additional training and/or experience as determined by the Level III examiner?

Response

This panel cannot comment on the adequacy of an individual written practice. However, according to Inquiry 78-4, the written practice should establish the basis for evaluating the amount of additional training and/or experience required by an individual not meeting the requirements of 10.2(b) or 10.2(c).

Inquiry 83-3

Is it the intent of Paragraph 8.1.4.4, SNT-TC-1A (1980 edition) that the individuals demonstrate the capability of distinguishing and differentiating contrast between colors on an annual basis or may this be demonstrated upon recertification?

Response

Per Inquiry 81-1, it is intended that an individual should demonstrate the capability of distinguishing and differentiating contrast between colors upon original certification and upon recertification by Practical examination or work performance.

Inquiry 83-4

1. Can the nominated Level III examiner qualify other possible Level III candidates by examination?
2. Can any Level III examiner, nominated or not by the company, qualify a possible Level III candidate by examination?
3. Are Level III examiners under the grandfathering scheme accepted by ASNT in accordance with SNT-TC-1A?

Response

1. Yes.
2. No, not unless the Level III is nominated by the company and acting as its agent.
3. ASNT makes no differentiation between Level IIIs grandfathered in accordance with the initial ASNT program and those taking the ASNT examinations.

Inquiry 83-5

Is the intent of Paragraphs 8.1.3.2 and 8.3.3.2(c) of SNT-TC-1A (1980 edition) to require recertification of personnel when a new code, specification and/or standard is invoked by the employer?

Response

The Specific examinations should cover the codes, specifications, and standards used by an employer at the time of examination. Immediate recertification of individuals based on the addition of new codes, specifications, or standards would not be required unless deemed necessary by the employer. However, the examinations should be revised to reflect the new materials.

Inquiry 83-6

Does the Ishihara Color Perception Test fulfill the SNT-TC-1A (1980 edition) requirements for the physical examination in Paragraph 3.1.1.2 as applicable to radiographers?

Response

Yes, the Ishihara Color Perception Test is an accepted test to demonstrate the capability of distinguishing and differentiating contrast between colors.

Inquiry 83-7

1. In relation to the SNT-TC-1A definition of an “employer” and Paragraphs 5.1 and 9.1: Is a company in compliance with SNT-TC-1A in certifying NDT personnel to its own written practice when those people are not the employees of the company but are paid their wages by an outside agency that does not have an established written practice?
2. And a related question: With the qualifying practice customarily based on documented past experience, would the previous certifications be valid when the practitioner has moved from site to site, qualifying in accordance with each company’s written practice without having been directly employed, in terms of the SNT-TC-1A definition, by any of them?

Response

1. If the company defines with its written practice the mechanism for certifying the individuals not employed directly by the company, the answer is yes.
2. It is the responsibility of the employer to verify the validity of previously claimed certifications used to determine an individual’s experience in accordance with the employer’s written practice.

Inquiry 83-8

We desire to have a member of management for our NDT Level III who, by virtue of their job duties, will not have worked as a Level II. Clarification is needed relative to SNT-TC-1A (1980 edition), Paragraph 6.3.2.1, 6.3.2.2, or 6.3.2.3. The employee may also not have any previous experience in the particular discipline. The questions are:

1. How can a person become a Level III if they have not had a Level II assignment?
2. What types of other experiences could be counted for the Level II requirements?

Response

1. An individual may be given credit for work assignments comparable to that of an NDT Level II in the applicable test method.
2. The types of work assignments comparable to the Level II assignments should be defined by the employer in the written practice.

Inquiry 83-9

Enclosed please find the cover sheets for materials that are used in our self-training program. Please advise if these materials are acceptable by ASNT as a home-study course.

Response

ASNT neither accepts nor rejects training course materials. The acceptability of any training course is a contractual decision between the parties involved.

Inquiry 83-10*

Please interpret the 25% rule for a trainee in one method who is also performing NDT in a method for which the trainee is already qualified and certified.

Response

Note (2) of Table 6.3.1 in the 1980 edition of SNT-TC-1A applies only to initial simultaneous certification in two or more methods. Inquiry 78-3 states that an individual seeking certification in only one method must meet the total work experience hour requirement for that method even if any other work performed by an individual is NDT-related. Therefore, based upon the above information, an individual seeking to be certified and/or upgraded in only one method must meet the total experience hour requirement shown for that method in the employer’s written practice.

***Withdrawn in June 1990. See Inquiry 89-3.**

Inquiry 83-11

1. Is it the intent of Paragraph 8.3.3 of the 1980 edition of SNT-TC-1A that an individual who is certified NDT Level III in the RT method by examination including a Basic, Method and Specific test needs to be administered only the Method and Specific tests when being certified for NDT Level III in the UT method?
2. Is it the intent of Paragraph 8.4.2 that a separate weighting schedule may be utilized that provides greater weighting values for the Method and Specific tests, for the situation described in [1.] above, than are used when the individual is administered Basic, Method and Specific tests for NDT Level III certification?

Response

1. Yes.
2. Paragraph 8.4.2 requires the employer to establish weight factors or to use simple average grades that are uniformly applied to all individuals taking the same test. If your written practice does this, it is within the intent of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 84-1

1. Considering the responses in ASNT Inquiry 77-1, 78-2 and 80-14 regarding recertification, it appears that the correct interpretation of SNT-TC-1A should be that the edition applicable to certification by examination should be the edition in effect at the time of examination. Is this interpretation correct?
2. Is it consistent with the intent of SNT-TC-1A that an employer's procedure for certification by examination contain wording that the "applicable year of issue (of SNT-TC-1A) will be the latest in effect at the time of examination"?

Response

1. Yes. Any or all of the editions could be referenced in the employer's written practice, depending on the specifications or codes to which the employer must conform in their business.
2. The key word in this question is "consistent." If "consistent" is intended to mean "compatible," the answer is yes. If the definition of "consistent" is taken to mean "holding always to the same principles or practice," then the answer is that SNT-TC-1A does not prohibit such application of reference in an employer's written practice. Clearly, the tests and examinations used by the employer for certification must reflect the editions referenced in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 84-2 and Inquiry 85-5

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A to allow a Level I NDT person to perform, evaluate and accept or reject an NDT examination in accordance with written procedures and acceptance standards without the presence of a Level II NDT person at the time of evaluation or interpretation?

Response

A Level I individual may perform the functions as inquired only if the written procedure and acceptance standards are in the form of a written instruction applicable to a specific calibration, specific test, and Specific evaluation. The written instruction must be sufficiently specific and complete to ensure that the Level I individual can make a clear determination for acceptance. The written instruction shall not permit the Level I individual to interpret any aspect of the procedure and standards not specifically defined in the written instruction.

Inquiry 84-3

If an employee has met the training and experience requirements for a higher level of certification with a former employer but was not certified to that level, may a new employer certify the person to that higher level without additional training or experience if all requirements of 10.2 have been met?

Response

Yes, provided the training and experience are specifically applicable to the new employer's requirements, are documented to the requirements of the new employer's written practice and the candidate passes the necessary examinations. Reference Inquiry 80-12.4.

Inquiry 84-4

1. Can home-study (correspondence) courses allow one to meet the training requirements of SNT-TC-1A? Would the course better meet SNT-TC-1A if it included quizzes which were mailed back to the responsible "Level III agency" for evaluation, allowing the agency to offer direction to the participant?
2. How many hours credit for training received would the participant be given? Would this be determined by the authors of the course?

Response

1. Yes. A home-study or correspondence course may be used toward satisfaction of SNT-TC-1A recommended training provided it is organized as a course with sufficient quizzes to assure an understanding of the material and that it is specifically described in the employer's written practice. Quizzes associated with a home-study or correspondence course may be used toward compliance with Paragraph 7 to insure comprehension of training information, but not toward compliance with Section 8, Examinations.
2. The credit hours should be determined by the Level III responsible for the course as reflected in the employer's written procedure.

Inquiry 85-1

May the recommended experience for a given method and/or level be reduced for a candidate having experience and certification in another examination method?

Response

No. Table 6.3.1 (1980 edition) notes (1) and (2) relate to NDT-related activities. Also see Section 3 and Section 6.

Inquiry 85-2

We request you to clarify whether a person qualified as per the 1975 edition and renewed once in three years is required to be requalified by conducting Specific examination as per the 1984 edition. We interpret that the 1984 edition is applicable for the personnel taking a qualifying examination for the first time and the qualification of the persons qualified prior to August 1984 is not affected.

Response

Inquiries 77-1, 77-6, 78-2 and 80-14 established the precedent in principle that an individual once certified need not establish a new certification upon publication of a revised edition of SNT-TC-1A. This interpretation is applicable to the publication of all editions of SNT-TC-1A, past and present and to future editions provided that future editions contain no provisions to the contrary.

Inquiry 85-3*

1. Paragraph 6.2.1 (1975 edition) states, "The experience factor in months is based on a normal 40-hour work week (175 per month)." Is it intended that the individual document eight hours per day for a full calendar month to obtain the 175 hours?
2. May an individual be certified to Level I in the MT method after working one to three hours per day every day for one month while also performing regular duties as a Level II in the PT method?
3. May time spent in formal training beyond minimum requirements be applied to experience?

Response

1. No. See Inquiry 80-12: The employer's written practice should specify the time period over which simultaneous experience should be credited. See also Inquiry 76-1.
2. Yes, if the working hours in the MT method in the month total 44 or more and all other requirements for certification are satisfied.
***Withdrawn in June 1990. See Inquiry 89-3.**
3. No. It is not intended that formal classroom training in excess of minimum requirements be substituted for experience. Hours spent in hands-on examination in excess of minimum training requirements may be counted toward experience when that provision is contained in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 85-4

1. Can an employer, acting as the certifying agency, certify a Level III individual to SNT-TC-1A criteria if that individual is a self-employed consultant?
2. If so, what method of certification should be used and what objective evidence should be available?

Response

1. Yes. A self-employed consultant qualifies as an employee within the intent of 2.1.5 and 2.1.7.
2. The employer's written practice should describe a method of certification in accordance with the provisions of SNT-TC-1A. The objective evidence should be as described in the employer's written practice and should include evidence of education, training, experience and appropriate examinations.

Inquiry 85-5

See Inquiry 84-2.

Inquiry 85-6

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that qualification requirements such as visual acuity, color vision and sufficient work experience be completed before the examination date and that the examination date be used as the final certification date in lieu of the employer establishing the certification date based on all qualifications being met regardless of the final order of completion?

Response

SNT-TC-1A does not recommend a sequence for completing the various requirements for certification. The employer's written practice shall cover all phases of certification, but the written practice need not specify the sequence in which requirements are completed. The certification date may not be based on completion of an individual requirement, such as an examination, but must be concurrent with or subsequent to the date of completion of all requirements for certification.

Inquiry 85-7

A question has arisen with regard to the validity of "Level III certification by appointment" in the case of the owner of a company certifying himself.

Response

See Inquiry 81-9.1: An employer may certify any employee as Level III provided the individual has the qualifications required by the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 85-8

Paragraph 8.6.3(C-2) of SNT-TC-1A (1975 edition) requires a percentile weight factor 0.4 to 0.6 for Specific-Practical NDT Level III examination grades. Is it acceptable to interpret this paragraph as follows?

Examination	Weight Factor
General	0.5 Wg
Specific	0.5 Ws
Practical	N/A Wp

Response

In strict conformance with the recommendations contained in the SNT-TC-1A (1975 edition), the following apply to Level III examination and certification: 8.5.3(c) Practical Examination Proficiency shall be demonstrated in selecting, specifying, and writing specifications and/or procedures for the performance of the applicable nondestructive tests using appropriate reference material.

8.6.3(c) NDT Level III Examination Grades:

General	0.4 to 0.6
Specific-Practical	0.4 to 0.6

Therefore, in strict conformance with SNT-TC-1A (1975 edition), a Practical examination is required. Together with Specific examination, the grades may constitute from 0.4 to 0.6 percentile weight factor. There is no recommended distribution for weight factors between the Specific and Practical examination. The employer may choose any distribution. The response to Inquiry 78-6 states with regard to 8.6.3, "The specific percentile weight factors used should be clearly stated in the employer's written practice and should be based on the particular needs of the employer."

Paragraph 9.3 of the SNT-TC-1A (1975 edition) provides that certification shall be based on Paragraphs 6, 7 and 8 but permits modification of those requirements by the employer's written practice. Therefore, the ultimate response to the inquiry will be determined by the basis of the content of the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 85-9

1. Can the personnel already approved by the 1980 edition conduct the test of both eddy current testing and magnetic leakage flux testing without any additional education and/or qualification test?
2. If not, can the personnel already approved by the 1980 edition conduct the testing of only the eddy current test? Is qualification based on the 1980 edition effective only concerning the eddy current test? If it is effective, is it necessary that the personnel already approved by either the 1980 edition or the 1984 edition be identified respectively?

Response

1. To be qualified and certified in the magnetic flux leakage method, personnel shall receive additional education and a qualification examination in accordance with SNT-TC-1A.
2. Personnel certified in the eddy current method in accordance with SNT-TC-1A (1980 edition) are qualified to perform only the eddy current method. The certification record for an individual should indicate the edition of SNT-TC-1A applicable at the time of examination.

Inquiry 86-1

If an inspector has been given an eye examination and found to have a red/green color deficiency, can the inspector be qualified to perform magnetic particle testing and liquid penetrant testing providing the following color test is administered by a Level III?

1. Magnetic particle: a test shall be conducted using welds with known discontinuities to assure their detection. A second test of production welds shall be given to evaluate the inspector's ability to distinguish between relevant and nonrelevant indications. The inspector's certification shall be restricted to using only those colors used in the above tests, such as black powder, gray powder and/or orange powder.
2. Liquid penetrant: a test shall be conducted using welds with known discontinuities to assure their detection. A second test of production welds shall be given to evaluate the inspector's ability to distinguish between relevant and irrelevant indications.

Response

The color vision examinations described are in compliance with the intent of the SNT-TC-1A (1980 edition), Paragraph 8.1.1.2 as well as the same paragraph of the 1984 edition and Paragraph 8.2(a2) of the 1975 edition and with prior Inquiry 78-11.2 and Inquiry 81-15. The examinations should be documented in the written practice required by Section 5 of those editions.

Inquiry 86-2

May a Level II as per ASNT guidelines SNT-TC-1A legally inspect, for example, the lifting devices of an industrial plant without a written procedure and a report of approval of an ASNT Level III?

Response

The question of whether or not compliance with any provision of SNT-TC-1A is legally necessary is beyond the scope of SNT-TC-1A and must be determined in the laws, codes, and standards applicable to the facility of material being inspected. In situations where SNT-TC-1A is applicable, an NDT Level II may interpret and evaluate results with respect to the applicable codes, standards, and specifications and may report the results, as provided in 4.3.2. While it is good practice to perform all NDT in accordance with a written procedure, SNT-TC-1A only prescribes written documents for the control and administration of NDT personnel training, examination, and certification. See Paragraph 5.1. It does not prescribe that there exist a written procedure applicable to each examination performed. The participation of ASNT Level III is not a requirement under any aspect of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 86-3

Regarding the need for reexamination of a Level II technician on changing employers, it is our belief that provided that evidence exists of an examination to SNT-TC-1A rules, the new employer may recertify the technician to the previously attained level providing the employer is satisfied that the technician meets the other conditions set by ASNT, regarding period of employment and date of recertification.

Response

Inquiry 78-4.1 and Inquiry 80-9 established the precedent that the examination referred to in Paragraph 10.2 be administered by the "new" employer or obtain copies of the examinations taken by the

candidate at the previous employer. This step is necessary to ensure the quality of the examinations and to meet the documentation needs of Paragraph 9.6.1.6.

Inquiry 86-5

1. It is, of course, clear from SNT-TC-1A that a company can use an external Level III authority to conduct Level I and Level II examinations and to underwrite its own certification procedures. I have always assumed that this Level III authority should be officially certified by ASNT and their name would therefore appear on a current list of such persons, issued annually by ASNT. Is this correct?
2. It is also possible for a company to certify its own internal Level III authority "with or without an examination" provided it meets other requirements of SNT-TC-1A and of its own written practice. If an examination is administered, I have assumed that it should at least be carried out by an external authority certified at Level III by ASNT. Is this a true assumption?
3. If an individual is "internally" certified as a Level III in Company A, can that individual act as an "external" Level III authority for Company B and administer exams for Level I and II personnel in Company B?

Response

1. No, as established by a precedent of Inquiry 86-2, though on a slightly different subject. "The participation of ASNT Level III (i.e., a holder of a valid ASNT Level III certificate) is not a requirement under any aspect of SNT-TC-1A." The employer's written practice should specify the requirements.
2. No. See Inquiry 85-7.
3. Considering the response to Inquiry 81-9.2 and Inquiry 83-4.1 and 83-4.2, the answer is yes, provided the Level III is acting as Company B's agent.

Inquiry 86-7

It is requested that clarification be provided regarding whether an individual qualified in accordance with the 1984 edition is also qualified in accordance with previous editions of SNT-TC-1A, as referred by the *ASME Boiler & Pressure Vessel Code*.

Response

Inquiry 85-2 established the precedent that an individual once certified need not recertify to another edition of SNT-TC-1A. However, as addressed in Inquiry 84-1, "Any or all editions [of SNT-TC-1A] could be referenced in the employer's written practice," depending upon the specification or code referencing SNT-TC-1A to interpret what is required. If the individual is certified to the latest edition of SNT-TC-1A, they are also considered to meet the recommendations of earlier editions.

Inquiry 87-1

In accordance with the intent of SNT-TC-1A (1975, 1980, and 1984 editions), is it acceptable to allow credit toward RT Level I qualification and certification for RT work time experience which has been acquired while working as a trainee with and under the direct supervision of certified Level I RT technicians who have met all federal and/or agreement state requirements for qualifications and designation as industrial radiographers?

Response

Yes, provided the Level I receives the necessary instructions or supervision from a certified Level II or III individual. See Paragraph 4.3.1. Paragraph 4.2 of the 1975, 1980 and 1984 editions of SNT-TC-1A states, "A trainee should work with a 'certified' individual..." This certified individual may be a Level I, II or III. Also, per Paragraph 4.3.2, "The NDT Level II... should exercise assigned responsibility for on-the-job training and guidance of trainees and NDT Level I personnel." The employer's written practice should detail the requirements for the trainee's work time experience. The certified Level I RT technician who has met federal and/or agreement state requirements as an industrial radiographer is outside the scope of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 87-2

Does ASNT consider it "acceptable" for an NDT training school to hold a "written practice" and train, examine and certify individuals to that written practice?

Response

No, unless the certified employee is a bona fide employee of the educational institution. SNT-TC-1A, Paragraph 1.3 states, "These guidelines have been developed... to aid employers in recognizing the essential factors to be considered in qualifying employees..." Paragraph 2.1.5 defines employer as: "The corporate, private or public entity which employs personnel for wages, salary, fees or other considerations." An educational institution can serve as an "employer" and, as addressed in Paragraph 5.1, establish a "written practice." The employer's written practice should address the basis for qualification and certification.

Inquiry 87-3

Paragraph 6.0 of SNT-TC-1A (1985 edition) establishes recommendations with respect to education, training and experience pursuant to initial qualification. Table 6.3.1 lists recommended training and experience pertaining to Level I and Level II. The 25% rule is found in Note 3 to this table, but not elsewhere in SNT-TC-1A.

1. What percent of a candidate's time is intended to be required (in the same sense that the word "required" is used in the heading of Paragraph 6 of SNT-TC-1A) as a qualifier of experience pursuant to Level III certification?
2. Should maintenance of a valid Level II certification over the required qualifying time be considered to satisfy Paragraph 6.3.2 of SNT-TC-1A without computation or criteria regarding the percent of time spent working in the method?

Response

1. It is intended that 100% of the experience time specified in Paragraphs 6.3.2.1 or 6.3.2.2 or 6.3.2.3 be met in each applicable test method. The 25% rule of Note 3 in Table 6.3.1 is not intended to apply to 6.3.2. Note, however, as stated in Paragraph 6.3.2, "When the individual is qualified by examination, the above requirements may be partially replaced by experience as a certified NDT Level II, or in assignments at least comparable to NDT Level II, in other methods... as defined in the employer's written practice." The employer's written practice should specify the requirements.
2. No. The intent of the experience requirement of Paragraph 6.3.2 is that the candidate should be actively working and acquiring

progressive experience in the methods for which certification is sought. Just "maintaining" a valid certification does not meet this intent. The employer's written practice should specify the requirements regarding qualifying work time experience.

Inquiry 87-4

A candidate has met the "established and published" requirements for certification as Level III by a group other than ASNT. The scores were graded to the requirements of MIL-STD-410 and SNT-TC-1A. Although not certified by ASNT, could scores based on SNT-TC-1A requirements be acceptable by a contracting agency as equivalent to ASNT certification, if all other requirements are met?

Response

As stated in SNT-TC-1A, Paragraph 9.1, "Certification of all levels of NDT personnel is the responsibility of the employer." Whether a contracting agency accepts the scores as being equivalent to ASNT is solely up to the employer's contracting agency. ASNT's position is that there is no "equivalent" to ASNT Level III certification.

Inquiry 87-5

A Level II is terminated from Company A and is employed by Company B as a trainee. Eight months after termination, Company B certifies the employee to Level II.

1. May an employee working at a lower NDT level be upgraded to their former NDT level without retraining?
2. When certifying personnel in accordance with Paragraph 9.3, may training and experience documented by a former employer be considered in satisfying the criteria of Paragraph 6.3?

Response

1. Inquiry 84-3 established the precedent that once an individual has met the certifying employer's required training, even if the training were attained while working for another employer, it is not necessary to repeat the training. Based on this, the trainee could be certified to the former level. However, this assumes that all of the certifying employer's written practice requirements are satisfied. It should further be noted that based on Paragraph 10.2.3 of SNT-TC-1A (which requires recertification within six months of termination), certification eight months after termination does not comply with the stated conditions. The employer's written practice should address this matter.
2. Yes. See Inquiry 80-12.4 and Inquiry 84.3.

Inquiry 87-6

Is it intended that an individual with a four-year degree in NDT or any four-year scientific degree from an accredited college and three years as a certified Level II, who has not been performing NDT examinations on a daily basis in the particular method they are seeking Level III qualifications, but has been actively involved in the day-to-day technical operations of a major NDT organization, i.e., calibration block development, procedure writing (in the method which they are seeking Level III) and involvement in other NDT

operations in the organization, be required to spend 25% of the preceding 12 months involved in the particular method in which they are seeking qualifications as Level III?

Response

See Inquiry 87-3.

Inquiry 88-1

1. In accordance with the intent of SNT-TC-1A (1975, 1980 and 1984 editions), may an employer prepare a written practice which permits Level III leak test qualification and certification in three, two or even one of the four leak testing techniques identified in Table 6.3.1 of SNT-TC-1A?
2. When a limited Level III leak test certification in three, two or even one of the four leak testing techniques is intended, may the questions used in the Level III Method and Specific examination be selected primarily or even exclusively for the leak testing techniques for which the limited certification will apply?

Response

1. Yes. Inquiry 82-1 established the precedent: (a) Paragraph 4.1 (1975 edition) permits subdivision of the basic levels of qualification as needed to fit the employer's needs; the scope of these subdivisions may be greater or less than the guidelines of SNT-TC-1A; and (b) education, training and experience guidelines of Paragraph 6 and Table 6.2.1(a) should be modified to meet the needs of the subdivisions in accordance with Paragraph 4.1. Note: Table 6.2.1(a) in the 1975 edition was renumbered as Table 6.3.1 in the 1980 edition. Paragraph 4.1 was revised also in the 1980 edition. However, the intent has remained consistent in all three editions.
2. Yes. Paragraph 4.1 permits the subdivision of the basic levels of qualifications as needed to fit the employer's needs; thus, it would be considered appropriate to select Method examination questions specifically for the particular leak testing techniques for which a limited certification is being sought. For basic examinations, other techniques of leak testing, as well as other nondestructive test methods should be covered in accordance with Paragraph 8.3.3.1(e).

Inquiry 88-2

When the recommendations of SNT-TC-1A (1975 through 1984 editions) have been made mandatory requirements in the employer's written practice, as is often required by other agencies, and when personnel have been certified by a new employer under SNT-TC-1A Paragraph 10.2, what records must the new employer obtain to satisfy himself that the requirements of 10.2 have been met?

Response

Response to Inquiry 77-10 states: "The specific documentation to be furnished by new employees and past employers and the means for obtaining documentation is referenced in Paragraphs 9.6 and 10.2 of SNT-TC-1A. Details should be included in the employer's written practice."

Paragraph 1.2 of SNT-TC-1A identifies the fact that the document (SNT-TC-1A) provides guidelines for the establishment of a qualification and certification program. If an employer's written practice is made mandatory by another agency, it is ASNT's position that the extent of compliance to Paragraphs 9.6 and 10.2 must be addressed in the employer's written practice to the degree necessary to satisfy that agency.

Inquiry 89-1

1. Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that Specific examination questions about specifications, codes, and acceptance criteria be limited to those used during specific assignments?
2. Do Specific examination questions that are designed to demonstrate an applicant's ability to comprehend and utilize specifications, codes, and acceptance criteria similar to those used by an employer in their nondestructive testing procedure—but are not directly applicable to the procedures used for specific assignments—meet the intent of SNT-TC-1A?
3. Do Specific examination questions that are designed to demonstrate an applicant's ability to comprehend and utilize specifications, codes, and acceptance criteria similar to those used by an employer in their nondestructive testing procedure—but are formulated in such a manner that every question in the Specific examination may be answered directly by reviewing the reference material (NDT procedure, charts, graphs, etc.) provided by the employer's Level III examiner—meet the recommendation of SNT-TC-1A for closed-book written examinations?

Response

1. No. This is a minimum. Other specifications may be covered at the employer's option.
2. No. Specifications used by the employer should be covered as a minimum. Other specifications may be included at the employer's option.
3. No. Questions which can be answered directly from necessary data, such as graphs, tables, specifications, procedures, codes, etc., may demonstrate an ability to utilize the material but do not demonstrate an appropriate knowledge of the equipment, operating procedures and NDT techniques that the individual may encounter.

Inquiry 89-2

If Specific examination questions are taken directly from the data provided, such as applicable procedures or codes, does this meet the implied definition of a "closed-book" examination, assuming all questions were selected and approved by the responsible Level III?

Response

No. See Inquiry 89-1.3 and Inquiry 77-5.

General Comments

The term "closed book" in Paragraphs 8.5, 8.3, 8.3 and 8.7 of the 1975, 1980, 1984 and the 1988 editions (respectively) of SNT-TC-1A should be interpreted with the degree of flexibility needed to make it fit the employer's situation, as required by Paragraph 1.4 of SNT-TC-1A.

The intent of SNT-TC-1A examinations is to determine that the candidate is capable of correctly applying the necessary information to real testing situations.

Furthermore, it is generally considered good practice for personnel to refer to the applicable graphs, tables, codes, and standards while conducting tests in order to reduce the potential for error. For an employer who uses such good practices, it would be unreasonable and inconsistent with the intent of SNT-TC-1A to give examinations without allowing the use of pertinent reference material when this reference material is provided by the designated examiner.

However, when use of reference material with an examination is permitted, the examination questions should require the exercise of judgment, analysis or computation to the degree needed to demonstrate the candidate's ability to deal satisfactorily with real testing situations. It would not meet the intent of SNT-TC-1A if the examination could be passed by simply finding, in the reference material, the correct piece of data or the particular sentence needed to answer the questions.

Inquiry 89-3*

Based on a review of published inquiries in the 1988 Redi-Reference Guide (*Materials Evaluation*, Vol. 46, No. 2), there appears to be a conflict and an open item related to Inquiry 83-10 and Inquiry 85-3.2.

Inquiry 83-10 restated: "Please interpret the 25% rule for a trainee in one method who is also performing NDT in a method for which they are already qualified and certified."

***Withdrawn by interpretation panel action (June 1990).**

Inquiry 85-3.2 restated: "May an individual be certified to Level I in the MT method after working one to three hours per day every day for one month while also performing regular duties as a Level II in the PT method?"

***Withdrawn by interpretation panel action (June 1990).**

Response

(Reconsideration of Inquiry 83-10)

The intent is that a full-time inspector working in more than one method may simultaneously receive full-time experience credit for all methods in which the inspector is pursuing certification if at least 25% of the work time is spent in each method for which the inspector is claiming credit. The remainder of the work time must be spent in other NDT or NDT-related activities, as a trainee or as a certified inspector and as defined in the employer's written practice. Example: A PT Level II, with no UT experience, begins to accumulate experience toward UT qualification with the goal of becoming a UT Level II. The inspector works 25% of the time in UT and the remainder in PT. Under these conditions, the inspector would have the necessary experience to qualify as a UT Level I after three months elapsed time and as a UT Level II after nine additional months elapsed time if the employer's written practice added no further requirements in addition to those in SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 89-4

In the 1968, 1975, 1980 and 1984 editions of SNT-TC-1A, an employer may waive examinations for the Level III and thereby "certify" the individual by appointment.

There is no such provision in the 1988 edition. However, it is implied by the statement in Paragraph 6.3.2: "When the individual (Level III) is qualified by examination..."

May the employer waive examination for the Level III and be in compliance with the intent of SNT-TC-1A (1988 edition)?

Response

It is intended by the 1988 edition of SNT-TC-1A that all Level IIIs initially certified after issuance of the 1988 edition of SNT-TC-1A be qualified by examination.

Also see Inquiry 90-2 and Inquiry 92-2.

Inquiry 89-5

1. Because Level III personnel primarily interpret codes and specifications and Level II personnel generally follow approved procedures, shouldn't Level III Specific examinations consist mostly of questions that test the candidate's ability to interpret codes and specifications rather than procedures which the candidate, in fact, may have written?
2. Should the Level II Specific examination deal more with the requirements and acceptance criteria contained in the procedures which will be used by the candidate rather than questions from codes and specifications from which the procedures are developed?

Response

1. No. This is a matter which should be detailed in the employer's written practice. The examination should include questions that test the candidate's knowledge of procedures, as well as questions related to equipment and techniques applicable to the employer's product and methods, to the administration of the employer's written practice and to codes, specifications, and standards directly applicable to the employer's activities. Questions related to the ability to interpret codes, standards, and specifications generally related to method (not specific to the employer) may be included as part of the Level III Method examination.
2. No. As noted above, this is a matter for the employer's written practice and depends upon the details of what is expected of the Level II by that employer.

Inquiry 89-6

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A to permit administration of the certification examination prior to commencing the experience time for a certain level? For example, an individual completes the recommended training and the General, Specific, and Practical examinations for Level I. The experience time then commences and at the completion of the minimum experience period, certification becomes effective as of that date.

Response

SNT-TC-1A states in Paragraph 5.1: "The employer shall establish a written practice for the control and administration of NDT personnel training, examination and certification." The time of examination should be specified in the employer's written practice.

However, it is difficult to understand how an individual requiring experience in order to become qualified can satisfactorily pass an appropriately difficult Practical examination prior to obtaining the necessary experience. If an employer believes that this is satisfactory under some circumstances, these circumstances should be clearly specified in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 89-7

In reference to the SNT-TC-1A (1984 edition), we want to know if the words "should" and "shall" have a specific definition. If these words have a specific definition, what is the scope of each?

Response

No. The words "should" and "shall" do not have a specific definition applicable to the 1984 edition of SNT-TC-1A.

The implied intent of these words initially was that "shall" was used to express the importance of a particular function or activity to be considered by an employer in the written practice, whereas

“should” was intended to denote a suggested or recommended function or activity which could or should be considered for inclusion in an employer’s written practice.

A conflict in the intended usage of these two verbs was introduced by a regulatory body which interprets the words “shall” and “should” when used in their code as “shall” meaning mandatory and “should” being preferred.

To further clarify ASNT’s position on the use of these words in the context of SNT-TC-1A, the 1988 edition of SNT-TC-1A now defines “shall” and “should” in Section 2.1 as

“(8) Shall: a verb used to express the minimum recommended guidelines for most employers’ qualification and certification programs; this is intended to express what is mandatory by law or regulation.

“(9) Should: a verb used to express the desired guidelines for most employers’ qualification and certification programs.”

Inquiry 89-8

See SNT-TC-1A (1988 edition), Section 4.3. Can NDT Level IIs establish a specific technique they will use in an NDT method with an approved general procedure without approval of an NDT Level III?

Response

This issue should be addressed by the employer’s written practice. The employee must be qualified to perform the work to be accomplished.

Inquiry 89-10

It has been determined that the subject question as submitted does not constitute a request for clarification of a stated SNT-TC-1A recommendation. The question addresses the ASNT Level III program administered by ASNT under the direction of the Level III Program Committee or, after 1990, through the National Certification Board (NCB). The Level III program is an administrative function and is a separate entity from SNT-TC-1A. Therefore, this inquiry is not considered a valid request for interpretation.

However, in response to your concern, the interpretation panel answers the following question: Do electric utilities that employ personnel who have been certified to perform nondestructive examination in accordance with SNT-TC-1A routinely audit the certification process of ASNT? If not, why?

Response

The answer to your question from an NCB standpoint is no. The reason why is stated above: the ASNT Level III Program is a separate activity administered by Board-appointed members through headquarters and is not governed by SNT-TC-1A. Due to the nature of the examinations and because of confidentiality requirements, no one but NCB members have access to these examinations.

Inquiry 89-11

1. Can one waive the training requirement on the basis of previous documentable work experience and test by examination for certification?
2. Can one waive the training requirements on the basis of previous documentable certification, for certification?

Response

1. No. Training cannot be waived. Training and experience are different elements of qualification. Training is a required segment of qualification with recommended times related to education levels. Work experience and examinations are the other elements considered in qualification for certification.
2. No. The employer must evaluate the elements of previous certification to determine whether the elements of the current employer’s program have been satisfied by a previous employer’s program.

Inquiry 90-1

1. Paragraph 9.6.1.10 states: “Signature of Designated Representative.” Should the employer’s representative signing for certification be a certified Level III examiner in the specific discipline or can it be signed by an individual with no certification in that discipline but is a certified Level III examiner in a different NDT process?
2. Paragraph 4.3.3 states in part that “... the NDT Level III should have general familiarity with other appropriate NDT methods and should be qualified to train and examine NDT Level I and Level II personnel for certification.” Does the general familiarity with other appropriate NDT methods mean “a Level III [is] required to have enough ability to be able to certify another individual”?

Response

1. The inference of the statement, “Signature of Designated Representative,” in Paragraph 9.6.1.10 of SNT-TC-1A (1980 edition), is that whoever is identified by the employer in their written practice as the designated representative, may sign the record of certification.
2. No. Paragraph 4.3.3 of SNT-TC-1A (1980 edition), states ASNT’s recommendations for an employer to consider when selecting their Level III. The last sentence specifies that a Level III should be familiar with other methods and should be qualified by experience and training. The intent is to train and examine Level I and Level II personnel for certification in the methods in which they are qualified. This is further clarified in SNT-TC-1A (1988 edition), Paragraph 4.3.3, which states, “The NDT Level III, in methods in which certified, should be capable of training and examining NDT Level I and II personnel for certification in those methods.”

Inquiry 90-2

1. Is it the intent of ASNT that all Level III personnel certified to the 1988 edition be examined?
2. In accordance with SNT-TC-1A (1988 edition), an employer certifies their corporate Level III by examination through an outside service. However, the outside service’s Level III was certified by appointment to SNT-TC-1A (1984 edition). Is the employer’s Level III certification valid to the 1988 SNT-TC-1A?

Response

1. Yes. As stated in the response to Inquiry 89-4, “... It is intended by the 1988 edition of SNT-TC-1A that all Level IIIs initially certified after issuance of the 1988 edition of SNT-TC-1A be qualified by examination.” See Inquiry 89-4 and Inquiry 92-2.
2. Yes, provided the employer has assured that the examination services are in accordance with the employer’s written practice per Paragraph 9.5 of SNT-TC-1A (1988 edition).

Inquiry 90-3

Paragraph 4.3.3 in SNT-TC-1A (1988 edition) states that the NDT Level III “shall have a general familiarity with other appropriate NDT methods, as demonstrated by the ASNT Level III Basic examination or by other means.”

1. Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that “other means” be “written examination administered by a Level III”?
2. Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that “other means” be “examinations, written or practical, administered by a Level III”?

Response

No. The intent of the statement “other means” is to provide the user of SNT-TC-1A with sufficient latitude under Paragraph 1.4 to identify specifically how they would evaluate the extent of a Level III’s general knowledge of other NDT methods, as defined in their written practice.

Inquiry 90-4*

Is it acceptable for a candidate for Level III certification under SNT-TC-1A (1988 edition) to be qualified on the basis of demonstrated ability, achievement, experience, and education in lieu of qualification by examination as stated in Paragraph 9.6(g)?

Response

No. Paragraph 8.8 specifically requires that a Level III candidate be qualified by examination. Paragraph 9.6(g) addresses the content of the qualification records file to be maintained by the employer of certified personnel.

***This Response was reconsidered. See Inquiry 92-2. Also see Inquiry 89-4 and Inquiry 90-2.**

Inquiry 91-1

Assuming 2,100 hours are worked each year, is it the intent of Paragraph 6.3.2 that a candidate should work 2,100 hours to claim one year of experience or that a candidate should have been active in the methods during the year?

Example: A candidate works 2 hours per month (24 hours) as a Level II in PT and 173 hours per month (2,076 hours) in other methods. At the end of the year, the candidate claims one year of experience in PT.

Response

As previously stated in the response to Inquiry 87-3, it is intended that 100% of the work experience time specified in Paragraph 6.3.2 be met in each applicable test method prior to certification.

When the individual is qualified by examination, the above requirements may be partially replaced by experience as a certified NDT Level II or by assignments at least comparable to NDT Level II in other methods listed in Section 3 of this recommended practice as defined in the employer’s written practice.

Inquiry 91-2

Does Recommended Practice No. SNT-TC-1A (1984 edition) exclude an employer from developing its written practice utilizing visual examination as an NDT method?

Response

No. As previously stated in the response to Inquiry 78-7 and 80-8, the intent of Paragraph 1.4 is to provide the employer adequate flexibility to accommodate a variety of special needs as documented in a written practice.

Inquiry 91-3

May Level IIIs or their designated representative administer eye examinations? According to Paragraph 8.1, Level IIIs or their designated representative shall administer and grade the examinations specified in Section 8.3 to 8.8. Paragraph 8.2 (which covers eye exams) is not addressed in this statement nor are any qualified individuals addressed in 8.2. Should Paragraph 8.1 read “8.2 through 8.8” or are Level IIIs not permitted to administer eye exams and if so, who is?

Response

As previously stated in the response to Inquiry 78-11, it is intended that Level III personnel be allowed to administer the near-distance vision acuity examination. However, if the employer elects to use other methods of vision examination, it may be necessary to use personnel with other specialized qualifications to administer the examination. The employer should include details of the qualifications required of examiners in the written practice.

Inquiry 91-4

According to SNT-TC-1A (1984 edition), when an employee has been tested to Level III requirements by an outside agency and certified as a Level III by their employer on the basis of these tests:

1. Can the employee be recertified based on the employer’s statement of continuing satisfactory performance?
2. What constitutes “evidence of continuing satisfactory performance”?
3. Must the certification be given by another NDT Level III employed by the company, or may it be given by a company official?

Response

1. Paragraph 9.7.1 of SNT-TC-1A allows for recertification with evidence of continuing satisfactory performance. An employee may be recertified with evidence of continuing satisfactory performance if addressed in the employer’s written practice.
2. The intent of “evidence of continuing satisfactory performance” in Paragraph 9.7.1 of SNT-TC-1A is that the employer shall have objective evidence of an individual’s satisfactory performance during the previous certification period of the appropriate duties outlined in the employer’s written practice.
3. As previously stated in the response to Inquiry 90-1, the inference of the statement “signature of designated representative” in Paragraph 9.6.1.10 is that whoever is identified by the employer in their written practice as the designated representative may sign the record of certification.

Inquiry 91-5

Is it the intent of Table 6.3.1 (1984 edition) that, for initial certification to Level III PT, the recommended three months of experience must be accumulated in consecutive months? Assuming the individual is being certified directly to Level II, does not perform NDT full time and the 25% rule cannot be applied.

Response

No. As stated in Paragraph 6.3.1, the intent of Table 6.3.1 is to list the recommended training and experience factors to be considered by the employer in establishing written practices for initial qualification of Level I and Level II individuals. There is no provision to limit the time period over which the experience may be credited.

Inquiry 92-1

Please clarify the response to Inquiry 78-4, question 2, as it applies to SNT-TC-1A (1975 edition).

1. Is it necessary for the recertification of a previously qualified and certified individual to obtain further experience in the applicable method, in addition to refresher training?
2. If a written practice contains a provision to administer only additional training prior to the examination process, would the intent of Paragraph 10.2 be satisfied?

Response

1. As previously stated in the response to Inquiry 78-4, when an individual has proof of prior certification but has not worked in the method within the immediate six months prior to termination or the individual is being recertified after more than six months have passed since termination, additional training and experience is recommended. Whether or not additional training or experience is necessary must be determined and detailed in the employer's written practice.
2. Paragraph 10.2 addresses specific conditions for the recertification of terminated Level I or Level IIs solely by examination. Inquiry 78-4 addresses the general recommendations for recertifying individuals who do not meet the requirements of 10.2. The employer's written practice must detail such provisions in accordance with Paragraph 1.4.

Inquiry 92-2

Based on a review of inquiries published in *Materials Evaluation*, the following text is provided to clarify an earlier response.

Response

(Reconsideration of Inquiry 90-4)

SNT-TC-1A (1988 edition) recommends that a candidate for Level III be qualified by examination. However, Section 9.3 states "Certification of NDT personnel shall be based on demonstration of satisfactory qualification in accordance with Sections 6, 7 and 8, as modified by the employer's written practice."

Therefore, a candidate for Level III could be qualified on the basis of demonstrated ability, achievement, experience, and education in lieu of examination, if specifically addressed in the employer's written practice.

Also see Inquiry 89-4 and Inquiry 90-2.

Inquiry 93-1

Is the intent of Paragraph 9.7.3 that any time a certified employee attempts a certification examination in the method certified and fails, their current certification shall be revoked?

Example: A Level I employee was issued a certification with a three-year expiration date. Two years after certification the employee attempts a Level II examination and fails. Is the Level I certification still valid or should the employee be reexamined in accordance with Paragraph 8.10 prior to reinstatement of the certification?

Response

The intent of Paragraph 9.7.3 is to allow an employer to reexamine an individual at any time (employer's discretion) for the purpose of extending an existing certification (i.e., recertify an individual to

the same method and level) or for revoking an existing certification. The specific details of extending or revoking an existing certification must be documented in the employer's written practice.

In the example, since a higher level certification was attempted and failed, the existing lower level certification would be considered valid for the remainder of the certification period.

Inquiry 93-2

Section 8.8, part 4 and part 5 refer to a valid ASNT Level III certificate.

1. Is the ASNT Level III certificate endorsement limited to persons tested by ASNT?
2. A person was appointed as a Level III in June 1988, in accordance with the recommended guidelines of the 1984 edition SNT-TC-1A for a five-year period. Is that person meeting the "requirements" of the 1988 edition through May of 1993?
3. In the case of Level III certification by appointment, dated June 6, 1990, would this example be valid?

Response

1. Yes.
2. SNT-TC-1A is a recommended guideline. As such, it is to be used by employers in developing their own requirements. Therefore, the employer may accept the appointed Level III certification of the 1984 edition as satisfying the 1988 edition, if specified within the employer's written practice. See the response to Inquiry 85-2 and Inquiry 86-7.
3. Yes, see the response to Inquiry 92-2.

Inquiry 93-3

NDT technicians are employees of the state. The state's register has identified the "Qualification and Certification Committee" as being responsible for the qualification and certification of NDT personnel. In addition, the committee is allowed to approve and use testing centers for examinations.

If the NDT technicians work for a subsidiary of a corporation, who does ASNT recognize as the employer for the sake of certification?

Response

It is against ASNT policy to judge on the applicability of employer policies and documents.

The SNT-TC-1A Interpretation Panel was established to respond to written inquiries about Recommended Practice No. SNT-TC-1A: *Personnel Qualification and Certification in Nondestructive Testing*. The responses clarify the intent of ASNT's Technical and Education Council and recommendations of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 93-4

If an individual is certified as a Level I in MT and is progressing to Level II certification per the 1980 edition of SNT-TC-1A, does the individual need an additional three months of experience or are only two months of experience needed since the individual already acquired one month of experience for Level I.

Response

Yes, the individual will require an additional three months of experience.

Inquiry 94-1

Please clarify ASNT's intent regarding the phrase, "assignment comparable to that of an NDT Level II" as it related to SNT-TC-1A, 1984 edition, Paragraph 6.3.2.1. I interpret this statement to mean: even though an individual has a four-year degree in science or engineering, they should also have the "documented" NDT training and experience commensurate with that of a Level II. This documented training should follow the guidelines established in Table 6.3.1 of SNT-TC-1A (1984 edition). It also requires (in my opinion) this individual practice as a Level II for at least one year before being eligible for Level III certification.

Response

Please reference Inquiry 83-8.

Inquiry 94-2

I have a question regarding the certification hours. In Table 6.3.1 of the SNT-TC-1A recommended practice for a UT certification, it shows that the requirement for Level I is three months and Level II is an additional nine months. Three months at 40 hours per week translates into 480 hours; nine months at 40 hours per week translates into an additional 1,440 hours. I am currently doing thickness testing. My question is: How much of that time should be shear wave inspection in order to be an unrestricted Level II according to ASNT recommendations?

Response

Please reference Inquiry 80-3.

Inquiry 95-1

If the person who administered and graded an examination is identified on the examination and on the certification, and the examination and certification are signed by the Level III certifier, does the Level III need to issue a letter or statement delegating that person as their representative?

Response

Section 5.1 states: "The employer shall establish a written practice for the control and administration of NDT personnel training, examination, and certification." The employer's written practice should identify who is responsible for the administration and grading of examinations. It should also identify the method used to identify a Level III's designated representative. When not specifically addressed in the written practice, designation of a representative becomes wholly the responsibility of the NDT Level III. A Level III's signature on the examination or certification may be accepted as designation.

Inquiry 96-1

1. [Ref: 8.8.1(b) and 8.8.1(c), 9.5.1] The number of examination questions is increased by Section 8.8.1(b) and 8.8.1(c). Shall the NDT Level IIIs who have been qualified with the examination in accordance with an earlier edition and continuing satisfactory performance be required to take an additional examination until their next requalification?
2. [Ref: 8.8.2(a)] The revised requirements deleted the selection of questions from published ASNT Level III questions and required

questions "similar to." Do the requirements intend to prohibit to make or adopt the same questions as ASNT Level IIIs?

3. [Ref: 8.5(4)] Shall the NDT Level I, who was qualified in accordance with an early edition and continuing satisfactory performance, be required to take an additional examination evaluating the Practical examination results, until next requalification, if their written practice stipulates the specific evaluation of acceptance for the NDT Level I?

Response

1. No. Level III certification is valid until it is expired. At that time, the individual should be recertified according to the employer's guidelines. See Inquiries 85-2, 86-7 and 93-2.2.
2. No. ASNT Level III questions are administered by ASNT's Certification Management Board (formerly the National Certification Board). The questions are similar to those of a *Level III Study Guide*. Both sets of questions can be but may not necessarily be the same. See Inquiry 79-2.
3. No. Level I certification is valid until the expiration date. At that time, the individual should be recertified according to the employer's guidelines. See Inquiry 85-2, Inquiry 86-7 and Inquiry 93-2.2. Based on Sections 5 and 9 of SNT-TC-1A, certification of all levels of NDT personnel is the responsibility of the employer.

Inquiry 96-2

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that any individual examination grade less than 70% should be considered a failing grade?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 96-3

When applying SNT-TC-1A 1992 edition in strict accordance with the document, is it ASNT's interpretation that a Level III must be examined?

Response

No. Certification of all levels of NDT personnel is the responsibility of the employer. It is the intent of ASNT to certify Level IIIs by examination. However, the employer can specify the requirements for a certification route without examination in the employer's written practice. Please see Inquiry 80-9, Inquiry 89-4, Inquiry 90-2, Inquiry 90-4, and Inquiry 92-2.

Inquiry 99-1

May an employer use the training and experience hour requirements specified in the 1984 edition of SNT-TC-1A for personnel who have not graduated from high school and are being qualified to the 1992 edition of SNT-TC-1A?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 99-2

Is it the intent of the 1992 edition of SNT-TC-1A, that a person without a high school diploma or equivalent, not be certified to any NDT level?

Response

No.

Inquiry 99-3

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that any composite examination grade less than 80% should be considered a failing grade?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 99-4

Paragraph 4.0 (Levels of Qualification) of SNT-TC-1A 1984 edition permits those levels to be further subdivided by the employer for specific situations. Is there sufficient latitude within that paragraph to permit an employer to certify a person who is not qualified or certified in any method, as an Administrative Level III?

Response

No. See Inquiries 88-1 and 82-1. Under the recommendations of SNT-TC-1A it is not permissible for an employer to certify an individual who is not qualified (or certified) in any method as an NDT Level III, Administrative or any other title.

Paragraph 3.1 of SNT-TC-1A identifies the nondestructive testing methods where qualifications and certifications are awarded. Paragraph 4.3 identifies NDT Level I, NDT Level II and ASNT NDT Level III as the basic levels of qualifications. Paragraph 4.1 allows these levels to be further subdivided by the employer for specific situations. It is intended that the subdivided levels be method specific and detailed in the employer's written practice. The provisions of Paragraph 9.3 apply to the certification of all NDT personnel including subdivided levels.

Inquiry 00-1

Whose responsibility is it to personally maintain the certified employees' records and handle the files? The employer? The appointed ASNT NDT Level III? The human resources department? Or anyone assigned by the employer?

Response

Responsibility for maintaining records should be addressed in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 00-2

A company has a written practice for TIR personnel. They then become a part of the quality control group and want to develop a written practice for vibration analysis. The two groups are not connected in any way. They have different managers and locations. Is it permissible to have two separate written practices, one for TIR and one for VA personnel?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 00-3

How can an employer who wishes to utilize the services of an outside agency adopt that agent's written practice, course instruction, or examination particulars as acceptable as is within their written practice?

Response

Reference Inquiry 77-3.

Inquiry 01-1

I am inquiring of ASNT regarding an NDT Level III's scope of authority. I have asked several ASNT NDT Level IIIs locally regarding

this matter and have received several answers. Can an NDT Level III (not ASNT NDT Level III) perform third-party Level III services for outside companies (this particular Level III is operating under the 1996 edition of SNT-TC-1A)?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 01-2

Was or is it the intent of ASNT to prohibit the appointment of qualified personnel to Level III positions, making examination mandatory, as our authorized inspection company has interpreted it?

Response

No. Refer to Inquiry 92-2.

Inquiry 01-3

Does a Level I NDT technician require a high school diploma? ASNT's Recommended Practice No. SNT-TC-1A does not specifically list initial training or experience recommendations for personnel without a high school education and I need to know how to certify a person who has done NDT work for years but does not have a diploma.

Response

No. Should be addressed in employer's written practice.

Inquiry 01-4

We are an inspection company in Iran and would like to edit our written practice for training and qualification of NDT personnel. However, I have the 1988 edition of ASNT's Recommended Practice No. SNT-TC-1A, where Paragraph 8.3.4 states that, "on the basis of demonstrated ability, achievement, experience, and education, as defined in Par. 4.3(3) and 6.3, the employer may waive examination for the Level III individual." I would like to know whether this point still holds good, and can we still rely on it to appoint a company Level III?

Response

Yes, if you are operating under the 1984 or an earlier edition. You should note that Paragraph 8.3.4 was dropped from SNT-TC-1A in the 1988 and all subsequent editions.

Inquiry 01-5

Is the color vision test mandatory for ASNT Level II qualification in radiographic testing?

Response

Yes. That is, the color contrast differentiation examination is mandatory. The color contrast differentiation exam should demonstrate the capability of distinguishing and differentiating contrast among colors or shades of gray used in a method as determined by the employer.

Inquiry 01-6

Who can administer the vision tests, near vision acuity and color contrast differentiation? I understand that the near vision test should be administered annually and the color contrast differentiation test upon initial certification and at three-year intervals. But who can do it? A Level III who is in charge of the certification program? Medical personnel? What about the color contrast differentiation test?

Response

Any personnel designated in the employer's written practice to administer the vision tests.

Inquiry 01-7

I work for the Department of Defense and I'm in the middle of reviewing a contractor's written practice, which supposedly was written in accordance with SNT-TC-1A. According to the contractor's written practice, SNT-TC-1A allows the employer to waive Level III examinations. "In accordance with Recommended Practice No. SNT-TC-1A, based on demonstrated ability, achievement, experience, and education, the employer may waive examination for the Level III individual." It doesn't say anything about having a valid ASNT NDT Level III certificate. Is this true? Note that the contractor is required to utilize the latest version of SNT-TC-1A.

Response

Yes. Reference Inquiry 85-7 and 81-9.1.

Inquiry 01-8

1. Paragraph 8.1.1 of SNT-TC-1A (1992) reads: "An NDT Level III shall be responsible for the administration and grading of examinations specified in Section 8.3 through 8.8 for NDT Level I, II, or other Level III personnel. The administration and grading of examinations may be delegated to a qualified representative of the NDT Level III and so recorded. The actual administration and grading of Level III examinations specified in 8.8 may be performed by a qualified representative of the employer." In reference to the above paragraph, what is meant by a "qualified representative of the NDT Level III" to whom an NDT Level III can delegate authority for administration and grading for NDT Level I, II or other Level III personnel? Please explain specifically the term "qualified." What shall be the extent of the qualification of the person? Does it mean that the person should be highly qualified in the NDT field or can the person here be a responsible management representative?
2. Again, in reference to the above paragraph, what is meant by "qualified representative of the employer?" What is the level of qualification necessary in this case? For NDT Level III certification by the employer, is it required for the person who will issue certification to the ASNT NDT Level III to be highly qualified in the relevant NDT field or can they be top management representatives (in our case, our divisional head—that is, vice president of maintenance) who are knowledgeable in NDT but who do not have qualification in the NDT field?
3. It is well understood that SNT-TC-1A is a guideline and that the employer can modify it reasonably to meet any specific needs warranted under the circumstances and/or applications. There are various organizations and schemes in NDT qualification/ certification such as ISNT (Indian Society for Nondestructive Testing), DIN, MIL and Japanese certification schemes. Each has its own constitution and procedure for NDT personnel qualification countrywide. If somebody in my company is preexisting with other than ASNT Level I or II certification status (like ISNT) or if a new person joins my company with some other Level I or II certification status, considering the competency, education, and course coverage in that method, can I certify them to equal/ equivalent ASNT NDT level status by modifying the company's written practice accordingly? That is, can an ASNT NDT Level III certify ISNT (or some other) Level I or II person to an equal ASNT NDT level based on competency, education, and course coverage in the method?
4. Is the existence of a company NDT personnel certification procedure—a written practice—equally important and required for NDT personnel irrespective of industry type?

Response

1. Needs to be addressed in employer's written practice.
2. See Inquiry 95-1.
3. Yes.
4. Yes.

Inquiry 01-9

Regarding Paragraph 8.2.2 of SNT-TC-1A, is there a recognized method for differentiating shades of gray used in the method (radiography)?

Response

SNT-TC-1A does not define a specific method. The specific method is up to employer discretion.

Inquiry 01-10

We sometimes recertify persons periodically based on Paragraph 9.5.1.a on recertification in the 1996 edition of SNT-TC-1A, which cites "evidence of continuing satisfactory performance." At present, my qualification to date has been ASNT NDT Level III RT. Will I be able to issue a certificate (with my signature on the certificate) for someone who is being recertified by the above route?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 01-11

1. May a Level III perform a color contrast differentiation test along with the near vision acuity test as mentioned in Paragraph 8.2 of SNT-TC-1A (1996), if documented so in the written practice?
2. Is it also required to perform a test of gray shades, if the color contrast differentiation test is performed as per Paragraph 8.2 of SNT-TC-1A (1996) using the Ishihara series of plates and so documented in a written practice?

Response

1. Yes.
2. Yes.

Inquiry 01-12

In the 1996 edition of SNT-TC-1A, Paragraph 9.4 states (in part) that "personnel certification records shall be maintained on file by the employer." Who is it that actually maintains the records? The company's human resources department? The company's personnel department? The company's appointed Level III person? The certifying authority? Is it a common practice to delegate this task to the appointed NDT Level III person as per the written practice?

Response

Needs to be addressed in employer's written practice.

Inquiry 01-13

This is in relation to Paragraph 10.2 of the 1996 edition of SNT-TC-1A. One division of Company A was merged and acquired by Company B. All of the employees of its division were hired by Company B within six months and their job activities did not change. The employer of Company B designated the Level III personnel of Company A as the outside agency. The employer established a written practice, which was prepared by the Level III of Company A. In the written practice, it is specified that the employer can waive the examination in cases

where the job activities are the same as they were in Company A. May the employer of Company B certify the employee who had been certified by Company A without examination in this case?

Response

Yes, if addressed in employer's written practice.

Inquiry 01-14

The wording of Paragraph 4.3.1 of SNT-TC-1A (which reads the same in the 1996 and 2001 editions) is not clear and is inconsistent with the body of knowledge. Please advise of the official ASNT position on the following.

1. Is it the intent of Paragraph 4.3.1 of SNT-TC-1A that a Level I receive direct supervision from a Level II or Level III by their presence during the examination, interpretation, evaluation and reporting of NDT test results?
2. According to the recommended training listed in SNT-TC-1A, a Level I individual does not receive training on discontinuities, interpretation, and evaluation in most NDT methods such as PT, RT, UT and VT. How could a Level I individual perform the functions of interpretation and evaluation authorized in Paragraph 4.3.1 even with the presence of a Level II or III?

Response

It is the intent of 4.3.1 that the Level I should receive the necessary instruction or supervision from a certified NDT Level II or Level III individual. The extent of said instruction or supervision should be sufficient to perform the tasks required as determined by the responsible party.

Inquiry 02-1

An interpretation of SNT-TC-1A (2001) Paragraph 2.1.14 is requested. The paragraph states that an employer writes a written practice for the qualification and certification of their employees. However, Inquiry 83-7 suggests that employers can certify qualified nonemployees, while Inquiry 87-2 implies that only bona fide employees can be certified.

1. Is it the intent that employers certify only their qualified employees?
2. Is it the intent that employers, when permitted by their written practice, certify qualified nonemployees?
3. Would the answer in question 2 change if a third party, who agreed with the arrangement, were compensating both the nonemployee and the certifying company?

Response

Reference Inquiry 87-2.

1. Yes.
2. No.
3. No.

Inquiry 02-2

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A (2001) Paragraph 10.2 to recommend periodic testing with test props with at least one flawed specimen or are other means of technical performance evaluation acceptable, for example, monitoring an inspector performing an official production inspection?

Response

The means for periodic technical performance evaluation should be described in the employer's written practice. Note that the evaluation of technical performance should consist of not only monitoring the proper application of technique, but also the ability to recognize relevant indications and evaluate those indications against the employer's acceptance criteria.

Inquiry 03-1

1. Regarding SNT-TC-1A (1984) Paragraph 9.7.1, what is considered proper "evidence of continuing satisfactory performance"?
2. Does this mean the certified individual shall maintain documentation of satisfactory performance?
3. How often should performance be documented?
4. CP-189 (1991) indicates suspension should occur if duties are not performed during any consecutive 12-month period (Sec. 7.2). Is this implied in SNT-TC-1A?

Response

1. Please reference Inquiry 91-4 question 2.
2. No.
3. SNT-TC-1A (1984) provides the user sufficient latitude under Paragraph 9.7.1 to identify specifically how they would evaluate "evidence of continuing satisfactory performance." The requirements should be documented in the employer's written practice.
4. There are no specific provisions in the 1984 SNT-TC-1A regarding interruption of NDT duties while continuing to work for the same employer. However, the employer must be satisfied with the proficiency of any individual at any level to handle work tasks. The employer has direct knowledge of the employee's prior performance and can best judge the need for reexamination as a function of duration of interrupted NDT service.

Inquiry 03-2

May an NDT Level III develop, qualify, and approve NDT procedures, and establish and approve techniques in the methods in which not certified?

Response

No, see the response to Inquiry 90-1, Part 2 and Inquiry 10-5.

Inquiry 04-1

1. Is it the intent of Paragraph 1.4 that an employer can modify the "Guidelines" of SNT-TC-1A to the extent that Level II and Level III NDT personnel can be "certified" without any examinations if written this way in the written practice?
2. What are the limits that are intended regarding how much the employer can deviate from SNT-TC-1A as written? If no limits are given, the employer can change the entire context of SNT-TC-1A to eliminate all certification exams. Is that the intent?

Response

1. No. The provisions of Paragraph 1.4 allow modification of the detailed recommendations; it is not intended to allow elimination of the basic provisions of the document.
2. No. Paragraph 9.2. requires certification in accordance with "Section 8, Examinations" as described in the employer's written practice.

General Comments:

SNT-TC-1A allows for modification of detailed recommendations as necessary to meet particular needs. The intent is that there be a technical rationale to support such modification. Elimination of requirements, such as training, experience and examination, goes beyond modification of detailed requirements.

Inquiry 04-2

1. Is it the intent of Paragraph 12.1.1 that individuals who are re-certified based on “continuing satisfactory technical performance,” must pass a new Practical examination?
2. May a Level I or II individual be re-certified, based on “continuing satisfactory technical performance” without taking a new Practical examination?

Response

1. No. See Inquiry 91-4 question 2.
2. Yes. SNT-TC-1A provides the user sufficient latitude under Paragraph 9.7.1 to identify specifically how they would evaluate “evidence of continuing satisfactory performance.” The requirements should be documented in the employer’s written practice.

Inquiry 05-1

Paragraph 8.1.3 states “Examinations administered for qualification should result in a passing grade of at least 80%,” but if the employer’s written practice states that each examination must achieve 70% or more, and does not require an 80% composite, is this acceptable?

Response

No. See Inquiry 99-3.

Note to the Inquirer

The SNT-TC-1A Interpretation Panel reviewed this question and agreed with the original response.

Inquiry 07-1

Per the 2001 edition of SNT-TC-1A, Paragraphs 7.1, 7.2, and 9.4.4, and Tables 6.3.1A and 6.3.1B:

1. Can computer or Web-based NDT training with associated electronic quizzes be used to satisfy the training requirements described in Paragraphs 7.1 and 7.2?
2. If so, how should an employer document that training hours meet the recommended hours listed in Tables 6.3.1A and 6.3.1B so they can comply with the “satisfactory completion” requirements required by Paragraph 9.4.4?

Response

1. See Inquiry 84-4, response 1. Inquiry 84-4 addresses home-study (correspondence) courses, but the response is appropriate for both computer and Web-based training.
2. See Inquiry 84-4, response 2.

Inquiry 07-2

Per the 2001 edition of SNT-TC-1A, Paragraphs 6.3.2.1 through 6.3.2.3, may experience earned as a Limited Level II for the prescribed period of experience time qualify a person to sit for the ASNT NDT Level III exam in that test method?

Response

No response provided; this question is beyond the scope of SNT-TC-1A. The ASNT NDT Level III program is a third-party certification program governed by the Certification Management Council, not SNT-TC-1A. Any inquiries about the ASNT NDT Level III program

should be addressed to the Certification Management Council c/o the Senior Manager, ASNT Technical Services Department.

Inquiry 07-3

With regard to the 2006 edition of SNT-TC-1A, Table 6.3.1A, if my UT candidate has completed training and testing requirements per SNT-TC-1A 2006 and has completed 740 hours of intern experience with UT under supervision, how do we use the “total hours in NDT” column to complete the UT Level II qualification/certification process? It appears that without any other experience, this UT candidate would have to accumulate a total of 1600 hours per Note 1.0 if they were going directly to Level II in only the UT method. Is this correct?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 07-4

Regarding the 2001 edition of SNT-TC-1A, Paragraphs 2.1.8 and 4.2:

A trainee (uncertified technician) gets assigned to go and perform some NDT. There is no other technician with this trainee on the job. It takes eight hours to complete the job. How many hours of “work experience” can be claimed?

Response

None. Paragraph 2.1.8 defines experience as “work activities accomplished in a specific NDT method under the direction of qualified supervision including the performance of the NDT method and related activities...”

Inquiry 07-5

When providing third-party Level III services to clients who are operating in accordance with SNT-TC-1A, may an ASNT NDT Level III both provide the training and administer qualification examinations to those clients’ personnel?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 07-6

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that providers of third-party training and examination services (as permitted by Paragraphs 7.4 and 8.1.5 respectively) be accredited by some third-party body?

Response

No. Meeting the employer’s written practice requirements is all that is recommended in these paragraphs.

Inquiry 08-1

With reference to Table 6.3.1A, if a trainee is being qualified in only one method, which would be the total experience hours for PT Level I for qualification and certification?

1. 70 hours (work experience in the method)
2. 130 hours (70 hours of work experience in the method plus 60 hours in NDT)
3. 200 hours (70 hours of work experience in the method plus 130 hours in NDT)

Response

For PT, Table 6.3.1A indicates that 130 hours are required in NDT, 70 hours of which must be in PT. The additional 60 hours in NDT may also be acquired in the PT method or may be acquired in any other method.

Inquiry 08-2

Per the 2001 edition of SNT-TC-1A, a Level II examiner is certified in PT, MT and VT and has been approved as capable of distinguishing and differentiating contrast among colors according to Ishihara standard plates, as determined by the written practice. Does this person also require approval by a shades of gray acuity examination to be qualified in RT to meet the requirements of Paragraph 8.2.2?

Response

Yes. See Inquiry 01-11. Paragraph 8.2.2 allows the employer to determine the method of testing for color differentiation or gray shade differentiation. Whether to test for color differentiation or gray shade differentiation is determined by which is appropriate for the method the individual is being certified in.

Inquiry 08-3

Per the 2001 edition of SNT-TC-1A, an MT examiner has been approved in the capability of distinguishing and differentiating contrast among colors according to Ishihara standard plates. Does this person need to be tested in shades of gray acuity, if the MT procedure uses gray magnetic particles, to meet the requirements of Paragraph 8.2.2?

Response

No. See Inquiry 08-2.

Inquiry 08-4

Is it permissible to count a 40-hour radiation safety training course as part of the 80 hours of Level II RT training recommended in Tables 6.3.1A and 6.3.1B?

Response

No.

Inquiry 09-1

1. With regard to NDT Level IIIs signing off on certification after successful completion of trainees' examinations, is it the intention that the NDT Level IIIs must be certified in the methods for which they are signing off as per SNT-TC-1A Paragraph 4.3.3?
2. Is it commonly accepted in the industry that NDT Level IIIs can sign off on certifications for methods other than those in which they are certified?

Response

1. This question refers to two separate issues.
 - a. Can NDT Level IIIs sign off on certifications in methods for which they are not qualified? Yes. Signing off on certification is covered by Section 9.0, Certification Record, and Paragraph 9.4.9 states that a person's certification record must have the signature of the Level III who verified the qualifications of a candidate for certification. It does not require that this Level III be certified in the applicable test methods. See Inquiry 90-1 Part 1.
 - b. Can NDT Level IIIs develop and approve the training and examination program for NDT methods they are not qualified in? No. Paragraph 4.3.3 states that the NDT Level III should be capable of training and examining NDT Level I and II personnel for certification in those methods for which the Level III holds certification. See Inquiry 90-1 Part 2.
2. Determining industry practice is not within the scope of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 09-2

Should NDT Level I technicians be allowed to make the final determination as to whether a production part is accepted or rejected and then sign off on the production order paperwork if they follow a step-by-step procedure developed by a Level III?

Response

Level I personnel may accept or reject parts according to written instructions and record results. Reporting the final results requires a Level II or III.

Inquiry 09-3

Paragraphs 6.3.2.1 through 6.3.2.3 describe the eligibility requirements for NDT Level III, all of which require some experience time in the applicable test method(s). Directly below that paragraph is the following sentence: "The above Level III requirements may be partially replaced by experience as a certified NDT Level II or by assignments at least comparable to NDT Level II as defined in the employer's written practice." What is the intent of this sentence?

Response

The cited sentence allows appropriate experience in other NDT methods to be used to modify the "in applicable NDT method" experience requirements cited in the main paragraphs, if so defined in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 09-4

What qualification requirements are necessary to provide NDT training that will meet the guidelines found in SNT-TC-1A Section 7.0, Training?

Response

SNT-TC-1A does not address the qualification of providers of NDT training.

Inquiry 10-1

Can Paragraph 1.4 in SNT-TC-1A be interpreted to allow an employer's written practice to restrict or limit the function of an NDT Level III to dye penetrant testing applications, and by doing so, the NDT Level III would not be required to be examined for general knowledge in other methods?

Response

See Inquiry 88-1. The employer may restrict or limit the function of an NDT Level III. Such limitation does not alter the requirements of the Basic examination for the Level III.

Inquiry 10-2

Paragraph 8.8.3.2 states "A valid endorsement of ASNT Level III certificate fulfills the examination criteria for 8.8.1 (Basic examination) and 8.8.2 (Method examination) for each applicable NDT method. Has it been implied that an ASNT NDT Level III is not required to take the employer's examination in order to become NDT Level III for the employer?

Response

The cited reference in the first paragraph should be 8.8.4 and it only applies to the Basic and Method examinations. The Specific examination requirements for each method (8.8.3) may be addressed in two ways for an ASNT Level III in the method; examination or documented evidence of experience for both the preparation of NDT procedures to code, standards, or specification and the evaluation of test results.

Inquiry 10-3

1. For Limited Level II certification in UT A-scan Thickness, Table 6.3.1C shows the technician's starting point as being a trainee. Does this mean that personnel can go directly from trainee to Limited Level II without having held a Level I UT certification?
2. Can personnel that have met the UT Level I requirements shown in Table 6.3.1A (40 hours of training, 210 hours of UT experience and 400 total hours of total NDT experience) be automatically certified as Limited Level II in both Digital and A-scan Thickness since they have exceeded the requirements shown in Table 6.3.1 C for those certifications?

Response

1. Yes
2. No, the body of knowledge requirements as described in ANSI/ASNT CP-105 is different for UT Level I and UT Thickness. The written practice should address any thickness specific training, equipment, codes, experience, etc., necessary for thickness gauging job performance not addressed in the UT Level I training.

Inquiry 10-4

May an employer appoint directly an "EN 473 Level III" as employer's NDT Level III after defined in employer's written practice to sign the certificates according to SNT-TC-1A in order to verify qualification of candidate for certification?

Response

The employer may use the examination results that they has determined meet the requirement of the written practice. As stated in SNT-TC-1A, Paragraph 8.1.5, the employer is responsible for ensuring the examination services meet the requirements of the employer's written practice. Certification can only be issued when it has been determined that all the requirements of the employer's written practice have been met.

Inquiry 10-5

As stated in the SNT-TC-1A 2006 edition, Paragraph 4.0 Level of Qualification, 4.3.3 NDT Level III: "An NDT Level III individual should be capable of developing, qualifying and approving procedure..., etc."

Question

1. Does it mean that all NDT procedures/standard operating procedures (SOP) should be prepared by an NDT Level III?
2. Could an NDT Level II prepare a specific procedure based on the related standard or specification?

Example

The NDT Level I prepares NDT procedures for ferromagnetic connection inspection based on API RP7G and API Spec 7 and all procedures actually adopted from the referenced specifications.

3. Could the director of the company (inspection agency) approve this SOP, or
4. Should this SOP be reviewed and approved by the NDT Level III?

Response

1. No.
2. 3. 4. The scope of SNT-TC-1A is limited to guidelines for the qualification and certification of NDT personnel. The capability of developing, qualifying and approving procedure is a qualification

for Level IIIs. This does not preclude individuals who are not Level IIIs from also having some or all of those skills. SNT-TC-1A does not restrict employers from using individuals they feel are qualified for doing those tasks.

Inquiry 10-6

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that the hour method for achieving the necessary personnel experience in an NDE method is equivalent to the month method for all applicable current and previous editions?

Response

A person whose documented experience meets the requirements of the table stating the requirements in hours can be considered as having met the experience requirements for documented experience based on months as defined in previous editions of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 10-7

Is "self-certification" acceptable per SNT-TC-1A? Specifically, can a Level III in one method certify themselves in another method as Level III without additional training or examination?

Response

No. Self-certification is not addressed by SNT-TC-1A but self-declaration of qualification does not meet the requirement of SNT-TC-1A. The objective evidence is required as described in the employer's written practice and should include evidence of education, training, experience and appropriate examinations.

Inquiry 11-1

With regard to Paragraphs 2.1.8, 4.2, and 4.3 of the 2006 edition of SNT-TC-1A:

1. May an NDT trainee gain experience hours while working under the direct supervision of a Level I in the method?
2. Are there any circumstances that would allow NDT trainees or NDT Level I technicians to progress to the next certification level without ever having gained actual field experience working with NDT Level II or Level III technicians in the method?

Response

1. See Inquiry 87-1. Yes, provided the Level I receives the necessary instructions or supervision from a certified Level II or III individual.
2. No. As stated in Paragraph 2.1.8, experience can only be gained while working under the direction of qualified supervision.

Inquiry 11-2

1. Do the guidelines described in Paragraph 8.5 of the 2006 edition of SNT-TC-1A fully fill the guidelines described in Section 10?
2. Do the two guidelines need to be done separately or can they be done together?

Response

1. Yes.
2. The provisions of Paragraphs 8.5 and 8.6 are done separately. The Practical examination as described in Section 8.5 is part of the documentation for initial certification. The technical performance evaluation as described in Section 10 is intended to document continued satisfactory performance during the certification period.

Inquiry 11-3*

Is recertification considered a “detailed recommendation” or a “requirement” as described in the General Comment following the response for Inquiry 04-1?

Background

In the General Comment following the response for Inquiry 04-1 it says, “SNT-TC-1A allows for modification of detailed recommendations as necessary to meet particular needs. The intent is that there be a technical rationale to support such modification. Elimination of requirements, such as training, experience, and examination, goes beyond modification of detailed requirements.”

Response

This inquiry was answered with the release of the 2011 edition of SNT-TC-1A which states in part in Paragraph 1.4, “In developing a written practice as required in Section 5, the employer should review the detailed recommendations presented herein and modify them, as necessary, to meet particular needs. *Such modification may alter but shall not eliminate basic provisions of the program such as training, experience, testing, and recertification.*”

***Note: The SNT-TC-1A Interpretation Panel did not issue a formal response to this inquiry since it was answered in the 2011 edition of SNT-TC-1A.**

Inquiry 12-1

1. Is it the intent when obtaining certification in time of flight diffraction (TOFD) and/or phased array that the candidate first be certified as a UT Level II? Note 8.0 of Table 6.3.1 A requires completion of training and experience of UT Level II but not necessarily the written examinations (general and specific).
2. If the intent is that a TOFD and phased array candidate's prerequisite is UT Level II certification, is it the intent that they also complete additional training and experience (in TOFD and phased array) as well as Level II examinations (TOFD and phased array – specific and practical) to satisfy all the requirements for certification for TOFD and phased array?

Response

1. Yes.
2. Yes.

Inquiry 12-2

This inquiry was a revision request and was sent to the SNT-TC-1A (2016) Revision Committee.

Inquiry 12-3

1. Are individuals who currently hold RT and UT certifications per SNT-TC-1A (2006) and are performing digital and computed radiography and phased array and TOFD required to take additional training to meet the training hour requirements of Table 6.3.1 A (2011) prior to their recertification?
2. As a Level III in the RT and UT methods, will I have to meet the new training requirements and then retest as a Level III?

Response

1. There are additional requirements in newer versions of SNT-TC-1A. If you wish to have your company RT personnel meet the SNT-TC-1A (2011) guidelines, then your RT personnel will have to meet the training hour requirements for digital radiography and computed radiography to become certified in those techniques. If you continue to cite SNT-TC-1A (2006) in your written practice, this would not be

- necessary. The same applies to UT personnel and the TOFD and phased array techniques. Keep in mind that the SNT-TC-1A Foreword states, “It is recognized, however, that contracts require programs, which meet the intent of this document. For such contracts, purchaser and supplier must agree upon acceptability of an employer's program.”
2. To comply with the SNT-TC-1A (2011) guidelines that increase the scope of the employee Level III certificate, the employer should ensure that all certification requirements of SNT-TC-1A have been met including appropriate examinations.

Inquiry 12-4

Paragraph 8.5.4 is titled NDT Level I Practical examination, and the first sentence says, “Proficiency should be demonstrated in performing the applicable NDT on one or more specimens or machine problems approved by the NDT Level III.” The same statement is repeated in the first sentence in Paragraph 8.5.5 NDT Level II Practical Examination. Are “machine problems” intended to be for predictive maintenance Level I and II Practical examinations?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 12-5

The note under Paragraph 8.5.5 says, “While it is normal to score the Practical on a percentile basis, Practical examinations should contain checkpoints that failure to successfully complete will result in failure of the examination.”

1. Does this mean that an employer's checklist must have at least one checkpoint that must be successfully completed or the person fails regardless of having a Practical exam score that exceeds 70% as required by Paragraph 8.1.3;
2. Should the employer's Level III determine which checkpoint(s) will be a “kill point(s)”; and
3. Should this be recorded in the employer's written practice?

Response

1. Yes.
2. Yes.
3. Yes.

Inquiry 12-6

Is it the intent of Paragraph 8.2 that NDT personnel shall be qualified for all color contrast differentiation?

Response

Paragraph 8.2 says that the color contrast differentiation examination should demonstrate the capability of distinguishing and differentiating contrast among colors or shades of gray used in the method as determined by the employer.

Inquiry 12-7

Are UT personnel who are unable to distinguish and differentiate green and red color contrast disqualified from performing UT?

Response

No. The employer may perform additional examinations to determine whether or not the applicant can operate the equipment and properly evaluate resulting data.

Inquiry 12-8

I have NDT personnel performing MFL that were certified in the ET test method prior to ASNT making MFL an independent test method. Is it possible, in accordance with SNT-TC-1A (2011), to

certify these personnel in MFL based on their having met the requirements for ET certification prior to the removal of MFL from the ET test method?

Response

No. The earlier ET training hours that covered MFL can be applied to the MFL training hours shown in SNT-TC-1A (2011), but the full training time and experience will have to be documented, and an MFL examination is required.

Inquiry 12-9

Is it correct that an Authorized Inspector could insist the employer must perform hands-on Practical examination every two years for the Level I and II personnel, in order to fulfill the requirements of Paragraph 10.2 (periodical technical performance)?

As an employer, we would state on our written practice that the continuing NDT performance of the Level Is and IIs has been satisfied by the client and the appointed Level III, then they should be evaluated for good technical performance without taking any new hands-on Practical examination.

Response

Additional customer or regulatory requirements are beyond the scope of Recommended Practice No. SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 12-10

1. Would a certifying agency be in compliance with the intent of Paragraph 8.8(1)(c) [1992] and Inquiry 79-2 if the Basic exam included Level II questions in the method for which the candidate is being examined?
2. Is the intent of Paragraph 8.8(1) [1992] and Inquiry 79-2 that if certification in multiple disciplines is being sought that the Level II questions in these disciplines be excluded from the Basic exam?
3. Is the initial basic applicable for an individual seeking certification in another NDT method at a later date?

Response

1. Yes.
2. No. This would require multiple basic examinations because of the number of test methods available.
3. Yes. Paragraph 8.8(1) states that the Basic examination is required only once when more than one Method examination is taken.

Inquiry 13-1

Paragraph 9.4.9 of SNT-TC-1A (2006) says, "Signature of the Level III that verified qualifications of candidate for certification." If the candidate whose qualifications are being verified is an ASNT NDT Level III, must another Level III sign this verification?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 13-2

In SNT-TC-1A (2011), Paragraph 10.2 states, "Periodically, as defined in the employer's written practice, NDT Level I and II personnel should be reevaluated by the NDT Level III administering a Practical examination. The Practical examination should follow the format and guidelines described in Section 8.5."

Is it the intent of 10.2 that technical performance review be performed between certification periods, or is it acceptable to perform them when a person's certification comes due for renewal if that is how the evaluation period is defined in the employer's written practice?

Response

The intent is that the employer defines in the written practice when the technical performance review will be performed.

Inquiry 13-3

Based on the background information provided below, is it correct to assume that "qualified supervision" may only be provided by a certified Level II or III individual, or may supervision be performed by other non-certified management personnel (such as a quality assurance manager) if they are so designated in the employer's written practice?

Background

Paragraph 2.1.8 of SNT-TC-1A (2011) defines "experience" as "work activities accomplished in a specific NDT method under the direction of qualified supervision including the performance of the NDT method and related activities but not including time spent in organized training programs."

The only other place the word "supervision" is used is in Paragraph 4.3.1, which says in part, "The NDT Level I should receive the necessary instruction and supervision from a certified NDT Level II or III individual."

Response

Yes, the intent of "qualified supervision" is supervision by personnel who are certified Level II or III in the specific method.

Inquiry 13-4

As shown in the 2011 background information, Paragraphs 4.2 and 4.3.1 use the term "certified individual," but 4.3 uses the term "levels of qualification."

Should "and certification" be added to 4.3 to indicate that the basic levels of qualification are also the basic levels of certification so that 4.3 reads, "The three basic levels of qualification and certification are as follows."

Background

Paragraph 4.2 states in part, "A trainee should work with a certified individual"; Paragraph 4.3 states, "The three basic levels of qualification are as follows"; and Paragraph 4.3.1 states in part, "The NDT Level I should receive the necessary instruction and supervision from a certified NDT Level II or III individual."

Response

This is a suggested revision and not a request for interpretation, so it was forwarded to the SNT-TC-1A Review Committee for consideration in the next revision.

Inquiry 13-5

According to SNT-TC-1A (2011), is it acceptable that an employer considers training and examination received prior to completion of experience requirements as evidence of qualification?

Background

Employer will permit a new employee as trainee only if the trainee has subject knowledge and ability to use equipment/technique safely is established, thus seeking organized training before experience.

Response

Yes. Training and examination are partial requirements for the qualifications. A person cannot be considered qualified until all qualification requirements (training, examinations, experience, and visual acuity test) have been met.

Inquiry 13-6

1. SNT-TC-1A (2011) allows for modification of detailed recommendations as necessary for the particular needs of the employer. In Table 6.3.1B where it requires practical review of 1000 radiographs for the limited certification of radiologic testing (RT) film interpretation, does SNT-TC-1A allow for a reduction in the practical review of the radiographs to suit a specific sector?
2. SNT-TC-1A requires a Level II qualification to allow for limited certification and qualification in a specific method (RT film interpretation). Is this a requirement that does not allow for change to suit the employer needs in its specific sector?

Background

1. This is to stipulate the requirements for industrial experience in a specific sector of the employer that needs to draw up a written practice for its needs.
2. Limited qualifications are obtained for authorized inspection authorities to sign off images, with the intent to accept or reject the images for quality assurance purposes.

Response

1. SNT-TC-1A requires the employer develop a written practice and, where necessary, modify the requirements of SNT-TC-1A to meet its needs, pending customer acceptance of those changes.
2. SNT-TC-1A requires the employer develop a written practice and where necessary modify the requirements of SNT-TC-1A to meet its needs, pending customer acceptance of those changes.

Inquiry 13-7

Paragraph 10.2 states, "Periodically, as defined by the employer's written practice..."

Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A (2011) to perform the described technical performance demonstration in a greater frequency than the certification period, as defined by the employer's written practice? Why does the Paragraph not specify a known time period as a minimum or maximum amount of time?

Furthermore, for clarification, a suggestion for the paragraph would be, "Periodically, as defined in the employer's written practice, NDT Level I and II personnel should be reevaluated by the NDT Level III administering a Practical examination. The Practical examination should follow the format and guidelines described in Section 8.5. This review should be performed at least once during the certification period."

Response

The intent is that the employer defines in their written practice when the technical performance review will be performed.

The second part of your inquiry will be forwarded to the SNT-TC-1A Review Committee for consideration in the 2016 edition.

Inquiry 13-8

Can electronic signatures be used to issue a formal NDT examination report and have the same legal effect as hand-signed reports?

Background

My company wishes to employ electronic signatures to approve formal NDT reports through our laboratory information managing systems in the steel plant. The purpose is to increase our report filing efficiency and to save time and paperwork.

Response

The question of how inspection reports are signed is outside of the scope of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 13-9

According to SNT-TC-1A (2006), may the employer modify its written practice as per Paragraph 1.4 and accept the documentation of prior certification as per Paragraph 6.1 issued by an outside Level III or an institute as evidence of qualification to meet training, experience, and General examination requirements if so written in employer's written practice, and may it conduct Specific and Practical examinations for prior level of certification to meet its specific requirements?

Background

According to Paragraph 1.4, the employer may modify the guidelines of SNT-TC-1A when preparing the written practice to suit its specific requirements. Paragraph 6.1 of SNT-TC-1A for initial certification states, "Documentation of prior certification may be used by an employer as evidence of qualification for comparable levels of certification." Qualification as per SNT-TC-1A is defined as documented training, documented experience, demonstrated knowledge, and demonstrated skill.

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 13-10

As per Paragraph 2.1.12 of SNT-TC-1A (2006), is it correct to say that knowledge is demonstrated when you clear the written examination (general and specific) and skill is demonstrated when you clear the Practical examination?

Background

Qualification is defined in Paragraph 2.1.12 as demonstrated knowledge, demonstrated skill, documented training, and documented experience.

Response

No. Paragraph 2.1.12 is a definition, not a statement of requirements. Paragraph 9.2 says that certification of NDT personnel shall be based on demonstration of satisfactory qualification in accordance with Sections 6, 7, and 8, as described in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 13-11

Does the technical performance evaluation mentioned in Paragraph 12.1.1 of SNT-TC-1A (2006) refer to the periodic technical performance evaluation as mentioned in Paragraph 10.2?

Background

Paragraph 12.1 states that "all levels of NDT personnel shall be recertified periodically in accordance with one of the following criteria..."

Paragraph 12.1.1 mentions one of the criteria as "Evidence of continuing satisfactory technical performance."

Response

No. Paragraph 10.2 says, "The [technical performance] evaluation and documentation should follow the format and guidelines described in Section 8.5." Section 8.5 describes the Practical examination. The "continuing satisfactory technical performance" mentioned in 12.1.1 refers to evidence of having satisfactorily performed those tasks that are relevant to the level of qualification of the person being evaluated.

Inquiry 13-12

1. In SNT-TC-1A (2011), in the column titled “Minimum Hours in Method,” 160 hours is shown for both time of flight diffraction (TOFD) and phased array ultrasonic testing (PAUT). Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that a UT Level II wishing to get one of those endorsements have 160 hours in that specific technique, or can the 160 hours be in any technique within the UT method?
2. Is a UT Level III required to have the additional training hours and experience to be able to teach and/or perform the PAUT and TOFD techniques?

Response

1. The 160 experience hours should be specific to the technique being acquired.
2. The recommendations in Table 6.3.1A are intended for Level I and II personnel. A Level III is responsible for staying current in emerging technologies and is supposed to be sufficiently knowledgeable in all of the techniques.

Inquiry 14-1

We engage an outside agency to provide NDT Level III services. In SNT-TC-1A (2011), Paragraph 9.3 states in part that the responsibility of certification of the employees should be retained by the employer. Paragraph 12.1.2 states that reexamination in those portions of the examinations in Section 8 are deemed necessary by the employer’s NDT Level III.

Since we engage the services of an outside agency for Level III, does the outside agency’s Level III determine which portions of the examinations in Section 8 are necessary?

Response

Yes, as authorized by the contracting employer.

Inquiry 14-2

In SNT-TC-1A (2011), Table 6.3.1A, Note 8.0:

1. May the experience requirements for UT Level II certification required as a prerequisite for phased array certification be gained by performing phased array or time of flight diffraction (TOFD) techniques under the direction/supervision of a qualified individual?
2. May an individual be certified directly to Level II phased array or TOFD?
3. Is it acceptable to further subdivide the ultrasonic technique of phased array into specifics (manual, encoded, automated data interpreter, and so on) and modify the training and experience requirements in the company written practice to reflect particular needs?

Response

1. Yes.
2. Yes, provided the sum of the training and experience hours for UT Level II and the applicable technique (phased array or TOFD) are met.
3. Yes, for Level II. See Inquiry 82-1.

Inquiry 14-3

Does hydrostatic leak testing fall under the “pressure change technique” in the leak testing method?

Background

The Federal Railroad Administration has requested that the Association of American Railroads add hydrostatic testing to MSRP C-III Specification for Tank Cars, Appendix T Nondestructive

Examination. Procedures to perform hydrostatic testing will be required and must be approved by a Level III. Also, personnel would be required to be trained, qualified, and certified in the hydrostatic technique.

Response

No, hydrostatic testing is not a technique covered for certification as a pressure change leak testing technique within the leak testing method under ASNT document SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 14-4

When applying Paragraph 6.3.2.1 (2006 edition) for Level III qualification in five methods (MT, PT, UT, RT, and VT) with graduation from a four-year college, is it acceptable to require in total one year of NDT experience beyond the Level II requirements (that is, total additional experience of 1600 hours in one or more of the five methods, as specified in our written practice), in excess of the total hours in NDT required for Level II, per Table 6.3.1A (that is, for RT and UT 1600 h), and documented work experience in each of the five methods fulfilling the required hours for Level I plus Level II as required per Table 6.3.1A for each of the five methods?

Response

The candidate should meet 100% of the Level I and II written practice requirements for a method before beginning the acquiring of additional time in that method for Level III.

It is intended that 100% of the experience time specified in Paragraph 6.3.2 be met in each applicable test method. The intent of the experience requirement of Paragraph 6.3.2 is that the candidate should be actively working and acquiring progressive experience in the methods for which certification is sought. Just “maintaining” a valid certification does not meet this intent. The employer’s written practice should specify the requirements regarding qualifying work time experience.

Inquiry 14-5

When requirements are changed on a new revision of an employer’s written practice, starting the effective date of the new revision, which requirements shall be followed for those personnel certified under the old revision? Should the new requirements in the new revision replace the older requirements in the previous edition for those personnel certified under the previous revision?

Response

Paragraph 6.0, Table 6.3.1A, and Table 6.3.1B apply only to *initial* experience required for qualification and certification. New requirements are not intended to be retroactive to previously certified individuals. The current written practice as it relates to recertification would be applicable at the time of recertification.

Inquiry 14-6

Paragraph 10.2 of the 2011 edition states the technical performance evaluation should be a Practical examination that should follow the format and guidelines described in Section 8.5. Practical examinations administered as part of the certification process (Section 8.5) are generally scheduled in advance and performed in a controlled environment using specimens or test props specifically selected and approved for the examination by the Level III for the examination.

1. Is the intent of the technical performance evaluation (Paragraph 10.2) to: (a) repeat the Practical examination administered during the certification process or (b) to be a more spontaneous, audit type evaluation, using at least 10 checkpoints covering the scope of the Practical examination that would more closely represent how the Level I/II executes the method on a daily basis?
2. Is the intent that the technical performance evaluation: (a) be scored on a percentile basis as required for a Section 8.5 Practical examination or (b) that any technique issues disclosed be documented and appropriate corrective actions taken?

Response

1. The periodic technical performance evaluation should follow the guidelines of Paragraph 8.5. Within those guidelines and the written practice, the Level III has the flexibility to tailor the examination to best evaluate technical performance. Both of the suggested approaches are within the guidelines of SNT-TC-1A.
Note: This response is not intended to limit acceptable approaches to the two suggested by the inquirer.
- 2a. Yes.
- 2b. Yes.

Inquiry 14-7

Regarding Paragraph 8.2 of SNT-TC-1A (2011), who may be responsible to carry out the vision acuity examination? We have in our written practice three possible options:

1. Performed by a nurse and approved by an NDT Level III; or
2. Performed by an ophthalmologist and approved by an NDT Level III; or
3. Performed by the NDT Level III.
Are all correct?

Response

SNT-TC-1A does not address who should conduct the visual examination. All three of the options would be acceptable if addressed in the written practice.

Inquiry 14-8

1. Can Level IIIs certified under a certification program other than SNT-TC-1A (ISO 9712, EN ISO 9712, and so on) perform Level III functions in an SNT-TC-1A program if the employer can show that the Level III requirements of the other program meet or exceed the SNT-TC-1A guidelines for Level III and the use of that certification program is documented in the employer's written practice?
2. If Company A subcontracts NDT work to Company B, are Company B's NDT personnel required to be certified in accordance with Company A's written practice, or can they perform the work using certifications issued in accordance with their own (Company B's) written practice?

Response

1. Yes.
2. When the performance of NDT is subcontracted to an outside organization and the outside organization is the direct employer of the individual performing NDT, the outside organization is the "employer" in terms of SNT-TC-1A. Whether the outside organization is properly qualifying and certifying its NDT personnel can only be determined by the purchaser of such outside services, and how such determination is made is a contractual matter between the purchaser and the outside organization.

Inquiry 14-9

Under the 2011 edition of SNT-TC-1A:

1. Can a UT Level III certify other employees to Level II in phased array and time of flight diffraction (TOFD)?
2. Since SNT-TC-1A (2011), Table 8.3.4, "Minimum Number of Examination Questions" does not show a minimum number of questions for the phased array and TOFD General examinations, does this mean that no General examination is required to add the Level II phased array and TOFD endorsements?

Response

1. Yes.

General Comment

There is no additional Level III certification for phased array or TOFD; it is the responsibility of the Level III in a method to know their limitations and qualification in the various techniques. Qualification is defined as demonstrated skill, demonstrated knowledge, documented training, and documented experience required for personnel to properly perform the duties of a specific job.

2. Yes.

Inquiry 14-10

According to SNT-TC-1A (2011), if a person is being qualified directly to Level II, do they need to take both the Level I and Level II examinations, or can they take just the Level II examinations?

Response

Only the examinations for the level of certification being sought are required.

Inquiry 15-1

In Table 6.3.1 A under Experience, the "Minimum Hours in Method" recommendation for UT Level II is 630 hours. My questions are:

1. What was the intent of the committee when it identified the need of 630 hours of Level II experience; and
2. Of those 630 hours, how many hours should be in performing angle beam examinations?

Response

1. The intent is that 630 hours of ultrasonic testing experience be gained as a Level I in the techniques and applications covering the scope of ultrasonic applications related to the employer operations.
2. SNT-TC-1A does not define the breakdown of hours by technique. The Responsible Level III should identify the scope of ultrasonic applications and make sure the Level I to Level II development experience is sufficient in each technique and application.

Inquiry 15-2

According to Paragraph 8.1.1.1, a qualified representative of the NDT Level III shall be designated after appropriate instruction by the responsible NDT Level III. Question: Who is that responsible person?

Response

The assigned Level III, as provided for in the employer's written practice, is the responsible person.

Inquiry 15-3

1. Who should be responsible for conducting [the] vision exam?
2. Are vision exams mandatory for ASNT NDT Level IIIs if they regularly perform an NDT test, calibrate equipment, and interpret and evaluate results?
3. Are the vision requirements mandatory for all levels of NDT who regularly perform NDT tests, calibrate equipment, and interpret and evaluate results?
4. Can an ASNT NDT Level III approve [the] quality assurance or quality control manager to perform vision exam[s] on all levels of NDT, including NDT Level III?

Response

1. The employer's written practice should designate who is responsible for conducting the vision examinations.
2. Yes.
3. Yes.
4. Any personnel designated in the employer's written practice may administer the vision tests. (See Inquiry 01-6.)

Inquiry 15-4

My understanding of Table 6.3.1 A Note 7 is, that if a person is certified in RT and wishes to add computed radiography, they need only an additional 24 hours of computed radiography experience to become certified (assuming they have had the additional 24 hours of training). Correct?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 15-5

In the 2006 edition of SNT-TC-1A, in Paragraph 9.4.9, for the purposes of certification by an employer, must a Level III's qualifications be verified by another Level III prior to certification by the employer?

Response

The employer's Level III must have documented verification that their Level III's qualifications meet the examination requirements of SNT-TC-1A. The documented verification should carry the signature of a Level III.

Inquiry 15-6

Paragraph 8.7.1.3 of the 2011 edition of SNT-TC-1A says, "A valid ASNT NDT Level II certificate may be accepted by the employer's written practice as fulfilling the general examination criteria described in Paragraph 8.3 for each applicable method."

Does a Magnetic Particle Inspection Level 2 certificate of completion issued by the Canadian Welding Bureau Institute (CWBi) showing that the required training and examinations were completed and stating that the services were in accordance with SNT-TC-1A and ANSI/ASNT CP-189 meet this requirement?

Response

No. The cited reference paragraph only addresses certificates issued by ASNT.

Inquiry 15-7

1. Per Paragraph 6.3.2.2, does the requirement for two years of experience apply to initial certification only or does it apply to every method?
2. After passing my first NDT Level III method, can I sit for additional methods as long as I fulfill the requirement of Table 6.3.1 A, or do I need to document two years of experience for each method?

Response

1. It applies to each applicable method.
2. The requirement for experience in any additional method would not be met until the two-year experience beyond NDT Level II requirement—as defined in Table 6.3.1 A—in an assignment at least comparable to that of an NDT Level II in the additional method are met.

Inquiry 15-8

1. When performing recertification in accordance with Paragraph 12.0, is the only acceptable evidence of continuing satisfactory technical performance a reexamination performed using a flawed specimen?
2. If the answer to 1 above is no, when performing reexamination in those portions of the examinations in Section 8 as deemed necessary by the Level III, is it acceptable to perform an examination by the candidate employing the applicable NDT method with an approved procedure on production samples that do not have a known flaw?

Response

1. No. See Inquiry 91-4, Part 2, and Part 2 of the Response.
2. Yes.

Inquiry 15-9

Should certification documents contain dates of assignment to NDT as required by Paragraph 9.4.10 (2011 edition)?

Response

The intent of "dates of assignment to NDT" in Paragraph 9.4.10 is that the employer, as a minimum, document the start and end date of employment assignments that affect the nature of the NDT work done by the individual.

Inquiry 15-10

Per Paragraph 7.1 of the 2011 edition of SNT-TC-1A, can classroom training be given by a Level II and the training certificate be signed by that Level II?

Response

See Inquiry 09-4.

Inquiry 15-11

Can an employer create a Limited Level I certification and delete the NDT Level II or III supervision requirement described in Paragraph 4.3.1 (2011 edition) if properly documented in the company's written practice?

Response

No.

Inquiry 16-1

1. Table 6.3.1 C (2006 edition) allows Level II limited certification for film interpretation and digital radiography, but I cannot find a definition for digital radiography anywhere in SNT-TC-1A.
2. Is there a definition for digital radiography, and does this table permit personnel with limited digital radiography certifications to perform all of the functions of a Level II radiographer, that is, taking the actual X-ray, positioning parts, assigning IQIs, or anything else to do with actually testing of the part?

Response

1. Defining radiography is not an interpretation of SNT-TC-1A.
2. No. The title of the table is *Limited Certification*. The formal hours and minimum work experience is intended to address digital image interpretation.

Inquiry 16-2

The appendix of example questions (Level I and Level II) has a note in the opening paragraph that states, "All questions and answers should be referenced to a recognized source."

What is considered *recognized*?

Response

Paragraph 4.3.3 makes the Level III responsible for training and examining NDT Level I and II personnel for certification. That implies that the Level III is responsible for selection of the reference material, approval of lesson plans, and so on. In designating student study material and handouts, the Level III is recognizing such material.

Inquiry 16-3

1. Do Paragraphs 5.3 and 5.4 of SNT-TC-1A (2011) require the written practice to clearly identify and describe each technique for certification for PT, MT, VT, and so on, whose techniques are not specified in Table 6.3.1 A and 6.3.1 B?
2. If yes, should NDE techniques for above be identified and described as specified in T-X50 of ASME Boiler & Pressure Vessel Code (BPVC), Section V, 2015 edition?

Response

1. SNT-TC-1A is intended to provide the employer with adequate flexibility to accommodate a variety of special needs, as documented in the written practice. The methods and techniques presented in SNT-TC-1A, along with the training outlines in ANSI/ASNT CP-105, are guidelines based on method committee input from multiple industries.
2. Application to other codes and standards is beyond the scope of the SNT-TC-1A Interpretation Committee.

Inquiry 16-4

For sections: ASME Code: I, IV, VIII; B31.1; B31.3 2015 edition, the Recommended Practice No. SNT-TC-1A 2006 edition shall be used. For ASME Code III, the recommended practice SNT-TC-1A shall be used.

Question

Is it possible to write another written practice per the 2011 edition and also keep active the actual written practice per the 2006 edition, or what do I have to do in order to be covered?

Response

This inquiry is not a request for SNT-TC-1A interpretation. Guidance on implementation to other codes and standards is beyond the scope of the SNT-TC-1A Interpretation Committee.

Inquiry 16-5

Regarding classification of methods in Paragraph 3 and responsibilities of the Level III in 4.3.3, some clarification is required.

1. Can a UT Level III certify for phased array, time of flight diffraction, GWT Level I/II?
2. Can an employer incorporate GWT on the UT techniques in their written practice and certify employees?

Response

1. Yes. See Inquiry 09-1, response 1.a: for an explanation of who can approve certification.
2. No. Guided wave testing is a separate method.

Inquiry 16-6

Does SNT-TC-1A (2011) Paragraphs 5.4 and 5.5 require the employer's written practice to address requirements for each technique of an examination method used by an employer, even if the technique is not specifically listed in Table 6.3.1 A?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 16-7

According to ASME BPVC VIII 2-2016, SNT-TC-1A (2006) is the applicable edition. According to ASME BPVC III NCA-2015, SNT-TC-1A (2011) is the applicable edition. Which edition should be referenced for the qualification and certification of nondestructive personnel: 2006, 2011, or the last 2016 edition? Or all of these?

Response

The request is not an interpretation of SNT-TC-1A and all of the above requests should be directed to ASME.

Inquiry 16-8

For a Level III certified under ISO 9712 who wants to be certified ASNT Level III in the same method, can the employer for the Basic examination (8.8.1 SNT-TC-1A [2006]) delete parts 8.8.1.1.2 and 8.8.1.1.3, as they are similar to the ISO 9712 2012 edition examination, if this is clearly specified in the employer written practice?

Response

Yes, if it is defined in the employer written practice.

Note: The ASNT Level III title is reserved for ASNT certificate holders only.

Inquiry 16-9

For a Level III certified under ISO 9712 who wants to be certified ASNT Level III in the same method, can the employer for the Method examination (8.8.2 SNT-TC-1A [2006]) delete parts 8.8.2.1 and 8.8.2.2 as they are similar to the ISO 9712 2012 edition examination, if this is clearly specified in the employer written practice?

Response

Yes, if it is defined in the employer written practice.

Note: The ASNT Level III title is reserved for ASNT certificate holders only.

Inquiry 17-1

As per Paragraph 6.3.2.2 of SNT-TC-1A (2006/2011 edition), an NDT Level III shall have completed with passing grade at least two years of engineering or science study at a university, college, or technical school, plus two additional years of experience beyond the NDT Level II requirements in NDT assignments at least comparable to that of NDT Level II in applicable NDT method(s).

Say person X is complying with the education requirements as per Paragraph 6.3.2.2. They have worked four years as a multitechnician in NDT methods RT, UT, MT, and PT. They were certified NDT Level II as per SNT-TC-1A 2006 edition in all four methods (complying with training and experience requirements).

Now the query is whether they are complying with experience requirements as per Paragraph 6.3.2.2 to become NDT Level III in all four methods, or if they will need a minimum of eight years of experience to become NDT Level III in all four methods? Can we consider them with four years of experience for NDT Level III certification in all four methods?

Response

See Inquiry 15-7 in *Interpreting SNT-TC-1A*. The two additional years of experience beyond Level II requirements in a method begins when the individual has met the requirements for Level II in that method. The NDT assignment at least comparable to that of NDT Level II must include the applicable NDT method in order to count for experience beyond Level II in that method. If the assignment includes multiple methods, experience may be gained simultaneously in all of the included methods.

Inquiry 17-2

Is it the intent of Paragraphs 8.5.4 and 8.5.5 to overwrite the scoring requirements of Paragraph 8.1.3 by requiring a minimum score of 100% for Level I and Level II Practical examinations?

Response

No.

The requirement to detect all discontinuities and conditions in Paragraphs 8.5.4 and 8.5.5 is limited to those specified by the NDT Level III.

Inquiry 17-3

Can an employer, who is acting as a certifying agency, certify oneself as a Level III (whose examination requirement is fulfilled by a valid ASNT NDT Level III or ACCP Professional Level III certificate in the applicable method) in its own company, as per the provisions of its written practice based on SNT-TC-1A, and also by providing the required evidence of education, training, and experience? Is such type of certification acceptable as per SNT-TC-1A?

Response

An employer may certify any employee as Level III provided the individual has satisfied the qualifications required by the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 17-4

Is it the intent of Paragraph 6.3.2.1 that to be certified as Level III in six methods (for example, RT, UT, MT, PT, VT, and ET), a person is required to have at least six years of experience with at least one year in each method before being certified to Level III in all the applicable methods, although they are already certified by ASNT as Level III in all six methods?

Response

See Inquiry 15-7 in *Interpreting SNT-TC-1A*. The one additional year experience beyond Level II requirements in a method begins when the individual has met the requirements for Level II in that method. The NDT assignment at least comparable to that of NDT Level II must include the applicable NDT method in order to count for experience beyond Level II in that method. If the assignment includes multiple methods, experience may be gained simultaneously in all of the included methods.

Inquiry 17-5

Are the training and experience requirements of Paragraph 6.3.2 of SNT-TC-1A satisfied if the person holds a current ASNT Level III certificate in the specific method?

Response

SNT-TC-1A does not address the Level III certificate as a verification that the certificate holder has met the training and experience requirements.

Inquiry 17-6

Can a company, whose primary business is not inspection, set up the SNT-TC-1A program to qualify a Level III employee by itself without using the services of an independent organization, provided they meet all the requirements of SNT-TC-1A?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 17-7

Is it the intent of Paragraphs 8.5.4 and 8.5.5 that the candidate has failed the examination if the candidate does not detect all discontinuities specified as mandatory and conditions specified by the NDT Level III?

Response

Yes, if specified as mandatory by the NDT Level III.

Inquiry 17-8

In regard to Table 6.3.1B: Initial Training and Experience Levels for NDT Level II Limited Certifications for Radiographic Film Interpretation (from SNT-TC-1A, 2011 and 2016 editions), is the intent that these are additional certifications for an RT Level II from Table 6.3.1A? In other words, does an RT Level II from Table 6.3.1A have to also have the film interpretation certification from Table 6.3.1B in order to read and interpret film?

Response

No.

Inquiry 17-9

1. All of the mentioned paragraphs indicate that an ASNT ACCP Level II may be accepted as fulfilling the requirements for testing in the qualification of applicants. Is this limiting, or intended to limit, the use of other third-party testing/training services?
2. For example, an applicant is trained and tested in accordance with ISO 9712 by a third-party organization that is ISO 9712 compliant, could this be considered to meet the requirements as well?
3. Would any third-party organization be acceptable as long as the Level III has determined that such examinations meet the requirements of their written practice?

Response

1. No.
2. Yes, as long as ISO 9712 is addressed in your written practice.
3. Yes.

Inquiry 17-10

Invalid request.

Inquiry 17-11

Invalid request.

Inquiry 18-1

The request was determined not to be an inquiry and beyond the scope of the Interpretation Committee.

Inquiry 18-2

I kindly request you to specify the possibility of appointing the specialist whose qualification meets requirements of Paragraph 6.3.2 SNT-TC-1A as a specialist of the 3 grade by the employer in accordance with his/her ISO 9712 certificate when SNT-TC-1A certification and appraisal system is implementation at our enterprise without further examination.

(Editor's Note: The inquirer is asking if they can accept an ISO 9712 Level III as their SNT-TC-1A Level III without additional training/experience/exam requirements.)

Response

The employer may accept the ISO 9712 certificate as satisfying some or all of the examination requirements in Section 8.7, if specified in the employer's written practice. (See Inquiry 16-8.) Note: The ASNT Level III title is reserved for ASNT certificate holders only.

Inquiry 18-3

1. Paragraph 5.4 refers to listing specific test techniques to be used in the written practice. Should test techniques that are not explicitly listed in Table 6.3.1A or Table 8.3.4 (e.g. water washable vs. solvent removable PT) be differentiated and listed in the written practice?
2. Paragraph 5.3 states that the written practice should list the training, experience, and examination requirements by method and technique, as applicable. When the employer's written practice lists techniques not explicitly listed in Tables 6.3.1A or 8.3.4, do the cumulative training and experience hours apply to the method rather than to each technique to be used in the method?

3. Table 8.3.4 lists a minimum number of examination questions by method and in some cases are further broken down by technique. If techniques are not listed in Table 8.3.4, is it acceptable to maintain the minimum number of general and specific questions listed for the method as long as questions for all of the techniques to be used by the employer are represented in those examinations?
4. For each technique that the trainee is to be qualified and certified to conduct, should a separate Practical examination be conducted for each of these techniques in accordance with Paragraph 8.5?

Response

1. Yes.
2. The training, experience, and examination requirements for techniques must be determined by the employer and specified in the employer's written practice.
3. Yes, if specified in the employer's written practice.
4. Yes, if separate Practical examinations are specified in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 18-4

The request was determined not to be an inquiry and beyond the scope of the Interpretation Committee.

Inquiry 18-5

If a person has previously qualified as NDT Level II that required recertification in according with Recommended Practice No. SNT-TC-1A, edition 2016, Section 12.2 (due to certification expiration date) to be performed by outside agency and the person has met all requirements of continuous performance satisfactory to the method referred, physical aptitude, level education, formal training, and experience, and has passed the Method examination then the new recertification interval shall be 5 years (not less)?

Response

The maximum recertification interval shall not exceed 5 years. The employer's written practice may specify a shorter period.

Inquiry 18-6

A company (employer) already has a written practice according to SNT-TC-1A (2016) and decides to contract an outside agency to recertify the personnel. In this case should the outside agency always follow the guidelines established in the written practice of the employer?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 18-7

Part 1:

SNT-TC-1A, 2011 and 2016 editions, Table 8.3.4, does not require a General exam for PAUT certification (nor for TOFD).

Table 6.3.1A, Note 10.0 in 2016 (Note 8.0 in 2011) specifies UT Level II certification as a prerequisite for the training and experience hours given in Table 6.3.1A.

Is it then the intent of SNT-TC-1A that SNT-TC-1A does not recognize the practice of certifying an individual to PAUT (or TOFD) alone; PAUT (and TOFD) use a current, valid UT Level II certification as a prerequisite and are considered “add-on technique endorsements” to an existing UT Level II certification? Therefore, the candidate has already passed a UT Level II General exam, and the PAUT (or TOFD) Specific exam is required because SNT-TC-1A requires the Specific exam to “address the equipment, operating procedures, and NDT techniques that the individual may encounter during specific assignments...”

As an example: Company B hires a new technician who was previously certified as a UT Level II and a PAUT Level II by the previous employer, Company A. Company B has documented evidence of the prior certification (including training hours, experience hours, and certification exam scores) of the technician's time at Company A (per SNT-TC-1A, Paragraph 13.2). Company B desires to certify the technician only in PAUT, not in conventional (fixed-angle) UT. There does not appear to be a mechanism in SNT-TC-1A to certify directly to PAUT without first certifying the individual in conventional (fixed-angle) UT.

Part 2:

1. Follow-up question: Does the note associated with Table 6.3.1A only apply to training and experience?
2. Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that an individual in the situation described above could be certified as a PAUT Level II by taking a UT Level II General exam, a PAUT Level II Specific exam, and a PAUT Practical exam?

Response

Part 1:

Yes, it was the intent of the subcommittee that only personnel already certified UT Level II may qualify for certification in PAUT or TOFD.

Part 2:

1. No.
2. No, the intent is the individual is a fully certified UT Level II, meaning the training, experience, and examination provisions have been fulfilled prior to qualifying for PAUT or TOFD.

Inquiry 18-8

The second note at the bottom of the checklist form in Appendix B states “No more than 10% false calls allowed.” Does the term “false call” mean false indication?

Response

No. Refer to the definition for “false call” in Addendum 1 of the 2016 edition of SNT-TC-1A, dated August 2018.

Inquiry 18-9

The remarks of the No. 1 checkpoint in Appendix B states “Did the output comply with the procedure?” What’s the meaning of “output”? Does it mean the product to be tested?

Response

Output compliance is the process of conducting NDT in accordance with the procedure.

Inquiry 18-10

Regarding examination of qualification requirements for ferromagnetic tube heat exchanger test (remote field test/RFT):

1. Can a Level I (II) qualification holder of the ECT or ACFM technique of the ET (electromagnetic) method perform a ferromagnetic tube heat exchanger test (remote field test)?
2. Is the ferromagnetic tube heat exchanger test (remote field test) only available for the RFT technique Level I (II) qualified personnel?
3. Do I have to perform the ferromagnetic tube heat exchanger test (remote field test) after qualification to Table 6.3.1A and Table 8.3.4?

Response

1. No.
2. Yes, to perform RFT, the individual shall be certified in the technique.
3. Yes.

Inquiry 18-11

Our firm provided training to our inspectors according to SNT-TC-1A (2011 version). It has been 5 years since the certifications were issued to them. Recertification would be necessary now. However, Recommended Practice No. SNT-TC-1A itself has been updated to the 2016 version. In such a situation, is it still valid to re-issue certificates to SNT-TC-1A (2011)? Or, are we entitled to issue certificates to SNT-TC-1A (2016) instead? Is there any specific requirement for the inspectors to update from the 2011 to the 2016 version?

Response

The version utilized by the employer is determined by the employer's written practice unless the purchasing requirements indicate otherwise.

Inquiry 18-12

In reference to Paragraph 8.1.1 (SNT-TC-1A, 2006 edition):

1. Must the subcontractor's employer be an organization who has a written practice using SNT-TC-1A as a guide in place and the subcontractor be qualified and certified by the employer in accordance with the written practice?
2. If the reply to question 1 is YES, is it mandatory for the manufacturer to collect and maintain the subcontractor's near vision acuity and color contrast differentiation examination records?
3. If the reply to question 1 is NO, can a self-employed person holding a valid ASNT Level III certificate be a subcontractor to do the mentioned above?
4. If the reply to question 1 is NO, is it mandatory for the manufacturer to collect and maintain the subcontractor's near vision acuity and color contrast differentiation examination records and continuous working records?

Response

1. No, but the subcontractor must meet the requirements as addressed in the customer's written practice.
2. N/A
3. Yes.
4. No.

Inquiry 19-1

The request was determined to be an improper submittal.

Inquiry 19-2

The request was determined to be an improper submittal.

Inquiry 19-3

In reference to Paragraphs 2.1.15, 5.4, 8.5.4, 8.5.5, and 9.4.2 (2016 edition):

1. Within the liquid penetrant testing method, is it required to consider solvent-removable and water-washable as separate techniques? And within the magnetic particle testing method, is it required to consider yoke and prod as separate techniques?
If the answer to question 1 is yes,
- 2a. Regarding reference 5.4, is it required that these techniques within the method be identified in written practice?
- 2b. Regarding references 8.5.4 and 8.5.5, is it required for a Level I or II candidate to complete separate Practical examinations in each of these techniques?
- 2c. Regarding reference 9.4.2, is it required that the personnel certification record include these techniques along with methods?

Response

1. Yes.
- 2a. Yes.
- 2b. Yes.
- 2c. Yes.

Inquiry 19-4

If an employer chooses to exceed the minimum examination guidelines of SNT-TC-1A Section 8.7 and require the Level III to also complete a Practical exam and performance demonstration exam in addition to the required Basic, Method, and Specific exams, is it ASNT's intent to still restrict the composite score to be determined by simple averaging of the Basic, Method, and Specific exams only, as specified in Paragraph 8.1.4, or would it be appropriate to include the scores of the additional examinations in the calculation of the composite grade?

Response

SNT-TC-1A does not address adding additional examination(s) to the designated examinations, therefore the Interpretation Committee is unable to comment on the appropriateness of doing so. Beginning with Inquiry 80-8 in 1980, the SNT-TC-1A Committee and its Interpretation Committee has maintained that the acceptance of a written practice is based on mutual agreement between the employer and the customer.

Inquiry 20-01

In reference to Paragraph 8.1.6 (2016 edition):

Per Paragraph 8.1.6, grades listed as "pass" from an outside agency may be accepted by the employer as 80% for that particular examination. Which of the following would be correct when completing the composite score on the certification record if all three

exams for a Level I/II are administered by an outside agency with all results being reported as "pass"?

1. Would the entry of "pass" as the composite grade be acceptable?
2. Would the composite score of "80%" (average of the three "pass" grades at 80%) be entered for the composite grade?
3. Would the outside agency need to provide the composite grade of the three exams, and would that be entered for the composite grade?

Response

The composite score should be shown as 80%.

Inquiry 20-02

In reference to Paragraph 12.2 (2016 edition):

1. How many questions does the Level I and II have to answer in the written examination for each method?
2. Is the written examination used for all NDT test methods (MT, PT, RT, UT, VT), or only for RT and UT?

Background

According to ASME BPVC Section V, Article 1 – Mandatory Appendix III, Edition 2019, Paragraph 12.1: "Recertification shall be by reexamination. Continued satisfactory technical performance shall not be utilized for recertification without reexamination."

Response

1. and 2. Paragraph 12.1.2 in Section 12 refers the reader back to Section 8 for guidance on the number of questions for each type of examination. The questions regarding the requirements to satisfy ASME BPVC Section V, Article 1, Appendix III should be directed to the ASME BPVC Section V committee, including which methods require recertification by written examination.

Inquiry 20-03

In reference to Paragraph 12.0 (2016 edition):

If a Level II is certified to the 2019 version of the employer's written practice with an expiration date of 2024, is the employee still certified if the employer modifies the written practice in 2020?

Response

Yes. (Note: this does not address other code body requirements.)

Inquiry 20-04

In reference to Paragraph 8.1.2 (3) (1980 edition):

If I put the following into my written practice: "Questions from the applicable ASNT *Questions & Answers Books* and appropriate reference books shall be used," is it acceptable to use the questions verbatim from the published ASNT *Questions & Answers Books* for my general examination questions?

Response

No. Examination questions from a publicly available resource do not meet the intent of a closed-book examination.

Inquiry 20-05

In reference to Paragraphs 7.2 and 8.3 (2016 edition):

Paragraph 7.2 requires sufficient examinations for training programs. Paragraph 8.3 requires a General exam. Is it permissible for Level I, II, and II Limited to combine both requirements into one exam that is taken at the end of the training in accordance with Table 8.3.4 for number of questions?

Response

Yes. Provided this is clearly specified in the employer's written practice, and to the satisfaction of the Level III responsible for the qualification and certification program [that] the certification examinations cover the body of knowledge contained within the course.

Inquiry 20-06

In reference to Paragraph 9.1 (2016 edition):

If I have the following in my written practice, "The required examinations may be administered prior to obtaining the prerequisite experience detailed in Appendix B. However, certification shall not occur prior to the completion of the training," can I give the General, Specific, and Practical exams before the candidate has completed obtaining the required documented experience hours and concurrent with training?

Response

Yes.

Please note General Comment (from Inquiry 89-6):

However, it is difficult to understand how an individual requiring experience in order to become qualified can satisfactorily pass an appropriately difficult Practical examination prior to obtaining the necessary experience. If an employer believes that this is satisfactory under some circumstances, these circumstances should be clearly specified in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 20-07

In reference to Paragraph 12.0 (2016 edition):

How many questions have to be asked for the recertification in the written exam: 10, 15, or 20 questions? How many technical performance [evaluations] do I have to do during the certification period: one or two, and when?

Response

Neither the number of questions on the recertification written examination nor the number of technical performance evaluations required is provided in SNT-TC-1A. The employer's written practice should detail all such requirements.

Inquiry 20-08

In reference to Table 6.3.1A and 8.3.4 (2016 edition):

Table 6.3.1A, Note 7, provides direction for when personnel are certified in a radiographic testing technique using a full-course format and are seeking certification in the same method in another technique.

1. Is there any similar direction in Table 8.3.4 for the required General and Specific examinations?
2. If personnel have achieved Level II in a method using a full-course format and would then take a reduction in training hours and

experience hours, would they be permitted to take a reduction in the number of General or Specific examination questions in the same method, but a different technique?

3. Would the previously mentioned personnel be required to take another General and Specific examination for the technique sought?
4. Can one General exam be created to the minimum amount exam questions in Table 8.3.4 that meets all of the method techniques?

Background

Personnel were certified to RT Level II utilizing a full-course format in the radiographic technique. They are now seeking certification in the computed tomography radiographic technique. There are reductions in education and training required due to the prior certification, but there does not appear to be any reductions for the General or Specific exam.

Response

1. No.
2. No, the General examination is a Method examination as stated in Paragraph 8.3.1.
3. Yes, for the RT method.
4. No.

Inquiry 20-09

Per the referenced definitions, an employer may acquire "qualified" personnel from any staffing company regardless of whether they have the background, guidelines, knowledge, or skill to properly "qualify" NDT candidates.

1. How can an outside agency, "without" a written practice "qualify" personnel and document experience?
2. And how could an employer vet the required experience hours have been achieved?

Response

Inclusion of "third-party agency" recognizes the existing practice of hiring contract NDT technicians for large projects, from companies specializing in providing such contract employees. Paragraph 2.1.9 describes the requirements of the employer utilizing such contract employees for NDT work. These requirements include addressing how they will be utilized and certified in the NDT company's written practice. That is, how the NDT company utilizing the contract employee establishes the individual has the demonstrated skill, demonstrated knowledge, documented training, and documented experience required for personnel to properly perform the duties of the specific job.

1. The outside agency does not "qualify" personnel or evaluate documentation. The employer responsible for the performance of NDT examinations is responsible for qualification and certification. This does not represent a change; the employer has always been responsible for qualification and certification of NDT technicians.
2. When utilizing a contract employee from a third-party agency, the employer should specify documentation requirements in accordance with their written practice including the certification requirements needed to perform NDT.

Inquiry 20-10

In reference to Table 6.3.1A and Note 7 (2016 and 2020 edition):

If someone is being trained to Level II without being a Level I, for film and nonfilm at the same time, how many hours of on-the-job training do they need? Without transitioning, do I have to use 840 + 840? Note 7 deals with transitioning from one to the next, and I can use 840 + 420 hours (50%).

Response

No reduction in experience hours for simultaneous qualification in two RT techniques is addressed in SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 20-11

In reference to Paragraphs 2.1.11 and 8.5.4 (2020 edition):

In structuring a Practical exam for a Level I operator of automated testing equipment, it appears that the concept of “false calls” does not apply since the operator does not make any calls. In these types of tests, is it acceptable to structure the Practical exam using checkpoints to verify that the operator successfully set up the equipment in accordance with the work instruction and delete the “false call” requirement for Level I operators?

Response

“The candidate should demonstrate familiarity with and ability to operate the necessary NDT equipment, record, and analyze the resultant information to the degree required” (Paragraph 8.5.1). It is not the intent to add requirements to meet SNT-TC-1A that are not required in the candidate’s job function. It would be appropriate to document the modification in an appendix in accordance with Paragraph 1.4.

Inquiry 20-12

In reference to Paragraph 2.1.12 (2020 edition):

1. In regard to Paragraph 2.1.12 (Definition of a Grading Unit), what is a qualification specimen?
2. Is it a specimen for Practical examination?
3. What is meant by flawed or unflawed grading units?
4. What does it mean by equal length or be equally spaced?
5. How can percentage of flawed/unflawed specimens be calculated?

Response

1. A qualification specimen is a sample used for the Practical qualification examination.
2. Yes.
3. The specimen (test piece) may have multiple flaws and the portion of the specimen containing each of those flaws may be approved by the [company] Level III as a grading unit. There may also be area(s) of the specimen that contain no flaw, that the Level III approves as a grading unit.
4. These areas may be of the same size or vary in size based on the sample.
5. The total number of grading units containing flaws divided by the total number of grading units $\times 100$ gives the percent of flawed grading units. The total number of grading units containing no flaws divided by the total number of grading units $\times 100$ gives the percentage of unflawed grading units.

Inquiry 21-01

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Table 6.3.1B

Table 6.3.1B, Limited Certification, lists “Film Interpretation.” Can film be interpreted to mean all formats of radiographic images (film, CR, DR)?

Response

No. While the physics of the radiographic process is similar for the three techniques, the imaging process and the interpretation of those images involves a very different process. Table 6.3.1A, Note 7.0, provides guidance when an individual is certified in a radiographic technique using a full-course format and wishes to certify in an additional radiographic technique.

Inquiry 21-02

Is detection rate the inverse of the false call rate?

Response

No. Definitions have been revised for the 2024 edition of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 21-03

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Table 6.3.1B and Table 8.3.4

When using the term “radiographer” in Tables 6.3.1B and 8.3.4, is ASNT referring to radiographers (IRRSP certified) as equivalent to RT NDT Level I?

Response

No. While the body of knowledge required for a Level I radiographer and IRRSP-certified radiographic personnel share some similarities; they are separate certifications with each requiring the mastery of a separate body of knowledge. See SNT-TC-1A (2020), Table 6.3.1A, Note: 8.0.

Inquiry 21-04

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Paragraphs 2.1.12, 8.4.4, and 8.5.6

Regarding the definition of “outside agency,” can NDT training organizations such as CINDE (Canadian Institute for NDE) or SAIT (Southern Alberta Institute of Technology), together with the ISO 9712 Certification Board NRCAN (Natural Resources Canada) and CGSB (Canadian Government Standards Board), be considered collectively an outside agency for the purpose of fulfilling the training and examination criteria for the General and Practical requirements of SNT-TC-1A?

Response

Yes. While not recognizing the certification schemes of those bodies mentioned for reciprocity of certification, those types of organizations may provide outside agency services. Those services being provided would need to be evaluated and approved as meeting or exceeding the specific training or testing requirements of SNT-TC-1A by the organization seeking to use them. The use of outside agencies should also be addressed in the organization’s written practice.

Inquiry 21-05

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 2.1.22

The definition of third-party agency is “a company or organization, without an established written practice, providing supplemental workforce to the employer; for example, a temporary staffing company.” Our external NDT service provider has their own written

practice. We want to hire their skilled NDT personnel to carry out NDT testing for our company. In this case would they still be considered a third-party agency?

Response

Yes. The external NDT service provider would be considered a third-party agency if they were providing (skilled) qualified personnel to be tested and certified under the provisions of your written practice.

Inquiry 21-06

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Paragraph 9.2

I would like clarification of Section 9.2 as it regards to someone who has current ASNT Level III certification. Can an employer designate a current ASNT Level III certified individual as an SNT-TC-1A NDT Level III after administering the required Specific and Practical exams to that individual?

Response

Yes. An employer may certify an employee as an SNT-TC-1A NDT Level III, as described in the employer's written practice, provided the individual has met the minimum training and experience requirements and holds a current ASNT NDT Level III certificate in the method and has satisfied the employer's Specific examination requirements in that method.

Inquiry 21-07

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Paragraphs 1.4 and 4.3

As per 1.4 of SNT-TC-1A (2016) it states that employer should modify them as necessary to meet the particular needs. Such modifications may alter but shall not eliminate basic provisions of the program such as training, experience, testing, and recertification. Supporting technical rationale for modification of detailed recommendations should be provided in an annex to the written practice.

Also, as per 1.1 of ASME Section V, Mandatory Appendix III, modifications that eliminate or reduce basic provisions of the program such as training, experience, testing, and recertification shall not be allowed.

Now, as per the above statement when preparing a written practice for my employer, am I allowed to change the 4.3 Level II duties that Level II personnel shall be able to prepare NDT procedures under the supervision of Level III?

Response

Yes. While the SNT-TC-1A Interpretation Committee cannot comment on requirements from other codes and standards, SNT-TC-1A provides the ability to modify SNT-TC-1A recommendations to the needs of the employer as stated in Paragraph 1.4.

Inquiry 21-08

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Paragraph 2.1.10

Paragraph 2.1.10 states "Limited Certification: nondestructive test methods may be further subdivided into limited disciplines or techniques to meet specific employer's needs; these are NDT Level II certifications, but to a limited scope."

1. Is it the intent of this paragraph that limited certification should not be applied for NDT Level I certification?
2. Can we use NDT Level I – Limited Certifications if so defined in employer's written practice?

Response

1. No.
2. Yes.

Inquiry 21-09

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Paragraph 8.7.1.1

Section 8.7.1.1 states that if you are adding another method, you do not need to take the Basic exam over again, [but] it does not talk about if you are recertifying. If you have an MT certification and you want to add a PT certification, you do not need another Basic exam but what about when you are recertifying for the original MT certification? If you have an ASNT certificate and you recertify by examination, you are not required to take the Basic examination over again. It is commonly held that once you have taken the Basic exam, you do not have to take it over again based on the wording in Section 8.7.1.1.

1. If you are recertifying [to] an employer's Level III by examination when you have only one certification, do you need to take the Basic examination along with the Method and Specific examinations?
2. If you are recertifying [to] an employer's Level III certification in one method by examination when you are certified in multiple methods, do you need to take the Basic examination along with the Method and Specific examinations?

Response

1. No.
2. No.

Inquiry 21-10

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Paragraphs 2.1.2, 8.7.3.1, and 9.4.12

The following pertains to contracted Level III services: I work for ABC Testing Company. I am utilizing my ASNT certificate for the Basic and Method examinations along with a Specific examination prepared by ABC Testing for my certification. I have been contracted to XYZ Machining to perform Level III services. I have taken a Specific examination prepared by XYZ Machining.

1. Who signs my certification?
2. Does the company I work for (ABC Testing) sign my certification as the certifying authority?
3. Does the company that is employing my Level III services (XYZ Machining) sign my certification as the certifying authority?
4. Do I need a certification signed by the certifying authority for both organizations?
5. If I only need a certification from ABC Testing, is the score from both Specific examinations averaged and reported in my certification record?

Response

1. The company or companies employing your Level III services under their program and using their written practice. (Note: While you may certify an individual you are contracting from an outside agency to your program, that is not required if you determine that the individual's employer certifications meet the minimum requirements of your program.)
2. Yes, if you are performing work under their program and written practice.
3. Yes, but only if you are performing work under the ABC Testing program and certifying you to their written practice and performing work under the XYZ Machining program and certifying you to their written practice.
4. Yes, but only if XYZ Machining is not accepting your ABC Testing certifications and choosing to certify you under their program and written practice.
5. Not applicable.

Inquiry 21-11

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Paragraphs 4.3.1, 4.3.2, and 4.3.3
Section 4.3.1 states that a Level I should be able to “properly perform specific calibrations, specific NDT, and specific evaluations.” Sections 4.3.2 and 4.3.3 do not speak to the ability of a Level II or III to possess the skill to perform specific NDT.

1. Based on the fact Section 4.3.2 does not contain any wording allowing it, can a Level II perform testing?
2. Based on the fact Section 4.3.3 does not contain any wording allowing it, can a Level III perform testing?
3. Is the Level III limited to the administration of the NDT program and interpretation of results?

Response

1. Yes. Section 4.3.2 does contain appropriate wording allowing it.
2. Yes. Section 4.3.3 does contain appropriate wording allowing it.
3. No, the Level III may perform all the duties of a Level II provided the Level III has taken and passed a Practical examination.

Inquiry 22-01

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Paragraphs 1.1, 8.5.1, and 8.5.2
As described in Paragraph 1.1 of SNT-TC-1A (2016): In a situation where individuals only witness NDT examinations due to their jobs.

1. Is it acceptable for a “surveyor” qualification to be based on witnessing results of nondestructive examinations, as described in the written practice?
2. Can a “surveyor” be certified as a Level II?
3. If so, would it need to be called a limited certification?

Response

1. Yes. The employer could create a unique certification such as a “surveyor.”
2. No. The position as described would not meet the requirements of a Level II.
3. No. This would be a unique certification called “surveyor” and would be based on the criteria described in the written practice for that specific certification.

Inquiry 22-02

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph: 8.2
Can a vision examination be administered and certified by a Level III, not qualified in visual testing?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 22-03

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Paragraphs 8.1.1 and 8.1.2

1. Does an ASNT NDT Level III have to undergo a Level III Specific examination conducted by an outside agency to become a qualified representative of the employer in order to conduct in-house NDT Level III examinations?
2. Can the same ASNT NDT Level III approve NDT Level III qualification examination questions if designated in writing by the employer?

Response

1. No. Paragraph 8.7.3.2 permits the employer to delete the Specific examination requirements altogether provided the candidate holds a valid ASNT NDT or ACCP Professional Level III certificate in the method and documented evidence of experience exists.
Note: This allowance has been deleted in the 2020 edition of SNT-TC-1A.
2. Yes. However, examinations which may be administered should not contain questions which they have authored and/or approved.

Inquiry 22-04

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Paragraph 8.7.3.1
Paragraph 8.7.3.1 states, “Twenty (20) questions relating to specifications, equipment, techniques, and procedures applicable to the employer’s product(s) and methods employed and to the administration of the employer’s written practice.”

1. Is it the intent of this paragraph that 20 questions should include questions related to the administration of the employer’s written practice?
2. If the answer is “yes,” then does the words “administration of the employer’s written practice” mean questions related to a specific requirement of applicable NDT methods in the written practice or any questions related to the employer’s written practice?

Response

1. Yes.
2. Questions which are related to the administration of the employer’s written practice.

Inquiry 22-05

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 8.1.4
Please provide clarification as to the correct method/formula that should be used when calculating the composite grade mentioned in Paragraph 8.1.4, if more than one Practical examination is administered.
Should the practical scores be added, averaged, and then added to other scores before obtaining the composite grade, or should each individual score be added to obtain a total, and the resultant total simply averaged?

Response

The composite score should include only one input for the General, Specific, and Practical examinations. Multiple General, Specific, and Practical exams should be averaged prior to inclusion into the final composite score.

Inquiry 22-06 Rev B

SNT-TC-1A (2016), Paragraph 6.0
May an employer accept a signed affidavit of training as an acceptable alternative to documented evidence?

Response

Yes, provided the process has been addressed in the employer’s written practice, supported by previous certification documentation, and approved by the employer’s Level III.

Inquiry 22-07

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 1.4

Section 1.4 allows an employer to provide a limited certification as long as there is a technical rationale for such modification.

1. Does the intent of this statement allow limited certifications in UT shear wave of groove welds only?
2. Is this limited certification justifiable for only 210 hours of experience?

Response

1. No.
2. No.

Inquiry 22-08

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraphs 8.1.8 and 10.2

1. If a Level III is performing testing and accepting production parts, does the Level III need to be reevaluated on a periodic basis by the administration of a technical performance evaluation?
2. If a technical performance evaluation is required for a Level III, can a Level II that has been properly delegated by the responsible Level III perform the oversight of the technical performance evaluation?
3. Would a Level II be considered a subordinate of the Level III, unable to administer the technical performance evaluation per Paragraph 8.1.8?

Response

1. No. (This topic is under review for future editions.)
2. Not applicable.
3. applicable.

Inquiry 22-09

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 11.0

1. What is meant by the term “Interrupted Service”?
2. Does interrupted service pertain to when an employee is still employed by the employer, but steps away from the employer for a period of time for a medical leave, military leave, leave of absence, etc.?
3. Does interrupted service pertain to when an employee leaves an employer, then has a gap in the time where the employee is not performing testing between the employment with the old employer and the employment with the new employer?
4. Does interrupted service pertain to when an employee is working for the employer, but not performing testing in a method for which certified for a period of time, such as six months? As an example, an employee is certified for RT, MT, PT, and VT, and they do not perform RT for six months, but are still performing testing in the remaining methods for which certified.
5. Does interrupted service pertain to when an employee is still working for the employer but is not performing testing or any other NDT-related activities in the methods for which certified?

Response

1. To be defined in the employer’s written practice.
2. If it is defined as such in the employer’s written practice.
3. This would be covered under Section 13.0, Termination.
4. If it is defined as such in the employer’s written practice.
5. If it is defined as such in the employer’s written practice.

Inquiry 22-10

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 8.1.3

Paragraph 8.1.3 states “All NDT Level I, II, and III written examinations should be closed book, except that necessary data, such as graphs, tables, specifications, procedures, codes, etc., may be provided with or in the examination. Questions utilizing such reference materials should require an understanding of the information rather than merely locating the appropriate answer.”

1. Does this paragraph apply if there are no references permitted to be used on either the General or Specific closed-book exams?
2. If a reference (i.e., NDT procedure) is permitted to be used during a Specific exam containing 20 questions from that reference, what would be a reasonable percentage of those questions that should not be simply “look-up and answer” style questions to meet the intent of that paragraph?

Response

1. No, it would not apply; however, the Specific exam requires the use of specifications or codes and acceptance criteria used in the employer’s NDT procedures.
2. Questions utilizing such reference materials should require an understanding of the information rather than merely locating the appropriate answer.

Inquiry 23-01

Paragraph 8.1.1 states that all qualification examination questions shall be approved by the NDT Level III responsible for the applicable method. Paragraph 1.5 allows a company to recognize third-party central certification examinations in place of employer examinations.

1. If my Written Practice recognizes third-party central certifications as detailed in paragraph 1.5, is my Level III required to review and accept the third-party examination questions? If yes, how would this be possible?
2. And what type of documentation would be acceptable?

Response

1. No, when using recognized third-party central certification programs as described in paragraph 1.5, the responsible Level III is not required to approve those examination questions.
2. The use of third-party central certifications satisfying the requirements for employer-based examinations shall be documented in the employer’s Written Practice.

Inquiry 23-02

1. Does a UT Level III need to be present to get on-the-job-training (OJT) hours for Level IIs in training (paragraphs 4.2 and 4.3.1)?
2. Or can we follow the company’s written procedure provided by the Level III on retainer?

Response

1. No, however, trainees must work under the direction of either a certified Level II or Level III individual. Further, training is administered as a formal process typically in a classroom setting, not administered “on the job” as the trainee is performing production tasks.
2. No, experience must be under the direction of either a certified Level II or Level III individual.

Inquiry 23-03

When conducting an unlimited qualification Level II Practical examination in Mass Spectrometer Leak Testing (technique), is it acceptable to implement only a Tracer Probe Practical examination, to qualify the individual in performing Tracer Probe, Sniffer Probe, Evacuated Envelope, and Gas Filled Envelope examinations (paragraphs 8.5.4 and 8.5.5)?

Response

Table 6.3.1 A states that Mass Spectrometer Leak Testing is a technique within the Leak Testing Method. It is up to the employer's NDT Level III to develop a Practical examination within that technique which would cover the applications performed by the candidate.

Inquiry 23-04

Does the NDT Level III, appointed as an Outside Agency (paragraph 2.1.16) for Level III Services by the employer of Level I and Level II examiners, need to undergo the Specific examination outlined in paragraphs 8.7.3 and 8.7.3.1 at the employer's (client's, customer's) location? This includes responsibilities such as training and examining NDT personnel, writing procedures, approving Written Practice, and participating in procedure demonstrations for the Authorized Inspector.

Response

The employer who uses Outside Agency Level III services is responsible for determining whether their qualifications and certifications meet the employer's Written Practice. The employer may accept the Outside Agency's Level III Specific examination or may choose to administer an additional Specific examination. This should be detailed in the employer's Written Practice.

Inquiry 23-05

What is the definition of "NDT Level III Services" (paragraph 2.1.16) by ASNT?

Response

ASNT has chosen not to define NDT Level III Services because the scope of services can be broad and vary from industry to industry and employer to employer. Paragraph 4.3.3 addresses some of the skills and duties that an NDT Level III might need or encounter and therefore this section could also be used as general guidance for NDT Level III Services.

Inquiry 23-06

Should the Specific exam (2016 edition) cover EVERY procedure, specification, and acceptance criteria in use at the employer? Many NDT service companies work to so many industries, specifications, and procedures that such a requirement would impose a specific exam requiring thousands of questions. Where some industries are imposing SNT-TC-1A as mandatory requirements, they're interpreting this section of SNT-TC-1A to mean EVERY procedure.

Response

No. Specific examinations should address the operating procedures that are representative of the techniques that the individual may encounter during their specific assignments, to the degree required by the employer's Written Practice (paragraph 8.4.1). Paragraph 8.4.2 then follows up by stating that questions relating to specifications, codes, and acceptance criteria used in those procedures should be included in the Specific examination. This further clarifies the intent of Inquiry 79-13 and this response supersedes this previous inquiry.

Inquiry 23-07

In regard to gaining experience prior to certifying as a Level III (1988 edition), is it required to fulfill all of the requirements for certification in the NDT method where certification is being sought to Level II prior to starting to accrue experience for certification to Level III?

Response

Yes. Level II requirements must be met first (paragraph 6.3).

Inquiry 23-08

1. Do Inquiry 84-2 and Inquiry 85-5 still stand with the 2020 edition of SNT-TC-1A?
2. Can a Level I perform an NDT examination in accordance with written procedures and acceptance standards without the presence of a Level II or Level III NDT person at the time of examination?

Response

1. No. SNT-TC-1A wording was changed from necessary instruction "or" supervision to "and" supervision in the 2006 edition (paragraph 4.3.1).
2. No.

Inquiry 23-09

1. Referring to the 2001 edition, can the questions from the *ASNT Questions & Answers Books* be used verbatim on the Level III qualification exams?
2. Does changing one word in a question from the *ASNT Q&A Books* make the question no longer verbatim?
3. If I change the order of the answers, does this mean the exam is no longer verbatim from the *Q&A Books*?

Response

1. No.
2. No. Paragraph 8.6 specifically states that the intent of the *Q&A Books* are to provide examples of questions and are NOT to be used verbatim. The intent of the SNT-TC-1A Committee is that the question writer should take the ASNT questions and write unique questions which are similar in meaning and content.
3. No.

Inquiry 23-10

1. Does the NDT Level II or Level III need to materially participate in the testing with the NDT Level I (2016 edition)?
2. Is it acceptable for a single Level II to watch five Level Is spread out over approximately 200 ft within one building?

Background

Ultrasonic testing is being performed in three different buildings in a facility by nine NDT Level Is and a single NDT Level II who is in an office in a building that is separate from where the testing is performed. The NDT Level II does not materially participate in the testing and cannot observe the testing from the office he is located in. The NDT Level I completes the testing, the report, and then the Level II signs the completed reports.

Response

1. Yes. The Level II or III is to provide the necessary instruction and supervision to Level I personnel, as they have the responsibility for on-the-job training and guidance for those individuals (paragraph 4.3.2).
2. No. It is difficult to envision how multiple Level I personnel could be adequately OJT trained and supervised when working remotely from a Level II or III who is to exercise that responsibility. As an example, training and supervision should be in direct sight and hearing distance of the Level Is, which may include video and audio monitoring.

Inquiry 23-11

In regard to the need for a candidate to detect the discontinuities and conditions specified by the Level III (2011 edition):

1. Does the Level III need to document the discontinuities and conditions to be detected by the candidate?
2. Does the Level III need to document that the candidate discovered the discontinuities and conditions specified by the Level III?

Response

1. Yes. Paragraph 8.5.3 requires that information to be documented.
2. Yes. Both paragraphs 8.5.4 and 8.5.5 require a checklist be used to document the results of the Practical examination.

Inquiry 23-12

Can the training outlines be contained in a separate document as long as the Written Practice identifies the document where the outlines may be found (Table 6.3.1 A Note 4, 2011 edition)?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 23-13

Paragraph 2.1.13 states that NDT certifications may be further subdivided into limited disciplines or techniques to meet specific employers' needs; these are NDT Level II certifications, but to a limited scope.

1. Table 6.3.1 A breaks Radiographic Testing into four techniques—Radiography, Computed Radiography, Computed Tomography, and Digital Radiography; and provides training and experience hours necessary to meet these requirements. My interpretation, based on the above, is that Level IIs would have a limited RT certification if they were trained and tested to only one of these techniques. Would it also be safe to say that the Level II's certification would be further limited to the product (welds, castings, etc.) that they are trained and tested to inspect?
2. Table 6.3.1 B identifies initial training and experience levels for NDT Level II limited certifications, but breaks down the certification by the technician's starting point: non-radiographer versus RT Level I. My interpretation is that this table and associated notes further limit the above initial limitation of question 1 based on the inspector's level of knowledge in radiographic operations.
3. Is paragraph 8.5.2.2 applicable to both situations above?
4. Is my interpretation way off? Please provide ASNT's intent with respect to limited certifications.

Response

1. No. SNT-TC-1A does not place further limitations on certifications other than what is already published, but does not prohibit an employer from describing additional limitations or restrictions within their Written Practice.
2. No.
3. No. Paragraph 8.5.2.2 specifically states it applies to Film Interpretation Limited Certification which is discussed in Table 6.3.1 B.
4. SNT-TC-1A addresses limited certification within a method (Table 6.3.1 A) and also within a technique (paragraph 4.1 and Table 6.3.1 B). Limited certifications and specific limitations and requirements beyond the training and experience discussed in SNT-TC-1A should be addressed in the employer's Written Practice.

Inquiry 23-14

If a person holds a current certification with another firm, paragraph 6.1 states that the previous certification may be used as evidence of qualification. Are additional assessments required or mandated to allow the Company Level III to issue certification under the new organization's Written Practice?

Response

Yes. Section 6.0 pertains only to the education, training, and experience qualification requirements for certification by the new employer, with that process being addressed in the employer's Written Practice. Previous certifications are not transferable to a new employer, who is responsible for administering qualification examinations in accordance with Section 8.0.

Inquiry 23-15

An NDT Level III whose certification has been terminated in Company A; may the certification be reinstated to the former NDT level in Company B, without a new examination, when all of the paragraph 14.1.1, 14.1.2, and 14.1.3 (SNT-TC-1A 2020 edition) conditions are met?

Response

No. Reinstatement pertains to the employee's previous employer who issued the certification, not a new employer.

Inquiry 23-16

If documentation of formal training is required (paragraph 9.4.3, 2016 edition), what type of documentation is acceptable for proof of the formal training of NDT personnel?

1. Is a training certificate acceptable?
2. Is a training sign-in sheet acceptable?
3. Is a resume acceptable?
4. Is a verbal statement from the certified person which is documented on the certification certificate acceptable?

Response

1. Previous Interpretations 77-10 and 22-06 provide some guidance when direct documented evidence is not available. The acceptability, as determined by the Level III, and described in the employer's Written Practice must be supported by some sort of objective evidence. Yes.
2. Yes, depending on the amount of information included on the sign-in sheet.
3. No.
4. No.

Inquiry 23-17

Paragraph 9.4.3 of SNT TC-1A (2016 edition) requires the certification record contain information pertaining to the educational background of NDT personnel. What type of documentation is acceptable for proof of the educational background of NDT personnel?

1. Is a diploma acceptable?
2. Is a transcript acceptable?
3. Is a resume acceptable?
4. Is a verbal statement from the certified person which is documented on the certification certificate acceptable?

Response

Previous Interpretations 77-10 and 22-06 provide some guidance when direct documented evidence is not available. The acceptability, as determined by the Level III and described in the employer's Written Practice, must be supported by some sort of objective evidence.

1. Yes.
2. Yes.
3. No.
4. No.

Inquiry 23-18

1. Does paragraph 4.3.3 of SNT-TC-1A imply that a current NDT Level III can use procedures approved by the previous Level III?
2. Is it the intention of the paragraph that all NDT procedures used by an employer must be approved by the current cognizant NDT Level III?

Response

1. Yes.
2. No.

Inquiry 24-02

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraphs 8.3, 8.4, 8.7

The SNT-TC-1A 2020 edition does not provide clarification that questions in the personnel certification exams should all be unique questions. Would certification exams containing duplicate questions still satisfy the required number of questions? Or is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A that in order to meet the required number of questions, all exam questions should be unique?

Response

No. The intent of SNT-TC-1A Table 8.3.4 is to have the required number of questions be unique, one of a kind, and not duplicate questions within the examination.

Inquiry 24-03

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraphs 9.5, 9.5.7

Paragraph 9.5 addresses recommendations for certification certificates and wallet cards. Paragraph 9.5.7 states "The certificate or wallet card should be fully completed at the time of signing by the designated NDT Level III and/or certifying authority so that no fill-in-the-blank data remains to be completed by others." This implies employers may choose either certification certificates or wallet cards.

When a code or standard invoking SNT-TC-1A as "mandatory minimum requirements and shall not be considered

recommendations or guidelines," what is the intent of SNT-TC-1A as it relates to the following questions:

1. Is it the intent of SNT-TC-1A for employers to use both certification certificates and wallet cards?
2. Can an employer choose to use certification certificates or wallet cards or both?

Response

1. No.
2. Yes.

Inquiry 24-04

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraphs 8.1, 8.3, 8.4

1. Is it the intent of the Recommended Practice that all written examinations undertaken, paragraph 8.1.3, shall consist of questions structured within a multiple-choice fashion?
2. Is it the responsibility of the employer to define the type and structure of examination questions for those components of the examinations within paragraphs 8.3 and 8.4?

Response

1. Yes. Paragraph 8.3.3 provides examples of typical questions [in the Appendix].
2. Yes.

Inquiry 24-05

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Sections 8.0 and 10.0

The Technical Performance Evaluation within certification tenure is mandatory. Frequency is the employer's choice and the responsibility lies on the NDT Level III. As stipulated in Section 8.0 Examinations, administration and grading can be delegated to a Qualified Representative of NDT Level III. Can the Technical Performance Evaluation be delegated to a Qualified Representative of NDT Level III?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 24-06

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraphs 8.5.2, 8.5.4, 8.5.5

Does the intended meaning of paragraphs 8.5.4 and 8.5.5 suggest that when an employer uses various techniques within a method, such as PT; the Practical examination must include at least one specimen for each of the water-washable and solvent-removable techniques?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 24-07

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 8.6

1. Does the intent of paragraph 8.6 also cover questions and answers from other ASNT publications such as *Materials and Processes for NDT Technology* and *ASNT Level III Study Guide: Basic*?
2. Is inquiry 20-04 still valid for all editions post-1980 edition of SNT-TC-1A including 2020 edition?

Response

1. Yes.
2. Yes. Also see Inquiry 23-09.

Inquiry 24-08

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 6.0

As per paragraph 6.0, is it mandatory for the candidate to pass a written exam at the conclusion of documented training? Alternatively, can an employer administer the General, Specific, and Practical exams after the candidate has fulfilled the classroom training and experience requirements?

Response

Refer to Inquiry 20-05.

Inquiry 24-09

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 8.1.8

Within the context of paragraph 8.1.8, how does ASNT define “subordinate”? Is the categorization of Level I and Level II as subordinate to Level III established, or is the intended criterion for subordination primarily determined by job title? For instance, is an NDT Level III considered subordinate to positions like NDT Manager or Quality Control Manager based on job titles?

Response

A subordinate is someone who is under the authority or control of another, within an organization. Also, a subordinate is someone who is lower in rank or position.

Inquiry 24-10

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraphs 8.7.2.2, 8.7.2.3

1. Regarding the “Application and establishment of techniques and procedure,” would questions like “What kind of PT is required per Spec ABC on rotating components of an engine?” be deemed suitable?
2. Regarding the “Capability of interpreting codes, standards, and specifications,” would questions such as “What is the minimum size of porosity permitted per Spec XYZ?” be deemed suitable?
3. How does ASNT define these question categories?

Response

1. Yes.
2. Yes.
3. ASNT does not define question categories, other than general, specific, basic, and method.

Inquiry 24-11

SNT-TC-1A (2020)

I would like to know exactly whether an individual holding an ASNT Level III certificate but not an NDT Level III (in-house certificate) can perform the NDT Level III services specified in paragraph 2.1.16 of SNT-TC-1A.

Response

It would depend on the Level III requirements defined in the program of the employer engaging the ASNT Level III (outside service). Note, an individual holding an ASNT Level III certificate

has only demonstrated that they have met the requirements of 8.7.1 Basic and 8.7.2 Method requirements of an SNT-TC-1A Level III.

Inquiry 24-12

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraphs 12.0, 13.0

When the certifications of individuals expire and the time limits of paragraphs 13.2.2 and 13.2.3 are exceeded, do those individuals need to repeat the training requirements of Table 6.3.1 A?

Response

No. Paragraph 13.2.4 specifically defines this scenario. When the time limits of 13.2.2 and 13.2.3 have been exceeded; prior to being reexamined as described in Section 8.0, the Level III is to determine what additional training is deemed to be appropriate.

Inquiry 24-13

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 4.3.2

1. Given that a Level II is authorized to deliver on-the-job training (OJT) to trainees, is it implied that a newly certified Level II is expected to commence providing OJT for trainees starting from the day following their certification?
2. Can Limited Level II certified individuals provide OJT to trainees?

Response

1. Yes. They would be qualified to provide, but not necessarily expected to provide, OJT to trainees.
2. Yes. Within the scope of their limited certifications.

Inquiry 24-14

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraphs 8.5.4 and 8.5.5

1. In regard to “successfully complete” in the context of checkpoints that failure to successfully complete will result in failure: Would the term “successfully complete” require the checkpoint to have no point value and either a pass/fail or successful/unsuccessful type of grade?
2. If my checklist requires obtaining seven or greater points on a checkpoint that has a maximum score of 10 points and I score the checkpoint as eight out of 10 points and I believe the candidate has successfully completed the checkpoint, would this meet the requirement for a checkpoint that failure to successfully complete will result in failure?
3. If the answer to the previous question is yes, would I need to define in my written practice the point threshold for such a checkpoint?
4. If my checklist requires a candidate to find all of the discontinuities and conditions that I specify in the flawed specimen, would this be considered a checkpoint that failure to successfully complete will result in failure?

Response

1. No. This could be a single checkpoint or a specific step within a checkpoint.
2. No. Also note that in addition, paragraph 8.1.6 also requires an 80% minimum for a Practical examination.
3. N/A
4. Yes.

Inquiry 24-15

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 5.0, 6.0, 7.0, 8.0

1. NDT personnel are transferred from one site (plant) to another site of the same employer but at different locations. Can the transferred NDT personnel be certified at the new site without further training and examination as both the sites are under the same employer?
2. Whether the certification issued by one site can be used as it is without any further certification by the new site, if the NDT personnel are working for different sites of the same employer.
3. If all sites of the same employer follow the same written practice, whether one qualification will be sufficient to perform NDT activities in all sites?

Response

1. Yes, provided the education, training, experience, and examination requirements of both written practices are the same and approved by the responsible NDT Level III.
2. Yes. See Response 1.
3. Yes.

Inquiry 24-16

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 2.1.13

Limited Certification: Does SNT-TC-1A 2020 allow limited certification in TOFD and/or PAUT Level II? If yes, what are the requirements in terms of minimum training hours and prerequisites?

Response

Yes. Table 6.3.1 A, Note 10.0 first requires personnel seeking TOFD and/or PAUT certification to be fully certified as UT Level II personnel. That person could then have a limited certification issued in TOFD or PAUT, provided the description of the limited certification along with the training and experience requirements for that certification would be described in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 24-17

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 6.3.2.1

Regarding the experience requirements for Level III personnel, paragraph 6.3.2.1 states that candidates "Have a bachelor's degree (or higher) in engineering or science..." Does a bachelor's degree in computer science meet this requirement?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 24-18

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraphs 8.5.4 and 8.5.5

Does a Practical examination with 10 discontinuities that have been identified on the answer key with the examinee finding eight of them meet the intent of "the candidate should detect all discontinuities and conditions specified by the Level III"? The examinee will have scored an 80% on the examination even though he missed two indications; or do I need to identify a specific discontinuity the examinee would be required find?

Response

No. The checklist needs to specifically identify which attributes or indications are critical to the Practical examination as determined by the Level III, such as not adequately addressing those attributes or missing those indications would constitute a failed examination.

Inquiry 24-19

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraphs 8.4.1 and 8.5.3

1. Is it required by paragraph 8.4.1 that an employer has their own documented Specific examinations even though an outside agency administers the Specific examinations, or can the employer accept the outside agency examinations?
2. May an employer accept the outside agency examinations as addressing the attributes of paragraph 8.4.1, if the employer doesn't have a Level III in the applicable method?
3. Is it required by paragraph 8.5.3 that the employer have their own specimens and checklists for Practical examinations, or can they accept outside agencies' specimens and the checklists?
4. If the outside agency provides the specimens and checklists, who would review and accept them if the employer doesn't have a Level III?

Response

1. No, it is not required for an employer to maintain their own set of Specific examinations, provided the Level III representing the employer has reviewed and approved the Specific examinations being used by the outside agency as addressing the employer's attributes identified in paragraph 8.4.1.
2. Yes, the employer may engage and approve an outside agency (See paragraph 2.1.16.) to provide Level III services, which would include evaluating the Specific examinations they are administering as meeting the employer's specific attributes, as identified in paragraph 8.4.1. That same Level III could also administer those Specific examinations to the employer's employees.
3. No, it is not required for an employer to maintain Practical examination samples and checklists. The employer may engage an outside agency to provide those services, provided they are representative of the employer's scope of operations (paragraph 5.4).
4. See the answer to question 2.

Inquiry 24-20

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 8.6

Currently, we have questions that are not verbatim, but may be slightly similar. Our upper management is stating we are not in compliance with the SNT-TC-1A 2020 Edition. With our management's interpretation we will have to remove definition questions and completely rewrite most, if not all of our other questions. Plus most definition questions are verbatim. Is it okay to have similar questions as long as they are not verbatim? Looking at SNT-TC-1A 2024 Edition paragraph 8.6 plus the table of method question books was removed. Was this intentional or an error?

Response

See Interpretation 23-09.

Inquiry 24-21

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraph 8.6.3.2

Was “ASNT NDT Level III certificate” intentionally omitted from this paragraph?

Response

Yes, the prerequisites for obtaining an ASNT Level III certificate do not include the Specific examination requirements of paragraph 8.6.3. Both the ASNT ACCP and ASNT 9712 examinations include a Specific examination, which may be used to meet the requirement if determined so and approved by the Level III.

Inquiry 24-22

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraphs 8.1.2 and 8.1.2.1

1. The first sentence of paragraph 8.1.2 mentions paragraph 8.8. There is no paragraph 8.8 in the new edition.
2. The last sentence in paragraph 8.1.2.1 requires that an NDT Level III administer the Practical examinations for Level I and II, but the sentence right before that allows for the Practical examination to be administered by a person certified in the applicable NDT method as NDT Level II OR III. It appears that the last sentence of paragraph 8.1.2.1 was added to this new edition, as it isn't in the 2020 version but doesn't have a marker in the margin. (Please clarify if this sentence was added in error or if it is applicable.)

Response

See SNT-TC-1A Errata 2. The errors have been identified and addressed.

Inquiry 24-23

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraph 6.4

Is paragraph 6.4 intended to be read beyond educational institutions, technical schools, and colleges to include training organizations or training done by an independent contractor to a training organization?

Response

Yes, provided the expanded training has been formalized using flawed samples, and the results and additional lab hours are documented and approved by the Level III. The course of NDE study at educational institutions and colleges typically far exceeds (weeks not hours) the minimum training hours required by Table 6.3.1 A. That expanded class schedule permits additional lab hours for hands-on evaluation of flawed specimens representative of components to be examined, which can then be credited toward experience hours. That does not preclude Level III trainers or other professional training facilities (who typically schedule their course of study to meet the Table 6.3.1 A requirements) from expanding their program beyond the Table 6.3.1 A requirements, to provide additional lab hours to perform hands-on applications.

Inquiry 24-24

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraph Change 14

Performing the review of changes to SNT-TC-1A, I evidenced that No.14 instead establishes that:

14. In paragraphs 8.3.4, 8.4.4, 8.5.6, 8.6.3.2, and 8.6.5, the new ASNT 9712 Program was added. ACCP remains in for now because there is a five-year transition in place.

However, when reviewing the paragraphs mentioned and especially paragraph 8.6.4.2, I observed that this is not the one that refers to the addition of the ASNT 9712 program and the change transition with ACCP.

- 8.6.4.2 If the NDT Level III will be required to perform NDT or evaluate NDT results, the Practical examination should include the same demonstrations of the candidate's ability to perform the required activity(ies) as required in paragraph 8.5.5. This Practical examination shall be administered by a person certified in the applicable NDT method as NDT Level III. For NDT Level III personnel certified under the employer's current written practice, this requirement should be met prior to the next recertification date, in the applicable method.

The mention of this addition to ASNT 9712 is established in the following paragraph 8.6.4.3, which is why I would believe that there is an error in change management that may confuse the reader.

- 8.6.4.3 If the NDT Level III needs to meet the recommendations in paragraph 8.6.4.2, a valid ACCP or ASNT 9712 Level III certificate may be accepted as fulfilling the practical examination criteria in paragraph 8.5.5 for each applicable method if the NDT Level III has determined that the ASNT examinations meet the requirements of the employer's written practice. This acceptance should be documented. If this assessment cannot be accomplished, an employer-administered Practical examination should be completed.

Response

This is identified and addressed in the SNT-TC-1A Errata.

Inquiry 24-25

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraph 8.5.5.3

The statement in paragraph 8.5.5.3 “This requirement should be clearly marked on the checkpoint,” means that a clear marking is to be added on the form used for Practical examination evaluation?

Response

No. This paragraph means that the grading master used for each of the Practical examination samples used will be permanently marked to indicate which checkpoint or checkpoints, if not successfully completed, will result in a failure of the examination, regardless of the total score.

Inquiry 24-26

Draft A SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraph 10.2.1
Should paragraph 10.2.1 be deleted?

Response

No. It was the opinion of the SNT-TC-1A committee that a gap existed for Level III personnel who were required to perform process examinations as part of their job responsibilities. The addition of paragraph 10.2.1 addresses that gap.

Inquiry 24-28

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraph 8.1.2.1

1. The administration and grading of Practical examinations for NDT Level I, Level II, and Level III (the person who grades according to checklist containing at least 10 different checkpoints) is described as follows. If the above conditions are satisfied, can a person certified in the applicable NDT method as NDT Level II grade the Practical examination for other NDT Level II candidates? "To be designated as a qualified representative of the NDT Level III for the administration and grading of NDT Level I, Level II, and Level III personnel qualification examinations, the designee should have documented, appropriate instruction by the NDT Level III in the proper administration and grading of qualification examinations prior to conducting and grading independent qualification examinations for NDT personnel."
2. Can the term "qualified NDT Level III" in the following sentence be considered the same as the "qualified representative of the NDT Level III" in the sentence above? "The NDT Level II Practical examination specified in paragraph 8.5 shall be administered by a qualified NDT Level III."

Response

1. Yes.
2. No. While an NDT Level III could be designated as a qualified representative of the Level III responsible for administering examinations, the terms are not interchangeable. Note: The last sentence of paragraph 8.1.2.1 has been removed with the issuance of SNT-TC-1A 2024 Errata 2.

Inquiry 24-29

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 8.6

1. Regarding to the use of the word "verbatim" in this paragraph, would a question still be considered verbatim if a small additional word (for example, "the") was added to the beginning or end of a question from the *ASNT Questions & Answers Books*?
2. Would it be considered verbatim if a sentence was added to provide some background prior to the question, given that this statement does not change the content of the question itself?
3. In cases where a question in the *ASNT Q&A Books* contains a sentence of background prior to the question itself, would a question still be verbatim if said sentence was removed?
4. If a question were to contain the same exact question statement as one from the *Q&A Books*, but with one or more of the answer choices different from those in the original question, would this question still be considered verbatim to those in the question booklets?

5. Was the intent of removing paragraph 8.6 in the 2024 edition of SNT-TC-1A to indicate that it is acceptable to use questions verbatim from the *ASNT Q&A Books* in written certification exams when working to the 2024 edition (in a situation in which all recommendations from SNT-TC-1A are to be considered minimum requirements)?

Response

1. Yes.
2. Yes.
3. Yes.
4. Yes, if the context and intent of the question is the same. The only exception of mathematical questions in which the significant values result in a different final calculation.
5. No.

Note: The intent of administering a written examination is to test the candidate's knowledge and understanding of a particular NDT method, not the ability of a candidate to memorize published training and example questions.

Inquiry 24-30

SNT-TC-1A (2006-2024), Paragraph 12

When an employer decides to extend the certificate of their employee based on continued performance, do they need to mention the original score of the General, Practical, Specific examinations in the recertification certificate? There should not be any column for showing the score and the recertification should simply cross reference the original certificate?

Response

This inquiry describes the recertification of an employee. The details of the recertification process should be addressed in the employer's written practice

Inquiry 24-31

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraph 8.1.2.1

In the 2024 Edition of SNT-TC-1A, Section 8.1.2.1, the second to last sentence allows for either a Level II or Level III to administer the Practical exam, and the last sentence reads that a "Qualified" Level III shall administer the Practical exam. Is it the intent that all Practical examinations are to be administered by a Qualified NDT Level III or can a Level II be designated in writing by the Level III to administer the Practical exam?

Response

This was a typographical error, corrected in SNT-TC-1A 2024 Edition Errata 2.

Inquiry 24-32

SNT-TC-1A (2024)

The 2024 edition of SNT-TC-1A no longer specifically prohibits the use of questions that are verbatim from the *ASNT Questions & Answers Books* (Q&A Books), as such I am going to put the following in my written practice, "questions for the basic, method, and general exams shall come from the *ASNT Q&A Books* and from the *ASNT Level III Study Guide: Basic*." Paragraph 5.3 of SNT-TC-1A requires that the actions I am going to take must be in my written practice, in this case the action is the use of the questions from the *Q&A Books*.

1. Is it acceptable to use the questions verbatim from the *Q&A Books* for certification exams?
2. Is it acceptable to use questions from other sources such as the Level III study guides for certification exams?
3. Is it acceptable to use questions from the *Q&A Books* where I have changed one or two words, leaving the questions essentially the same?

Response

1. No.
2. No.
3. No.

Note: The intent of administering a written examination is to test the candidate's knowledge and understanding of a particular NDT method, not the ability of a candidate to memorize published training and example questions.

Inquiry 24-33

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraph 12.2

In paragraph 12.2, the recommended maximum recertification interval is five (5) years for all certification levels. Certifications expire on the last day of the month of expiration. Suggestion: Paragraph 9.5.3 Deleted.

Response

This will be taken into consideration for the next edition of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 24-34

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraph 8.5.2

Add in paragraph 8.5.4.1 and 8.5.5.1 the words "or components" after word "specimens." The paragraphs should become: "Specimens. Proficiency should be demonstrated in performing the applicable NDT technique on one or more specimens or components as appropriate for the method and approved and documented by the NDT Level III. (Grading Key)"

Response

This will be taken into consideration for the next edition of SNT-TC-1A.

Inquiry 24-35

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraphs 8.5.4.2 & 8.5.5.2

Paragraph 8.5.4.2 contains two apparently conflicting statements. The first one is "The candidate should detect all discontinuities and conditions specified and documented by the NDT Level III." The second one is: "The written practice should address the acceptable detection rate as well as the maximum number of false calls acceptable." If the candidate should detect all discontinuities, how can the written practice address an acceptable detection rate lower than 100%?

Response

The NDT Level III should identify specific discontinuities and conditions which must be identified, while other discontinuities which may be missed will lower the overall score but will not cause an automatic failure of the examination.

Inquiry 24-36

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraph Summary of Changes Summary of Changes

18. Deleted old paragraph 8.6.
19. Added paragraph 10.2.1 for NDT Level III Technical Performance Evaluation.
20. Rewrote paragraph 8.4.2.
21. Renumbered the old paragraph 8.7 as 8.6 and the old paragraph 8.8 as 8.7.
22. Added Practical examination for NDT Level III in paragraph 8.6.4. The Summary of Changes does not list any essential change.

Response

Corrections to the Summary of Changes have been made in the 2024 SNT-TC-1A Errata 1 and Errata 2. Also, see Inquiries 24-24 and 24-31.

Inquiry 24-37

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Table 6.3.1A Note 3

What academic achievement (e.g., high school graduate, college degree[s], or highest grade level achieved) is the training and experience hours in SNT-TC-1A based upon? If the candidate has less than a high school diploma or equivalent, does the hours for training and experience need to be increased?

Response

This should be determined by the employer's NDT Level III and addressed in the employer's written practice.

Inquiry 24-38

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 8.1.1

Paragraph 8.1.1 requires that the Level III that is responsible for the applicable method shall approve the examination questions for all NDT methods.

1. Who shall approve the Level III basic and method exam questions when you only have one Level III and he is the Level III that has been assigned responsibility for the applicable testing method?
2. Who shall approve the Level III Specific exam questions when you only have one Level III and he is the Level III that has been assigned responsibility for the applicable testing method?
3. Can a Level III that is certified in a different testing method approve the certification exam questions that will be administered to the Level III that has been assigned responsibility for the applicable testing method?

Response

1. When an employer has only one Level III in a method, the employer will need to engage an outside agency to develop and or approve the Level III examinations to be administered to the sole Level III at the employer. The sole Level III cannot develop and approve Level III examinations which they will then be required to take.
2. See response to question 1.
3. No.

Inquiry 24-39

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraphs 8.2.1 & 8.2.3

If a Level III is only performing administrative tasks (training personnel, administering certification exams, etc.) and not performing testing or interpreting results, does the Level III need to have an annual visual acuity exam?

Response

Yes.

Inquiry 24-40

SNT-TC-1A (2020)

Can an employer NDT Level III (having qualification and certification in ISO 9712 NDT Level III) issue NDT Level II certification as per employer's written practice based on SNT-TC-1A 2020? Need statement and reply both.

Response

Yes, provided the ISO 9712 qualification scheme is addressed in the employer's written practice, which has been approved by the employer's NDT Level III.

Note: The certifying authority may not necessarily be a Level III. Also see Interpretations 14-8 and 17-9.

Inquiry 24-41

SNT-TC-1A (2020), Paragraph 9.4.8

Is the Level III referenced in paragraph 9.4.8 required to hold Level III certification in the same methods as the qualifications he is verifying?

Response

No. The review is not method specific, but an administrative review by a Level III individual knowledgeable with the requirements for testing and certification.

Inquiry 24-42

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraphs 8.6.4.2, 10.2, 10.2.1

1. Is it the intention of SNT-TC-1A to use the term "examination" for the performance of examinations on components and material and the evaluation of the results as well as for the assessment of practical examinations and the evaluation of the results for certification of NDE Level I, II, and Level III personnel?
2. Does an NDE Level III who does not perform examinations on components or material himself, but performs the Practical examinations (also issue of Master-Reports for examination specimens) for NDE Level I, II, and Level III examinations or evaluate the results of these examinations, have to fulfill the requirements of paragraph 10.2.1? Statement of Need or Reply: Clarify wording.

Response

1. No. The word "examination" found throughout the SNT-TC-1A document is used almost exclusively in the context of personnel qualification examinations. While method examinations are referenced a few times in the document, the word examination in context, refers to the qualification examinations for personnel certification.
2. No.

Inquiry 24-43

SNT-TC-1A (2024), Paragraph 8.3.4

Is it the intention of SNT-TC-1A that an ISO 9712 certification will not fulfill the requirements for the General examination for NDT Level I and NDT Level II? Statement of Need or Reply: Apparently, it seems to me, after the termination of the ACCP program and the ASNT 9712 program, ASNT believes that the basic principles of an NDT method for general examination can only be taught or trained by ASNT.

Response

No. An ISO certification issued by an organization other than ASNT may be accepted as meeting the General examination criteria for each applicable method, if it has been addressed in the employer's written practice and the Level III has determined the examinations meet those requirements. (Also see Interpretation 18-2).

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